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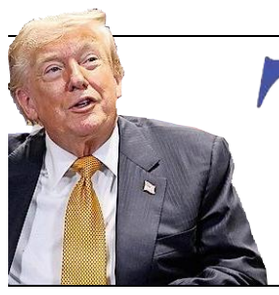

"We are helping them": President Donald Trump says US is still sharing intelligence with Ukraine and wants the war to end

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Supreme Court sides with Trump admin, agrees to hear a lawsuit seeking public records about Elon Musk's dept of govt efficiency

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TIMES GLOBAL

* THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

THERE IS ONLY ONE HAPPINESS IN THIS LIFE, TO LOVE AND BE LOVED — GEORGE SAND

PRINCE HARRY SAYS AVOIDING GRIEF FOR YEARS LED TO PANIC ATTACKS: 'I FELT LIKE I WAS SUFFOCATING'

US ACTRESS SELMA BLAIR ARRESTED FOR 'ASSAULTING' FLIGHT ATTENDANTS ABOARD A PLANE, SET OUT ON BAIL

Behind AI industry's push for reviews, a debate over what gets public

Anthropic and OpenAI have sought significant control over what outside evaluators can publish, fearing disclosures of trade secrets, according to two people familiar with private discussions. The negotiations expose tensions between independent scrutiny of potentially dangerous AI and companies' efforts to protect intellectual property.

As recently as Oct 5, both companies were seeking strict editorial control, the people said. By Oct 8, Anthropic's talks with some evaluators appeared to have evolved, one person said. Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei had said last month that external evaluators should be able to publish key findings "without editorial control." OpenAI later called for "editorial independence."

In response to Reuters' questions, Anthropic said significant control did not accurately characterise all its discussions and work with independent evaluators. It said current conversations with evaluators it had previously used made clear that reviewers controlled their methods, evaluation criteria, conclusions and publication. For new evaluator firms, however, Anthropic reserved the right to comment on and approve reports while reviewers learnt how its models operated and established a working relationship.

OpenAI said it was not seeking approval rights over the full text of evaluators' reports. It said its standard practice was to redact confidential information, while evaluators could disclose whether major redactions were made. The ChatGPT maker said labs and assessors should agree on scope and access before testing, disclose methods and conflicts, and allow assessors to control findings while labs protected sensitive data.

Measures discussed to prevent leaks from "embedded evaluation" teams working inside companies included lab employees observing them and barring evaluators embedded at one lab from simultaneously working at another. However, information considered proprietary can overlap with material needed to assess model risks, prompting disputes and redactions, another person familiar with past dealings said.

Anthropic last month named Faculty, Accenture's specialist AI business, as its first embedded evaluator, although access and reporting arrangements remained under discussion. Faculty CEO Marc Warner said independence and transparency were critical to public trust. Experts warned that without standards or legislation, AI labs could control evaluators' access and influence reporting.

Over 200 researchers, including Geoffrey Hinton, last month sought independent control of findings, lab access and protection from retaliation. OpenAI redacted non-public data from a report by Model Evaluation and Threat Research and Redwood Research into the Hugging Face incident, in which autonomous agents powered by models triggered a hack that compromised Hugging Face infrastructure, researchers said. REUTERS

Were humans involved? German cops confiscate robot that groped teen girl

Cologne: German authorities have opened an investigation into possible sexual harassment after a robot allegedly touched the buttocks of a 16-year-old girl and made thrusting movements towards her in Cologne, police said.

Police responded to the incident overnight from Saturday to Sunday near a fast-food restaurant. Online videos showed two young men escorting the robot towards women on a street. The robot's suspected 16-year-old owner and his 19-year-old companion allegedly filmed and livestreamed the incident. have not been charged but are suspects.

Investigators are examining whether the robot's movements were preprogrammed or controlled in real time, police spokesman Christoph Bermel said. "We have not been aware of this phenomenon so far," he said, calling it "new territory for us." Teams found the 120cm-tall red-and-gold robot in a vehicle's trunk. It also had what appears to be a fake moustache. Police confiscated it and the suspects' phones. AP

AP

The robot seized by Cologne Police

2 Maldivian pilots held in UAE over 'plot' to crash flydubai aircraft

Dubai: Two Maldivian pilots employed by flydubai have been arrested by UAE police in connection with an alleged attempt by an Omani co-pilot to hijack and crash a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight, in which Indian Captain Smit Machchhar was seriously injured while foiling the suspected plot, according to media reports. The duo were taken into custody on Oct 3, and their families have been formally informed of their detention by the Maldivian Embassy in UAE, Maldivian news portal Adhadhu reported. The Maldivian authorities have declined to comment on the detention of the pilots, it said.

No official details have so far been released by the UAE authorities regarding the allegations against the detained Maldivian nationals or the status of the probe into their possible involvement. The arrests came as UAE authorities widened their investigation into the Sept 30 incident involving flydubai co-pilot Hammam al-Hammami, an Omani national accused of attacking the flight's pilot, Machchhar, with an axe in an alleged attempt to take control of the aircraft and carry out a "terrorist attack".

According to Male-based Mihaaru newspaper, the two male pilots are believed to have interacted with al-Hammami at their workplace and lived in the same building as him. However, authorities have not officially revealed the nature of their alleged links to the incident or disclosed details of the evidence against them. The two are among the six Maldivian nationals working as pilots for flydubai and are reportedly the airline's most recent recruits from the Maldives, news portal edition.mv reported.

According to a Male-based newspaper, the two pilots are believed to have interacted with al-Hammami at their workplace and lived in the same building as him.

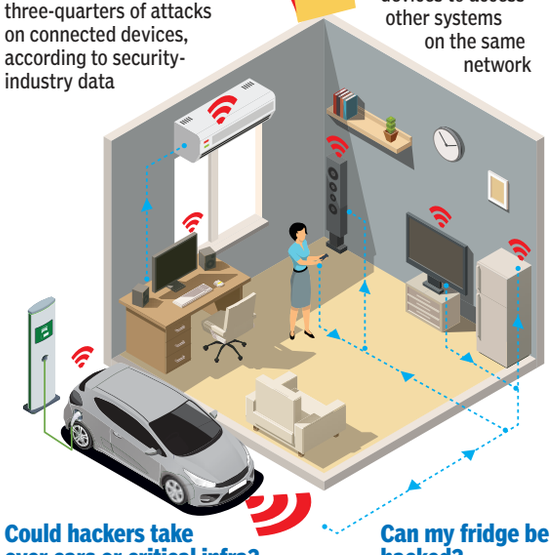
UAE has described the incident as an attempted terrorist attack and identified the accused co-pilot as al-Hammami. UAE attorney general has said a comprehensive probe is being conducted in coordination with regional security agencies to establish the circumstances of the incident and determine whether the accused had links with other individuals or groups. Last week, NIA registered a case to unearth the larger conspiracy behind the mid-air attack on Machchhar. PTI

From refrigerators to security cameras, more everyday devices are connected to the internet, making them potential targets for cybercriminals. Recent attacks on refrigeration systems at French supermarkets highlight this risk

COULD HACKERS GET INSIDE MY FRIDGE?

What devices can be hacked?
Smart TVs, security cameras, video doorbells, alarm systems, smart locks, thermostats and connected appliances can all be vulnerable. Even some toothbrushes connect to the internet. Routers are particularly common targets, accounting for more than three-quarters of attacks on connected devices, according to security-industry data

What could hackers do?
Attackers could access information, change settings or disrupt its operation. A compromised camera could expose activity inside a home, while a hacked refrigerator could have its controls altered. Attackers may also exploit vulnerable devices to access other systems on the same network



Could hackers take over cars or critical infra?
In 2015, a remote attack on a Jeep's entertainment system led to a recall of about 1.4 million vehicles. More recently, researchers found flaws that could allow certain Kia vehicles to be tracked, unlocked and started using a licence plate number. The vulnerabilities were reported to Kia and subsequently fixed. Power and water networks also face cyber threats, but generally have more extensive security measures, monitoring and safeguards than household devices

Can my fridge be hacked?
In theory, yes. Any internet-connected device can be vulnerable to hacking. In 2015, researchers demonstrated how a Samsung smart refrigerator could be compromised to intercept some internet traffic

How can you protect your devices?
Experts recommend changing default passwords, enabling two-factor authentication and installing software updates regularly. Replace devices that no longer receive security support, and keep smart appliances on a separate local network where possible. Connect devices to the internet only when necessary. Ultimately, fewer connected devices mean fewer potential entry points for hackers

Source: Reuters

Trump oil waiver: Voters get relief, Putin benefits

US Prez Insists 'Russia, China Not Aiding Iran'

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: US President Trump insists Russia and China are not doing much to help Iran in its war with America and Israel. "If they are, it's at a very low level, but I don't believe they are at all," the MAGA supremo declared on Monday, arguing that Moscow and Beijing had too much to lose by getting involved.

The assessment is not universally shared by American pundits, who have pointed to Russian intelligence assistance to Tehran and Chinese-linked supplies of technology and components that could sustain Iran's military capabilities. Yet Trump appears determined not to let such doubts obstruct his relationship with either leader

In a move that has infuriated Ukraine, unsettled European allies, mystified India, and prompted bipartisan protests in Washington, Trump has agreed to open the American market to Russian fuel while easing sanctions imposed on Moscow. The ostensible reason is soaring diesel prices ahead of midterm elections on Nov 3, with Trump needing to show that he can bring down the cost of living to forestall a rout.

The electoral calculation is straightforward: Diesel is the lifeblood of trucking, agriculture, construction and much of the goods-distribution economy, and high prices raise operating costs for farmers and truckers, feeding into consumer prices to provide Democrats with an obvious line of attack against a president who promised manna. Small problem: the transaction is so insignificant — the initial shipment would cover less than a day's demand in US — that analysts are looking for a hidden agenda in the deal.

While Russia stands to earn millions of dollars from the initial shipments, the broader waiver provides Moscow with an opportunity to resume exports and challenge the principle that its energy revenues should be restricted while its war against Ukraine continues — the argument Washington made while bearing down on India.

Trump, predictably, has doubled down on the two-timing. On Monday he invoked EU's past purchases of Russian energy, claiming the bloc had paid Russia $250 billion, without specifying the period covered. His argument is essentially that Washington should not be held to a stricter standard than European capitals, hypocrisy from both sides (US and Europe) that Delhi called out from the get-go.

Trump's reluctance to stand up to — much less confront — Putin and Xi is not necessarily evidence of personal affinity alone, according to diplomatic observers; it reflects a transactional view of diplomacy in which personal ties with powerful leaders are treated as instruments of statecraft, and immediate economic or political gains can outweigh the longer-term costs of accommodating strategic rivals. Whether voters reward him will depend on what they see at the gas pump, and if they believe he has delivered results rather than another announcement.

AFP

People at a polling station in Atlanta, Georgia, for early voting Tuesday

Suspected Russian drones hit 2 cargo ships off Bulgaria, 11 sailors missing

Suspected Russian drones struck two cargo ships off Bulgaria Tuesday, sinking one vessel and leaving 11 sailors missing in the latest spillover from the Ukraine conflict in the Black Sea.

Bulgarian PM Rumen Radev summoned the Russian ambassador after drones struck a Ukrainian-owned cargo ship, the Chelsea 3, while another vessel was also hit and sank further north off the coast of the Nato and EU member. Radev said the Chelsea 3 was "hit by three aerial drones", and shortly afterwards another ship was "struck" and sank. "We lack solid, clear evidence to level accusations against any specific party; however ... logic suggests the outcome works to the advantage of Russian Federation," he wrote, calling the attack "unacceptable".

"According to information we got from the rescue centre ... five people were rescued and 11 are missing. This is preliminary information," a spokeswoman for the northeastern region of Dobrich told AFP. The ship was travelling between Algeria and the Romanian port of Braila with a crew of Syrian and Egyptian nationals, according to the Bulgarian interior ministry.

Bulgarian defence minister Dimitar Stoyanov said it would be "illogical for the Ukrainians to strike their own ships". "We assume the drones which struck were Russian," Stoyanov said. AFP

Saudi-led coalition struck oil facilities in Sanaa: Report

Cairo: A coalition of forces in Yemen led by Saudi Arabia carried out new airstrikes Tuesday on the Houthi rebel-held Yemeni capital of Sanaa, the Houthi-run broadcaster Al Masirah and residents said. The strikes marked a fresh escalation in the widening West Asian crisis and came shortly after a coalition spokesman urged residents to evacuate the area for their safety. Witnesses in Sanaa reported hearing explosions. It was not immediately clear which facilities were hit.

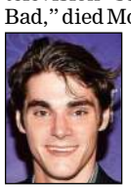
In a rare statement, the coalition urged civilians in the Houthi-controlled capital to leave the Yemeni Oil Company site and nearby storage areas ahead of a possible strike. The oil company in a statement said its storage facilities were empty.

Loud booms heard near Saudi Aramco HQ

Loud booms were heard in the vicinity of Saudi Aramco's headquarters in Dhahran on Tuesday night, six sources said. There was no official comment or confirmation from Aramco. One source said the Aramco headquarters was on fire. An evacuation order for the building had been issued, four of the sources said. A source with direct knowledge of the matter said the Aramco headquarters had been struck. REUTERS

RJ Mitte, 'Breaking Bad' actor and disability rights activist, dead at 34

Los Angeles: Actor RJ Mitte, whose personal experience living with cerebral palsy informed his role as Walter White Jr, the disabled son of a methamphetamine kingpin in the television series "Breaking Bad," died Monday at age 34.



News of Mitte's death in Texas was announced in a statement released through his talent management agency. A publicist for the actor later confirmed reports that Mitte took his own life. No further details were given. "Breaking Bad" star Bryan Cranston voiced his "deep despair" over the death of his "sweet son".

Mitte had been promoting a new movie, "Talking to Strangers." He served as a Screen Actors Guild spokesperson for performers with disabilities, and was an ambassador for the United Cerebral Palsy foundation. REUTERS

US envoy to Greece told to resign over 'unethical conduct': White House

The White House Tuesday asked US ambassador to Greece Kimberly Guilfoyle's to resign over mounting allegations of improper conduct, and she announced her departure within two hours. Guilfoyle, a former Fox News host who was once engaged to President Donald Trump's son Donald Trump Jr, denied the accusations and said she would vigorously defend herself.

Trump's administration said it had asked Guilfoyle to leave after severe criticism over alleged improper and possibly illegal conduct before and during her Athens tenure. White House' press secretary Katie Zacharia , in her first presser, praised Guilfoyle as a wonderful asset and wished her well. Trump said Guilfoyle had been doing a good job but added that his administration disliked what it had been reading.

Wall Street Journal has reported allegations that Guilfoyle threatened a Greek official, accepted improper gifts and services, and offered access to administration officials in exchange for payment of a $100,000 credit card bill.

Her lawyers denied wrongdoing and said money sought from a Trump donor was payment for public appearances and speaking engagements predating her nomination. A US official said state department's inspector general was examining the allegations, though it was unclear whether a formal inspector general investigation had begun. Senior Democrats in Congress have also sought a probe into her conduct. AP

US prisoner who killed inmate for death sentence executed in Florida

Miami: A Florida prisoner who said he killed his cellmate so he could be moved to death penalty was executed Tuesday, nearly 18 years after the fatal attack. James Robertson, 63, was pronounced dead at 12.32pm after receiving a three-drug injection at Florida State Prison near Starke. He pleaded guilty to first-degree murder and waived all appeals in the 2008 strangling of Frank Hart.

Robertson's execution comes at a time of escalating attention on the death penalty in US. In Tennessee, Christa Pike survived an execution attempt two weeks ago despite receiving two lethal doses of pentobarbital. And last week, the Pentagon announced that the firing squad execution of Fort Hood shooter Nidal Malik Hasan would be livestreamed.

Florida department of corrections spokesperson Jordan Kirkland was asked at a press conference early Tuesday how the state planned to make sure what happened to Pike in Tennessee wouldn't happen in Florida. "Florida has a sound lethal injection process and protocol," Kirkland said, noting he couldn't speak to Tennessee's lethal injection procedure. "We are very committed to carrying that out in a humane and dignified manner."

Robertson was supposed to be one of two executions carried out by Florida on Tuesday, but governor Ron DeSantis withdrew a death warrant last week for William Lee Thompson.

The Republican governor did not provide a reason but had temporarily stayed his execution last month pending a psychiatric evaluation. AP

DAILY PLANET

AP

Pope Leo XIV at Gemelli Hospital in Rome Tuesday where he underwent a surgery to remove a nodule from his lung. The Vatican, in a brief statement, said 'the procedure was successfully completed'

Unseen for 60 years, Van Gogh painting on show at HK gallery

Hundreds of people queued Tuesday outside a Hong Kong gallery to see a Vincent van Gogh painting on public display for the first time in six decades. The Dutch artist's "Chataigniers en fleurs" ("Chestnut Trees in Blossom") was on show in Hong Kong ahead of its Nov 18 auction in New York, where it is expected to fetch a record $180 million, according to Sotheby's. It was one of 12 works owned by late Argentine collectors Nelly Arrieta de Blaquier and Carlos Pedro Blaquier. The painting portrays a blossoming chestnut tree with a solitary man walking past three women in Japanese attire. Completed in 1890, it is from the last two months of van Gogh's life. "It's one of the most expressive and hopeful works by van Gogh in the final phase of his career," Scott Niichel, a vice chairman at Sotheby's, said.

Sleep-deprived Japanese compete for best-rested

In diligent, exhausted Japan, self-described elite "competitive sleepers" vied to lie down, relax and nap the fastest and deepest in a contest organised by a mattress company. The Tokyo competition, dubbed "Matt Race", saw dozens of participants fitted with sleep tracking devices sprawl on comfy mattresses to slumber for up to 90 minutes, competing for the top prize of over two million yen ($14,000). "Japan is often described as a country suffering from sleep deprivation, and people here are very diligent," said Riichiro Nakama, a creative director who supervised the planning of the contest. Data showed in 2021 Japanese people slept an average seven hours 24 minutes a day. "I want to live on my own. I'll use the money for moving costs," said winner Suimii.

Yunus called 'terrorist' by Awami backers at US airport

Ahsan Tasnim

Dhaka: Nobel laureate and former Bangladesh interim govt chief adviser Muhammad Yunus was confronted by a group of Awami League supporters at New York's John F Kennedy airport, who termed him a "terrorist" for "killing civilians, arresting thousands and destroying democracy in Bangladesh".

Bangladesh govt condemned the harassment of the former chief adviser, while the PM's information and broadcasting adviser Zahed Ur Rahman said govt views the incident — a video of which has surfaced online — as "Awami terror" and necessary action will be taken.

The foreign ministry said it has asked its mission in NY to take up the matter with law enforcement agencies. "You killed a thousand people in Bangladesh. You terrorist! Why did you come here? Why did you arrest 2,00,000 people?... He (Yunus) killed a thousand police in my country. He destroyed democracy," a supporter of the party, was heard saying as a wheelchair-bound Yunus was leaving the airport Monday.

Hate crime against Hindus up 15% in UK: Home office data

Naomi Canton

London: There has been a 15% increase in religiously-motivated hate crimes targeting Hindus in Britain, UK home office data reveals. Police recorded a total of 146,825 hate crimes in England and Wales between March 2025 and March this year. Religious hate crime rose by 13%.

There was also a 15% increase in hate crimes targeting Muslims, 10% targeting Jews, 3% targeting Sikhs and 24% targeting Christians. Public fear, alarm or distress offences were the most commonly recorded hate crimes targeting Muslims and Jews.

There was also a 15% increase in hate crimes targeting Muslims, 10% targeting Jews, 3% targeting Sikhs and 24% targeting Christians, the govt data revealed

Hindu Council UK managing director Anil Bhanot said that was not the case for Hindus who were experiencing an increase in serious physical assaults. He said the statistics do not represent the true picture as "many Hindus still choose to suffer in silence" if a hate crime is not a physical assault. "They don't report them as they don't feel the authorities will do anything," he said. He added whilst there was govt funding Hindu temples can apply for to protect their security, "historically nothing has been awarded to them".

"Synagogues and mosques have dedicated protection schemes, while Hindu temples have none and must compete for a small share of general funding," a spokesperson for INSIGHT UK, an advocacy group for British Hindus, said.

The spokesperson pointed out the home office "written commentary" accompanying the statistics was only about Jews and Muslims, with no mention of Hindus, the UK's third-largest religious group. "A 15% rise should not be left as a line in a table," the spokesperson said. "Our anti-Hindu hate survey, to be published in Nov, had 2,688 responses, and every respondent had witnessed or experienced anti-Hindu hate, from violence to temple vandalism and the misrepresentation of Hinduism in media and education."

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2 MALDIVIAN PILOTS EMPLOYED BY FLYDUBAI HELD IN UAE IN CONNECTION WITH ALLEGED ATTEMPT TO CRASH FLIGHT THAT WAS SAVED BY CAPT SMIT INSIDE JACKET

Ambulances set for upgrade, don't rely on 108 for 2 months: Minister

Bengaluru: Karnataka health minister U T Khader on Tuesday appealed to citizens not to rely on 108 Arogya Kavacha ambulances for the next two months, as ambulance staff have threatened to suspend services from Wednesday night.

"Since 2018, the 108 ambulance service has faced several difficulties. We want to restructure the entire system, introduce a new tender policy with revised conditions and deploy new ambulances. The process is expected to be completed by Dec. Hence, I request the public not to depend on the 108 service for the next two months," Khader appealed.

The state currently operates a fleet of 715 ambulances.

▶ Long delays, P 4

Set Q papers at last min to prevent leaks: Nilekani

Says PM Keen To Roll Out Panel's Suggestions

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Question papers for high-stakes entrance examinations could be generated at the last minute from a massive bank of questions instead of being prepared and stored in advance, as part of a technology-driven overhaul to prevent leaks, **Nandan Nilekani**, chairperson of the high-powered task force on examination reforms, said on Tuesday. He also said PM Modi was keen to implement the panel's recommendations.

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum 2026 in Delhi, the Infosys chairperson questioned the need for a fixed question paper, arguing that its existence created an economic incentive for theft and sale.

"Why do we need to have something called a question paper? Because the moment you have a question paper, that creates an economic incentive for that to be sold," Nilekani said. He suggested creating a massive question bank from which the paper would be assembled just before the exam. This, he said, would eliminate the incentive for advance leaks.

▶ Tests on computer, P 8

We do not grow at anyone's cost, we grow with the world, says PM Modi

PM **Narendra Modi** on Tuesday sought to position India as a trusted ally while stating that supply chains, energy, minerals, payment systems, and technology are increasingly becoming instruments of pressure and dominance. "One of the biggest questions facing the world today is that of trust, of confidence — the confidence that supplies will continue uninterrupted in times of need. We do not grow at anyone's cost. We grow with the world, and for the world," PM Modi said at a Bloomberg event. P 12

Canada PM Carney to be Republic Day chief guest?

New Delhi: In a phone conversation on Tuesday, **PM Modi** and his Canadian counterpart, **Mark Carney**, reaffirmed their commitment to finalising the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement at the earliest and doubling bilateral trade by 2030. Modi will visit Canada in Dec — on his way to the G20 summit in US — and the trade agreement is expected during the trip.

▶ India partner of choice, writes Canada min, P 8

India is also discussing a possible visit by Carney in Jan as chief guest for Republic Day. Canada foreign minister Anita Anand and trade minister Maninder Sidhu are visiting India currently.

Modi said the two agreed to build on the positive momentum in ties and work for concrete outcomes across key areas, including trade, energy, tech security and people-to-people ties. "Had a warm and productive conversation with PM Mark Carney. Together, India and Canada are contributing towards a more stable and prosperous world," Modi tweeted. TNN

▶ Carney thanks Modi, P 7

State pushes AI in schools, but 48% don't have internet

Niranjan.Kaggere
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: While Karnataka is favouring introduction of AI skills and coding in its schools, nearly 48% of the state's 74,578 schools do not have internet connectivity, exposing a glaring digital divide.

According to UDISE+ report released by Union ministry of education for 2025–26, the state's connectivity rate is well below the national average of 67%. Nearly one in three schools in India lacks internet access, while every second school in Karnataka lacks the facility.

Home to the country's IT capital, Karnataka has the highest percentage of schools without internet connectivity among the southern states — both as a proportion of total schools and in absolute numbers.

▶ Lowest in South India, P 2

DIGITAL DIVIDE

- In K'taka, **30k govt-managed schools don't have internet connectivity.** Nationally, over 4.7 lakh schools lack net access
- In Aug, CM **DK Shivakumar had announced initiatives aimed at introducing AI education** in schools from Class 6

> Without basic facilities, students in poorly connected schools risk being left behind even as their peers gain exposure to emerging tech
> **D Shashi Kumar** | GEN SECY, KAMS

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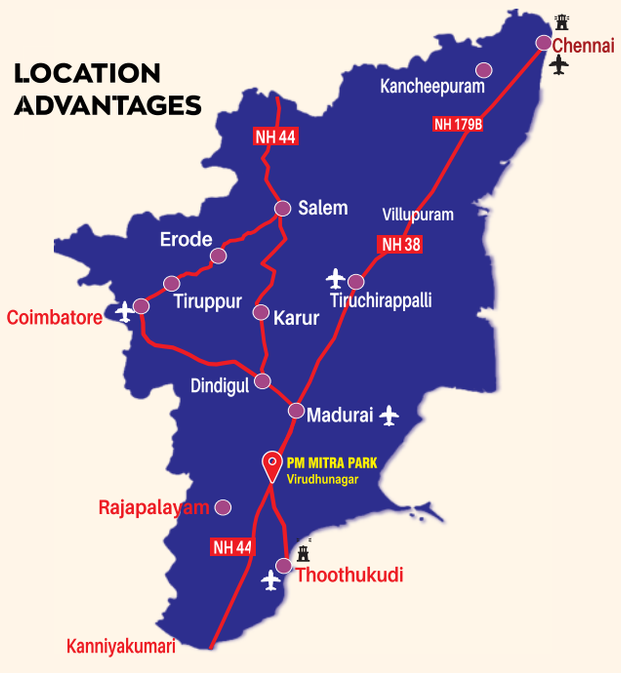

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Can India become the first economic giant built on solar, not coal?

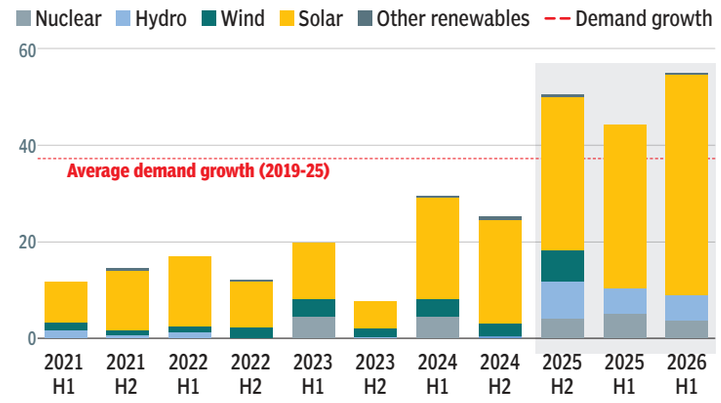
'China built on coal; India is building on sun,' observes Kingsmill Bond, energy strategist at global think-tank Ember. No major country in modern history has powered high-speed industrial expansion without relying on dirty fossil fuels. India is attempting to become the first. **Chandni Tekwani** looks at the data to see whether this clean-energy leap is reality or wishful thinking

CLEAN POWER MET ALL OF INDIA'S NEW ELECTRICITY DEMAND

Between the first half of 2024 and the first half of 2026, India's total power generation increased by 7%, or 63 TWh. That entire additional power requirement was met by clean energy—every unit of additional electricity required over the two years was supplied by clean power.

At 44 TWh, solar contributed the most to clean-power additions, which have stayed above the average demand growth for the past 18 months. That suggests the trend is no longer only about capacity being built, but about clean electricity actually meeting rising demand.

New clean power generation vs electricity demand growth (in TWh per half year)



1 TWh = 1 billion units of electricity; 1 GW = power capacity capable of running roughly 7-8 lakh homes

Source: CarbonBrief by CREA

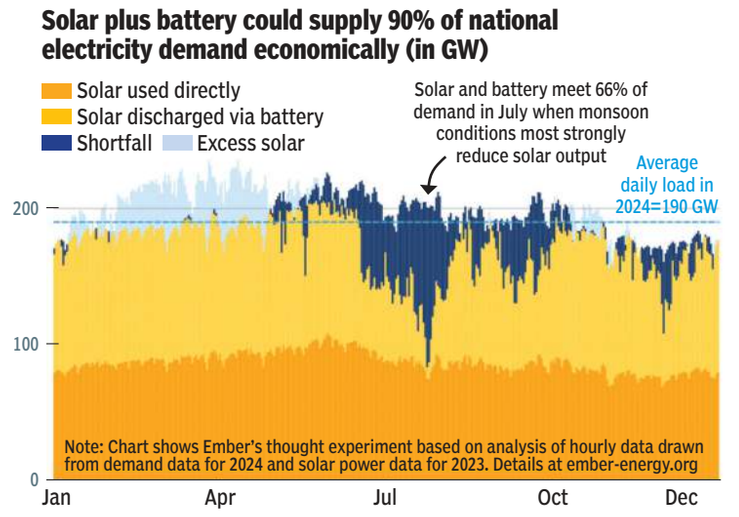
Utility-scale projects under construction as of Jan 2025 are expected to double India's wind and solar capacity, including 82 GW of solar, 25 GW of wind and 36 GW of hybrid wind-solar projects before the end of 2028

SOLAR IS READY. BUT WHAT HAPPENS AT NIGHT—AND DURING THE MONSOON?

Building solar is no longer India's biggest hurdle. The challenge is making it available when demand peaks. While solar generation is strongest during the day, electricity demand remains high into the evening, causing a switch to thermal power.

As the chart shows, solar paired with battery storage could meet up to 90% of India's annual electricity demand. But during monsoon, when solar output drops, that falls to about 66%, highlighting the need for other sources.

Solar plus battery could supply 90% of national electricity demand economically (in GW)



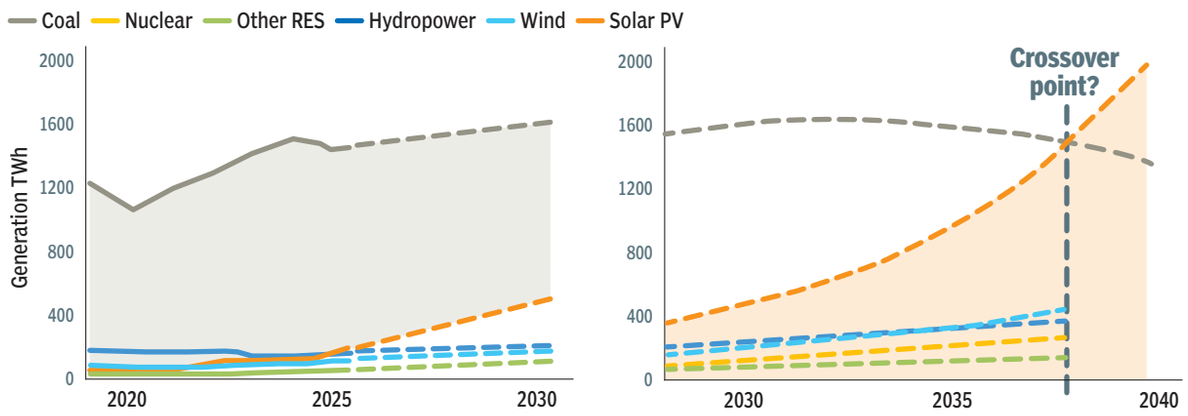
GW: A measure of installed power capacity, or the maximum electricity a power plant can generate

THE GREAT CROSSOVER: WHEN DOES SOLAR OVERTAKE COAL?

Coal still generates over two-thirds of India's electricity. For the next decade, not only will coal capacity not disappear, it will grow—but at a slower pace than solar expansion. The true turning point, the 'Crossover Point', when solar generates more electricity than coal, could come as early as 10 to 15 years from now. The deciding factor won't just be solar panels, but how fast India rolls out high-capacity green corridors and 50 GWh battery systems to move green power across state lines.

This is where Green Energy Corridor Phase III announced on Sept 30 fits in. Beyond adding renewable capacity, the plan strengthens transmission and adds 50 GWh of battery storage to move and store clean electricity when it is needed most.

From here in 2026.... **...can India be here by 2038 or soon after?**



*The projection shown in the chart is not an official estimate. It's based on individual energy researchers' estimates, assuming rapid expansion of solar generation and distribution in the coming decade. Note: Generating capacity at any given instant is measured in MW or GW (engine size). Actual electricity generated or consumed over time is measured in MWh / TWh (distance travelled)

Source: How India is building an energy system the world has never seen" - YouTube: 'Just Have A Think'

Rollout of BS-VII in 3 phases from April 2029 to April 2035

Will Start With Cars, SUVs; New Norms Won't Hit Existing Vehicles

Dipak.Dash@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Govt is all set to roll out BS-VII emission standards, aligned with Euro 7 norms, in phases, starting April 2029. The new norms will set stricter limits on harmful pollutants, including nitrogen oxides, hydrocarbons and particulate matter amid heightened pollution risks across Indian cities.

BS-VII will start with new cars and SUVs manufactured from April 2029, followed by small goods delivery and pick-up vans from 2030 and buses and heavy-duty vehicles from April 2031. The new norms for two-wheelers — the biggest contributor to pollution — will, however, be notified later.

Unlike BS-VI, which was first rolled out from April 2020, it will not require changes in the refinery infrastructure to produce petrol and diesel suitable for the upgraded emission standards, officials said. It will, however, require the automobile sector to upgrade engines.

TOI has learnt that the road transport ministry has approved the proposed timeline, and draft notifications for the three categories of vehicles are expected over the next few days. The proposed emission norms will not affect existing vehicles or their life, including those compliant with BS-VI standards.

The proposed standards will strengthen emissions monitoring beyond controlled laboratory tests to ensure vehicles comply with prescribed limits under real-world driving conditions and throughout their operational life.

The implementation of all the new norms will be in three phases spanning six years — April 2029 to April 2035 — giving adequate time to industry and testing agencies.

According to the finalised norms, the cut-off limits of various emission components for cars and SUVs remain unchanged compared with BS-VI. Particulate number has, however, been reduced from 23 nanometres to 10 nanometres, resulting in improved filtration of pollutants. Smaller particles penetrate deeper into lungs. A person aware of the matter said the proposed change makes the regulation more stringent by capturing ultrafine particles, which have been unregulated thus far.

The transition from BS-VI to BS-VII will have more impact on trucks and heavy-duty vehicles, with the proposed standard aimed at reducing emissions in the range of 20-50% across pollutants. This will be more stringent for on-road emissions.

People involved in framing the norms said BS-VII goes beyond tailpipe emission by regulating non-exhaust sources such as brake wear and tyre abrasion. Moreover, the new norms will introduce the concept of market surveillance, where independent testing agencies will conduct in-use compliance checks.

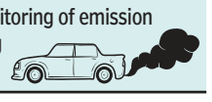
Officials said the norms are fully aligned with Euro 7 and its implementation, which was also structured in a phased manner, starting Nov 2026 for light-duty vehicles and May 2028 for heavy-duty vehicles. The full rollout will extend up to 2035.

HOW NEW STANDARD WILL BE DRIVEN IN

Timeline	Cars	Small Delivery/ Pick up trucks	Trucks/ Buses
Ph-I (tailpipe emission limits)	Apr 2029	Apr 2030	Apr 2031
Ph-II (brake particle emission limits & advanced OBM/OB-FCM over-the-air monitoring)	Apr 2031	Apr 2032	Apr 2033
Ph-III (harmonised brake emission)	Apr 2035	Apr 2035	Apr 2035

WHAT'S NEW

1) PM & PN limits applicable for all vehicles
2) On Board Monitoring for continuous monitoring of emission
3) On-board Fuel Consumption Monitoring
4) Brake wear emission & tyre abrasion



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Former Bangladesh interim govt chief adviser Muhammad Yunus confronted at New York's JFK airport by Awami League supporters who call him a **'terrorist'** for 'killing civilians, arresting thousands and destroying democracy', Inside jkt

After Brazil and Uruguay, **Kolkata to host an exhibition match** between the **legends of** Spanish football teams **Barcelona and Real Madrid** on Nov 25

Russian drones strike two cargo ships off Bulgaria, sinking a vessel & leaving 11 sailors missing in the latest spillover from the Ukraine conflict in Black Sea, Inside jkt

Shreyas Iyer-led Indian team will aim to seal 5-match T20 series against West Indies in the fourth match in Hyderabad on Wednesday. Shai Hope-led WI team need a victory to stay alive, P 21

BJP MP: FCRA bill has provisions akin to UPA law

BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal, who heads the JPC examining the FCRA amendment bill, which is facing opposition from certain sections and opposition parties, on Tuesday said major provisions of the proposed legislation have the same clauses that were incorporated in the law enacted by UPA govt in 2010. Jaiswal said the 2010 Act gave power to the state home secretary and principal secretary to confiscate properties of an NGO receiving foreign funding if there were irregularities. TNN

10 drown as boat capsizes in Ganga

At least 10 people feared drowned after a boat carrying around 15 to 20 people capsized in the Ganga in Bihar's Vaishali district Tuesday night. The bodies of five victims were recovered, police said. The passengers were mostly children and young men. TNN

FLIPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA

A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE.

Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in TOI.

Sugarcane farmers in K'taka protest

Sugarcane farmers blocked NHs at several places in Karnataka Tuesday, demanding higher prices for their produce and implementation of the Swaminathan Commission's recommendations. Protests were held in Belagavi, Vijayapura and Dharwad districts. P 5

Power bank of 1 brand barred on all flights

DGCA has barred MOBIKINS MK-PB-04 power banks from passenger baggage and cargo on all flights to, from or within India after a recent fire on an IndiGo flight involving the model. Airlines have been directed to prevent their carriage and publicise the safety advisory.

K'taka FDA to recall drug price order

Karnataka's FDA will withdraw its order directing hospitals, healthcare institutions and medicine retailers to disclose medicine and medical device costs and prices. The order will be recalled within days, a source said, citing a related Supreme Court case. P 3

4 flyers held with gold bars at KIA

Four passengers from Chennai, including three women and a man, were arrested by customs officials at KIA for allegedly smuggling gold from Dubai. They had taped 28 gold bars to the soles of their feet. The four were intercepted while leaving Terminal 2. P 3

Rahul peddling lies on SIR to cover Cong poll defeats: Shah

'Party Has Been Losing In States For Decades'

Kumar.Rakesh@timesofindia.com

PTI

CJP's Saurav Das (left, in black T-shirt) and Ashutosh Ranka (right, behind Tricolour) entered a heavily barricaded Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Tuesday and raised slogans demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar. An FIR has been filed against them and other CJP members for trespassing. Till last reports, Das, Ranka, Ajinkya Shinde, and other CJP members remain in detention

FULL COVERAGE: P 6

New Delhi: Going on the offensive amid opposition's stir against special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, Union home minister Amit Shah Tuesday accused Rahul Gandhi of fabricating lies about the exercise to hide his failure resulting in a string of Congress defeats, and to protect "infiltrators" who have been registered as voters.

"You and not SIR is responsible for Congress's defeats. Since you emerged as the main leader of Congress and then became its president and the leader of opposition, Congress has continuously lost elections. You should introspect," he said, asking the main opposition party and its allies to prepare themselves for a fourth consecutive defeat in the 2029 Lok Sabha polls.

"In many states you have not been able to win election for decades," Shah said, citing Congress's barren electoral performance in a number of states, including in Gujarat, Tripura, Tamil Nadu and West Bengal, while SIR had started only after 2024.

This is the first time Shah has taken on the opposition, which has been trying to ratchet up pressure for CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation through its street campaigns in the national capital, and signalled a determined intent of the BJP brass to challenge its opponents' allegation that Election Commission (EC) is working to benefit the party in polls.

The framing of opposition's protests as an attempt to cover "infiltrators" is significant, as BJP has for long accused its opponents of helping illegal immigrants from Bangladesh as well as Rohingya from Myanmar getting registered as voters as part of their "votebank" politics.

With opposition parties coming together, BJP and JD (U) held a joint press conference where Union minister Piyush Goyal dared opposition-run govts in different states to quit if it considered polls following SIR rigged.

Union minister and JD(U) functionary Lalan Singh said the entire campaign is not for saving democracy but weakening it by targeting constitutional institutions and trying to stoke anarchy through street protests. The two ministers echoed Shah on Congress's poor show in UP, Bihar and Tamil Nadu for decades, and said it is not even a key party in vast swathes of the country.

▶Reach in hinterland, P 6

EC in HC: Poll roll made anew, can't say voters deleted

Panaji: Election Commission on Tuesday justified before the Goa bench of Bombay HC the non-inclusion of a Goan family of six in the electoral roll and said their names couldn't be considered as "deleted" as the "core feature of SIR (special intensive revision)" is that it is prepared "de novo, or afresh from ground up", **reports Lisa Monteiro**.

"The fact that the name was on the earlier roll doesn't by itself secure a place in the draft SIR roll. Non-appearance of a name in draft SIR in law, and in fact, does not mean deletion at all since the electoral roll is being prepared afresh. There is no electoral roll from which the name can be deleted," senior advocate Ashutosh Kumbhakoni, representing EC, told the two-judge bench of justices Valmiki Menezes and Amit Jamsandekar.

▶SIR akin to first roll, P 8

K'taka govt backs right to protest, promises review of police action

Chethan.Kumar @timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Karnataka home minister Priyank Kharge and chief minister DK Shivakumar Tuesday reiterated that peaceful protest was fundamental to democracy and promised a review of police action against anti-SIR demonstrators in Bengaluru.

Activists, however, said

▶March blocked, but fight against SIR in state is on, P 2

assurances were not enough and demanded withdrawal of the police licensing order that restricts all protests in the city to Freedom Park. They also sought restoration of the 2009 order governing assemblies and processions.

The demand follows Monday's detention of protesters who had gathered near KR Circle to march to the chief electoral officer's office against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Police detained them after they refused to move to Freedom Park, while photojournalists covering the action were allegedly manhandled.

▶'Can't be confined', P 2

Journalists hold silent march in Delhi

Journalists marched silently around Press Club of India building in Delhi Tuesday, condemning the detention and alleged assault on mediapersons covering the ongoing protests. "Attacks on journalists...are unacceptable and undermine the fundamental right of the media to report freely and fearlessly," PCI said on X. TNN

SC asks for senior cop to address journos' plaint

Supreme Court Tuesday asked Delhi Police to depute a senior officer to the court on Thursday to respond to allegations that women reporters were sexually harassed by police personnel while covering the protests on Oct 10, **reports Dhananjay Mahapatra**.

Senior advocate Indira Jaising said that 'Network of Women in Media' has filed a petition narrating incidents of sexual harassment. "We would like some senior police official to remain present to explain and assist the court," the bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said.

The day also saw senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia and Mahesh Jethmalani mentioning a petition seeking criminal contempt action against political functionaries for storming SC Monday evening and obstructing access to SC's petition filing counter. P 6

'Sting op' row: Ex-CM gets injunction against circulation of 2 videos

Siddaramaiah: Bid To Tarnish Image, Truth Will Prevail

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Congress Working Committee member and former CM Siddaramaiah Tuesday obtained an interim court order restraining 42 media organisations, digital platforms and other defendants from circulating two videos allegedly linking him to a sting op controversy.

The 19th City Civil and Sessions Court (Bengaluru) directed social media platforms and digital intermediaries cited in Siddaramaiah's suit to forthwith disable access to and block the URLs.

In Mysuru, Siddaramaiah's son and minister Yathindra Siddaramaiah dismissed the videos as fake, alleging those were intended to tarnish his father's image.

"The political situation today has deteriorated to such a level that even a senior leader like Siddaramaiah has to face such false allegations," Yathindra said.

UPLOADED IN SEPT

- According to complaint, **first video was uploaded on Sept 27** and the **second video was an hour-long programme**, which was streamed online on Oct 2
- **Ex-CM Siddaramaiah's suit** submitted that as on Oct 4 the videos had garnered 3.2L views
- **Opposition demands CBI probe** into alleged 'sting op'

"A calculated and malicious design to cause maximum injury... — Siddaramaiah

"I'm confident that truth will prevail," Siddaramaiah said, adding he had lodged a complaint with the city police commissioner, seeking a probe into the controversy.

The ex-CM urged the media and public not to circulate what he termed "false information". In a social media post, he alleged that the videos, circulated on social media over the past few days, were being used to malign him for political reasons.

Union minister HD Kumaraswamy sought a CBI probe into the controversy.

▶'Hidden camera', P 5

India reaffirms Ladakh's status as China says it does not recognise UT

New Delhi: Diplomatic tensions flared again between India and China after Beijing strongly opposed India's decision to officially map and standardise 28 places in Ladakh, including some in Aksai Chin, and reaffirmed that it does not recognise the Union territory. In a swift rebuttal, New Delhi reiterated that no amount of Chinese denial can change the established fact that Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India, **reports Sachin Parashar.**

According to the home ministry, which announced the standardisation in a press release on Oct 2, identifying the places/geographical features formally on the Survey of India map was aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large. MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal reiterated the same, saying the MHA statement was self-explanatory.

The Chinese foreign ministry described the Indian move as illegal.

▶Amid ongoing talks, P 8

Union minister Murugan offers to resign, sparks Cabinet rejig buzz

Kumar.Rakesh @timesofindia.com

New Delhi: Union minister L Murugan on Tuesday offered to resign from govt and Rajya Sabha (RS), saying he wanted to return to politics in his home state Tamil Nadu after being part of govt for over five years, rekindling the buzz that PM Narendra Modi could be preparing to reshuffle his council of ministers amid a steady exit of its members and some being in queue.

Murugan has three and a half years left of his RS term, and his exit will allow BJP to pick a new face from Madhya Pradesh, where he was elected from in 2024.

In his five-page letter, Murugan expressed gratitude to the PM for all the opportunities he got and his govt's work for Tamil Nadu. He said, "I therefore request you to relieve me of my responsibilities as Minister of State and permit me to relinquish my membership of the Rajya Sabha so that I may dedicate myself full-time to strengthening the party in Tamil Nadu."

What stoked curiosity in political circles is that he chose to post the letter offering his resignation on social media, apparently with the consent of BJP leadership. This suggested a clear signaling from the party brass, leaving many within the ruling alliance wondering if it was a prelude to more resignations.

His exit from the govt comes on the heels of BJP not renominating Union ministers Hardeep Singh Puri and B L Verma for another term in Rajya Sabha, a necessity for their continuation beyond six months.

SERIES OF EXITS

- L Murugan's exit comes on the heels of BJP not renominating Union ministers **Hardeep Singh Puri and B L Verma** for another Rajya Sabha term
- **Ravneet Singh Bittu and George Kurian** resigned earlier under similar circumstances
- **Pankaj Chaudhary and Harsh Malhotra**, have been made BJP presidents in UP and Delhi, respectively, making their exit from Cabinet a matter of time

L Murugan

▶Puri may return, P 8

Pjb anti-drugs activist shot dead on live cam

Bathinda: Live on Facebook and in front of scores of witnesses, anti-drug activist Parminder Singh Jhota was shot dead by a chemist he suspected of selling 'chitta' (synthetic drugs) in Punjab's Mansa town on Monday morning. Four persons suffered bullet injuries, **reports Neel Kamal.**

The brazen murder was caught on CCTV and multiple cameras. Pistol in hand, the accused, Ashwani Kumar, followed Jhota as he staggered out into the street and took refuge in a shop. The gunman walked behind him and shot him again and again. Jhota was struck by three bullets. His dying agony was also caught on camera.

▶No to cremation, P 9

Citing probe lapses, HC acquits 13 serving life for 1996 Bihar killing of four

Patna: Patna high court acquitted 13 people serving life sentences for the 1996 killing of four people in Bihar's Karpi by left-wing militants, citing serious lapses in the police investigation and failure to establish the accused's involvement beyond reasonable doubt, **reports Dev Kumar Pandey.**

A division bench of Justices Rajeev Ranjan Prasad and Kumar Manish overturned Tuesday a Jehanabad court's April 3, 2023, verdict convicting 13 in the murder carried out by members of Mazdoor Kisan Sangram Parishad. HC flagged the absence of blood-soaked soil seized from the crime scene, spent bullet cartridges, a test identification parade, forensic evidence and postmortem reports examined during trial. Though the murders were established, the prosecution failed to prove who committed them, HC said, describing the lapses as evidence of negligent investigation.

IN THE COURTS

- HC reduces man's rape conviction to indecent assault, **says allegation of him mounting on her without medical proof insufficient to prove rape** | P 7
- Madras HC **quashes an ED laundering case against ex-TN min K Ponmudy**
- **Aligarh court awards 5-yr RI to a 23-yr-old** under UP Gangsters Act in a **case filed in '20, when he was juvenile** | P 6

▶Protect innocent, P 12

FM remarks spark LTCG cut hopes, sensex jumps 1100

New Delhi/Mumbai: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday said the govt was open and keen to "hear" discussions around the long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax as it was "healthy" to have the debate.

She, however, declined to be specific on the matter as preparations for the budget in Feb are already underway. Her comments raised investors' hopes of a reduction in LTCG tax and securities transaction tax (STT), a long-standing demand among foreign funds who have been big sellers in the Indian market.

As a result, stock prices jumped with the Sensex finally settling 1.5% or 1,109 points up at 73,034 points.

▶ Nifty rebounds, P 19

BS-VII set to roll out from Apr '29 for cars & SUVs

Govt is all set to roll out BS-VII emission standards, aligned with Euro 7 norms, in phases, starting April 2029. The new norms will set stricter limits on harmful pollutants, including nitrogen oxides, hydrocarbons and particulate matter amid heightened pollution risk across Indian cities. BS-VII will start with new cars and SUVs manufactured from April 2029, followed by small goods delivery and pick-up vans from 2030 and buses and heavy-duty vehicles from April 2031. The new norms for two-wheelers – the biggest contributor to pollution – will, however, be notified later. Flap opp

AP IAS officer & friends booked for abusing, attacking cops at B'luru pub

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

IAS officer Vikas Marmat (holding phone) and his friend Abhay Uday Singh argue with police officers

Bengaluru: An Andhra Pradesh-cadre IAS officer and his realtor-friend were among four people booked on charges of abusing and attacking police officers at a nightclub on Residency Road in Bengaluru when the latter were checking the credentials of customers to ensure liquor was not served to underage customers.

The 2019-batch officer under police scanner is Vikas Marmat, currently serving as project director of Kuppam Area Development Authority in AP chief minister N Chandrababu Naidu's home constituency, Kuppam. His friends booked are Abhay Uday Singh, a real estate businessman and resident of Akshaynagar on Bannerghatta Road, and Nitish, owner of a competitive exams coaching centre and resident of Bihar. The fourth person booked is Roshan, a bouncer.

While the officer has been named as primary accused, others were named co-accused in the incident that took place on the night of Oct 9. Next morning, Vikas and others apologised for their act, police said.

The incident unfolded when sleuths from Central Crime Branch visited Cavore on Residency Road as part of a drive to check underage revelry at liquor joints. A team led by inspector Arun Salunke visited the outlet around 1.30am. While interacting with revellers, a police officer asked a few young women to produce documents to prove age. This made Vikas and Abhay angry. They allegedly started behaving tersely with the police.

▶Questioned cops, P 5

11thC Khajuraho Vishnu idol's head found: ASI

Archaeological Survey of India has found the missing head of an 11th-century Vishnu idol at Khajuraho, whose restoration became the subject of a recent controversy involving the Supreme Court, and plans to reattach it after scrutiny. Yadubir Singh Rawat, ASI DG, told **TOI** the missing head was found in an ASI store.

Row over the beheaded Vishnu idol reached the top court last year. Then CJI BR Gavai dismissed the plea, saying, "Go and ask the deity itself to do something now." Gavai later clarified his remark was taken out of context and said he respects all religions. P 9

Protesters Send Memo To CEO By Email ■ Flag Arbitrary Deletions And Seek Restoration Of Jan 2025 Electoral Roll

March blocked, but fight's on

Chethan.Kumar@timesofindia.com

Pics: Syed Asif

STANDING THEIR GROUND: Bengalureans continued to gather at Freedom Park Tuesday to oppose SIR and condemn the detention of activists in the country. Lawyers also staged a peaceful stir outside the city civil court

Bengaluru: The protesters detained Monday while attempting to march to the chief electoral officer's (CEO) office to submit a memorandum opposing the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka have submitted the memorandum by email and vowed to continue their agitation.

The memorandum, submitted by My Vote, My Right — a coalition of over 40 civil society organisations, including trade unions, women's groups and human rights organisations, along with other democratic rights groups and citizens — demands the cancellation of the SIR process in Karnataka, restoration of electoral rolls as they stood in Jan 2025, and the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

"There's no question of backing out. The issue is serious. While we've already written to the Karnataka home minister about the way police acted on Monday, there's another question that remains unanswered," said Clifton Rozario, national general secretary of All India Lawyers Association for Justice, who was allegedly assaulted during the protest. "I've been at many protests over the years, and Monday's police behaviour was unfamiliar, to say the least. So, the question we have is: has the election commission communicated something to the police that has not been made public?" Rozario asked.

A key concern raised in the memorandum is the deletion of eligible voters' names from electoral rolls. Claiming that more than one crore names have been deleted from Karnataka's rolls, the signatories said street vendors, migrant workers, single women, members of the LGBTQIA+ community, Dalits and religious minorities were among the worst affected.

The memorandum highlights the low rate of reinstatement of deleted names through Form 6, the application used to seek inclusion in electoral rolls. As per the signatories, eligible voters are facing difficulties in getting names restored even through this mechanism, raising concerns about their ability to exercise their right to vote.

Call for better safeguards

The memorandum warns that marginalised communities face a disproportionate risk of exclusion because of difficulties in producing documents, migration, discrepancies in name, and arbitrary objections. "Excluding these groups would deepen existing inequalities in democratic representation," said Vinay Sreenivasa of My Vote, My Right. The signatories also expressed concern over the alleged misuse of Form 7, which allows objections to be filed against the inclusion of names in electoral rolls. They claimed that the process had created opportunities for politically motivated deletions, particularly targeting Muslims and Dalits.

According to the memorandum, concerns over large-scale deletions, procedural irregularities, lack of transparency and inadequate accountability have eroded public confidence in the SIR process. It calls for safeguards against arbitrary deletions and the misuse of the objection mechanism in future electoral roll revisions. "Along with scrapping the ongoing SIR and restoring the Jan 2025 rolls, we've urged that future revisions be conducted through a transparent, lawful and publicly accountable process, ensuring that no eligible voter is deprived of the right to vote," Sreenivasa said.

'Dissent not a crime': Lawyers demand probe

Anush.S@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Condemning police action against their colleagues and students during anti-SIR protests in Delhi and Bengaluru in the past four days, dozens of lawyers Tuesday demanded an apology from the Union govt for unlawful detentions, while welcoming the Karnataka chief minister's order to probe the Bengaluru incident.

Unlike the chaos Monday when protesting lawyers were manhandled allegedly near KR Circle, Tuesday's demonstrations by Indian Association of Lawyers and All India Lawyers Association for Justice (AILAJ) in front of the city civil court remained peaceful. Despite the lawyers protesting outside the designated site of Freedom Park, police officers did not attempt to detain or remove them.

'Batons cannot silence the Constitution' and 'dissent is not a crime' were some of the placards on display during the protest. On the CM's probe order, Clifton D'Rozario, AILAJ's general secretary, said, "This is the difference between a party that believes in democracy and others that don't. The state govt immediately said they'll look into it. I'm sure they'll take action." Clifton was among the advocates allegedly manhandled by police Monday. "Police are always in favour of the ruling class," he added.

The lawyers sought resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged discrepancies in the special intensive revision process. "Today's protest by lawyers in Bengaluru is due to several issues: SIR, manhandling of lawyers, and we're looking for the rule of the law. When we are supposed to uphold the rule of law, we are treated like this," said Shilpa Prasad, a lawyer.

Avani Choksi, an advocate focused on labour law, said the protest was planned well before Monday's chaos with a larger focus on Delhi. They hinted at more protests if the Union govt does not take action.

WHY CAN'T BENGALURU PROTEST OUTSIDE FREEDOM PARK?

A Karnataka HC order and police licensing regime have made Freedom Park the city's default protest venue. But the governing police order also gives the police commissioner discretion to designate another suitable venue, meaning the legal position is more nuanced than an absolute ban on demonstrations elsewhere

AI

Bengaluru has largely confined protests to Freedom Park for years. The practice stems from a suo motu case initiated in Karnataka high court in 2021 over the impact of demonstrations on traffic and the rights of non-participants.

How did the restriction begin?

On March 3, 2022, a division bench of HC passed an interim order directing the state govt to ensure that protests, processions and similar activities were held only at Freedom Park, Gandhinagar, and nowhere else in Bengaluru. The court also directed that such activities be organised without adversely affecting traffic, particularly during rush hours, and that action be taken wherever traffic was disrupted. On Aug 1, 2022, HC disposed of the case. Paragraph 4 recorded a submission that protests, marches and dharnas would be permitted only at Freedom Park, and that the state was obliged to enforce the 2021 licensing order. Paragraph 5 directed the authorities to ensure compliance with that order "in letter and spirit" and to continue taking action against violators.

What does existing police order say?

The Licensing and Regulation of Protests, Demonstrations and Protest Marches (Bengaluru City) Order, 2021, published in the state gazette in Jan 2022, currently governs protests in the city. It stipulates that protests, demonstrations, dharnas and protest marches cannot be held in the city without a licence under the order. Clause 4.1 identifies Freedom Park as the designated venue for protests in Bengaluru. However, it also empowers the police commissioner to designate another suitable location in the city, depending on the situation. The licensing authority may determine the number of participants permitted at Freedom Park based on the nature and duration of the programme and the venue's capacity.

So, are protests outside Freedom Park illegal?

Not necessarily in every circumstance. The 2021 order does not expressly prohibit protest marches or designate Freedom Park as the only possible venue. Instead, it identifies Freedom Park while retaining the police commissioner's discretion to permit another suitable location.

A legal backgrounder prepared by activists argues that the HC's final order did not direct that protests be held exclusively at Freedom Park, but required compliance with the licensing order. According to this interpretation, the judgment neither bars rallies nor mandates Freedom Park as the sole venue.

The distinction is important: the March 2022 interim order expressly restricted protests and processions to Freedom Park, while the Aug 2022 final order required enforcement of the 2021 licensing rules. Both orders must be read alongside the licensing order before arriving at a definitive legal conclusion.

Why does this matter?

Activists argue that restricting demonstrations to a single venue reduces their visibility and makes it harder for groups to draw public attention to local grievances. The backgrounder says the restrictions have affected workers, farmers, Dalit activists, sanitation workers and residents seeking to protest over issues in their own localities. The debate centres on balancing traffic management and public convenience with the constitutional right to assemble peacefully and express dissent. For now, Freedom Park remains Bengaluru's designated dominant protest venue. Whether, and under what conditions, the police commissioner exercises the discretion to permit demonstrations elsewhere remains central to the controversy.

— Text: **Chethan Kumar**

BLOs shift focus to implementing voter roll changes, to clear 19.5 lakh forms by Oct 22

Pearl.DSouza@timesofindia.com

Photo for representation

Voter applications received before Sept 23

7,86,520 Form 6 (new voter registration)	4,528 Form 6A (overseas voter registration)
58,220 Form 7 (deletion of names)	10,99,875 Form 8 (corrections, shifting of residence and replacement of EPIC)

Bengaluru: With notices and hearings nearing completion, booth-level officers (BLOs) have shifted their focus to processing applications for voter addition, deletion and correction submitted before the Sept 23 deadline through Forms 6, 7 and 8. The electoral machinery has until Oct 22 to dispose of pending claims and objections.

Form 6 is used to apply for inclusion in the electoral roll, Form 7 to seek deletion of a name, and Form 8 to update voter details, shift registration to another address, or replace an elector photo identity card (EPIC).

An official from the chief electoral officer's office said most of the nearly 19.5 lakh applications have been processed, with the remaining forms expected to be cleared by the end of the week. A BLO supervisor in Mahadevapura said physical verification of applicants under Forms 6 and 8 had begun alongside house-to-house verification of documents submitted by voters served notices.

Although no Form 7 application had been received at his booth, applications under Form 8 to shift voter registration to Mahadevapura would automatically generate a Form 7 request to delete the voter's name from the previous address. Karnataka has received 58,220 Form 7 applications, around 80% of which are generated through Form 8 applications when voters shift their registration, a senior official said.

Assistant electoral registration officers in Bengaluru Central said BLOs had also begun processing Forms 6 and 8 even as the notice and hearing process continued.

Meanwhile, the deputy commissioners of Bidar and Vijayapura told **TOI** that no notices had been issued to applicants or those whose names were challenged in constituencies that witnessed attempts at mass deletions through bulk Form 7 applications, as the objections had been withdrawn.

Protests can't be confined to Freedom Park: Activist

▶ Continued from page 1

While Kharge said he had instructed police to ensure that peaceful demonstrations were not disrupted, Shivakumar assured he had sought a full report on the circumstances leading to the police action and warned that accountability would be fixed if there had been unnecessary or excessive use of force.

"The right to peaceful protest is fundamental to our democracy. We cannot demand that right for ourselves in Delhi and deny it to others in Bengaluru," Shivakumar said, adding that there would be "no double standards". He, along with Kharge, was in Delhi Monday to be part of anti-SIR protests. Activists welcomed the assurances, but said govt must address the restrictions. "The licensing order, 2021, restricting protests to Freedom Park must be withdrawn. Protests cannot be caged to Freedom Park; holding placards and shouting slogans cannot be criminalised; peaceful marches cannot be met with police violence," advocate and activist Clifton Rozario said.

TOI

Protesters gathered at Freedom Park in the city Tuesday

My Vote, My Right, which had organised Monday's protest march, welcomed Kharge's decision, but urged the govt to withdraw the 2021 licensing order and restore the "2009 assemblies order" instead. The organisation also questioned Shivakumar over what it saw as a contradiction between his participation in a protest in Delhi and the action against demonstrators in Bengaluru, asking: "One law for you, one law for us — why?"

Road was blocked: Top cop

Activists of Horatada Hakkigagi Janandolana said a protest over a neighbourhood grievance loses its relevance when residents must travel to a central venue to be heard. Bengaluru police commissioner Seemanth Kumar Singh said KR Circle was a heavily congested junction and police had asked protesters to move to Freedom Park. He said the protesters refused to budge and blocked the road, following which, police removed the blockade and made preventive arrests.

Describing the scuffle involving protesters, police and media personnel as unintentional, he said officers had been instructed to exercise utmost caution in dealing with the situation.

CM on Rahul shove: 10-sec video can't tell entire story

Amid BJP's criticism over DK Shivakumar being allegedly pushed aside by Rahul Gandhi during protests in New Delhi Monday, the chief minister dismissed the episode and said that a 10-second video cannot tell the whole story.

Taking to social media, he said: "Rahul Gandhi, out of concern for my safety, advised me to return to the vehicle and be cautious. That is the bond we share — one rooted in trust, affection and family... Let us not lose sight of the real issue: Vote chori and the fight to safeguard every Indian's right to vote."

600 dolls & 365 days of planning Gombe Habba

Jahnavi@timesofindia.com

> After visiting Ayodhya, we decided to arrange our dolls along Ramayana theme this year. We made around 10% of the dolls by hand this time. We decided to focus on wire dolls, which are easier to make in any pose and posture
>
> **Maduri Anandh** | ADMIN OFFICER

Pics: Syed Asif, TOI

IN THE MAKING: Rajajinagar resident Padma B Udayakumar is recreating the sanctum sanctorum of Tirumala in Tirupati and Andal Vaibhavam, celebrating Srivaishnavism; (right) Girinagar resident Maduri Anandh and her mother-in-law are presenting a Ramayana-themed display with around 600 dolls

Bengaluru: A doll sitting upright may not be enough for Bengaluru's Gombe Habba enthusiasts anymore. As elaborate themes become central to annual displays, some families are making and customising dolls to fit the stories they want to tell.

The preparations do not just begin a week or a month before. The plans for next year's Dasara start the previous year itself.

In Girinagar, a mother-in-law and daughter-in-law spent the past year preparing a Ramayana-themed display. "After visiting Ayodhya, we decided to arrange our dolls along the Ramayana theme this year. We are planning to keep around 600 dolls and we have made around 10% of them by hand this year. We have made wire dolls, which are easier to make in any pose and posture," said Maduri Anandh, the daughter-in-law who works as an admin officer for a private company.

The family has been arranging Gombe Habba dolls for 12-13 years, with their collection now including dolls from the UK, US, Japan and Australia. During the 10-day festival, the display occupies almost the entire house.

For Rajajinagar resident Padma B Udayakumar, too, the work begins much earlier than the festival. The 52-year-old has been arranging dolls for over four decades and has won several national and international Gombe Habba contests. This year, she is recreating the sanctum sanctorum of Tirumala in Tirupati and Andal Vaibhavam, celebrating Srivaishnavism. "Andal is one of the saint poetesses," Padma said.

For Padma, the display is also an exercise in documentation. "This has become my identity now, with visitors expecting creativity out of me every year. I even keep my research material in a printed form so that those who come to see the dolls also get to read it," she said.

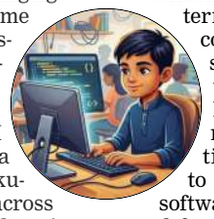
Padma began giving her displays a specific theme after the pandemic. Her earlier themes have included Indian textiles, ancient Indian games and Navadurga puja.

Report: K'taka has lowest school internet coverage in South India

▶ Continued from page 1

The gap is particularly alarming in govt schools. Of the state's 48,527 govt-managed schools, only 18,007 have internet facilities, leaving about 30,520 (63%) without connectivity.

These contrasting figures come at a time when chief minister DK Shivakumar, during his Independence Day, announced the AI Akshara Abhiyana and Coding Gurukula initiatives across Karnataka, aimed at introducing AI education in schools from class 6. Subsequently, the CM said AI training had already begun for class 9 students in govt schools and directed officials to explore extending it to younger students, with support from the information technology department and private organisations. However, the widening infrastructure gap raises questions about how uniformly these initiatives can be implemented across the state.



D Shashi Kumar, general secretary of the Associated Managements of Primary and Secondary Schools in Karnataka (KAMS), pointed out that the digital divide could widen if the number of schools with functional internet connections were considered, as several schools reporting internet access do not have an active connection. "AI education requires access to computers, suitable software, trained teachers and, for many learning applications, reliable internet connectivity. Without these basic facilities, students in poorly connected schools risk being left behind even as their peers gain exposure to emerging technologies. Although govt has pinned its hopes on CSR initiatives, how many schools will these initiatives cover? All these programmes require substantial financial resources. Will govt be able to provide necessary funds?" he asked.

Karnataka's performance is also poor compared with that of its southern neighbours. Andhra Pradesh has internet access in 99.2% of its 60,843 schools, while Tamil Nadu has achieved 99% coverage across 57,566 schools. Kerala reports connectivity in 92.6% of its 15,750 schools. Telangana, despite having a sizeable gap of its own, has internet access in 76.5% of its 41,762 schools. Karnataka, with connectivity in just 51.7% of its schools, has the lowest coverage in South India, the report revealed.

"The proportion of schools without internet connectivity in Karnataka is more than twice that of Telangana, where 23.5% of schools lack access, and over six times the national average of 32.6%," a Bengaluru-based academician said.

Nationally, almost 4.8 lakh of India's 14.7 lakh schools lack internet access, according to the report. Karnataka accounts for approximately 7.5% of the nationwide deficit.

4 land at KIA with 28 gold bars hidden in footwear

Anush.S@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Four passengers arriving from Dubai were arrested by customs officials at Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) Saturday for allegedly attempting to smuggle gold biscuits concealed around their feet and hidden beneath their footwear.

The group, comprising three women and a man from Chennai, allegedly concealed 28 gold bars by wrapping them in black tape and attaching them to the soles of their feet. They were intercepted by customs officials as they were leaving Terminal 2. Officials also seized 13 refurbished mobile phones and eight refurbished laptops. The 28 gold bars weighed 1.6 kg, and the total value of the seized goods was estimated at Rs 2.6 crore.

All four passengers were residents of Vyasarpadi in north Chennai. They allegedly taped the gold bars to the soles of their feet before covering them with footwear. Customs officials identified them based on profiling and intelligence inputs.

The accused were identified as Ramzan Begum Sirajudeen, Nasrin Banu Sirajudeen, Hyrun Fathima Sirajudeen and Asharudeen Chelladurai. All four were arrested under Customs Act, 1962. Officials said Nasrin and Hyrun were siblings and related to Ramzan and Asharudeen.

"The group was not at all cooperative; they did not reveal much details. Each was carrying around 450 to 500 grams of gold, which was stuck to the soles of their feet, and some bars were also found on the trolleys," a senior customs official told **TOI.**

The official added that two other men had travelled with the group but were not booked, as no gold was found in their luggage.

Further investigation is under way into the smuggling network, officials said.

TOI

PRICEY CATCH: The 28 gold bars weighed 1.6kg, and the total value of the seized goods was estimated at Rs 2.6 crore, officials said

Keralam-bound duo held with ₹1.7cr ganja

Bengaluru police arrested two men on charges of smuggling ganja from Odisha to their hometown in Keralam. Accused Vishnu CM and Chan Pasha were driving to Keralam with 317kg of ganja worth over Rs 1.7 crore when they were caught near Kumbalgodu.

Police said the duo had come from Kerala in their car and checked into a hotel at Bommasandra last week. They hired a cab and travelled to Odisha to buy ganja there. After returning to Bommasandra, they placed the ganja packets in their car and left for Keralam.

Doddagubbi area gets new pincode

Times News Network

With Doddagubbi post office in northeast Bengaluru getting upgraded to a delivery post office, the PIN code will change from 560077 to **560120** from Oct 15.

The areas are: Doddagubbi, Chikkagubbi, G Gollahalli, Yarapnahalli, Bande Bommasandra, Bilishivale, H Nagar, Kadagrahara, Angalapura, Kannur, Mitganahalli, Kodusonnapanahalli, Hosur Bande, Bandehosur, Byrathi Bande, Kyalasanahalli, Kanakashree Layout, Greenwood Layout, Laxmi Layout, Maple Green Layout, Mango Meadows Layout, Shubhayog Layout, Mother Theresa Layout, Bhoo Vaibhava Layout, SKMR Layout.

Other areas: SL Garden and KRC Road, Purva Palm Beach, Pride Pegasus, Sattva Northland, Assetz Soul & Soil, Rohan Upavan, Ferns Meadows, Sriram Luxor, Raga Apartment, Casagrand, LG Lake View Layout, Asha Township, Orchid Greens, DS Max Springfield, Diamond Regency Apartments, LG Rose Heritage, Amrutha Vidya Nagar, Bhuvaneshwari Apts, Amazing Grace Apts, Potters Hand Apts, Maniha Township, MIMS Northbrook, Secret Soil by Living Walls, Avila Apts, SKV Diamond Apts, RHBL, Kalya Hara and BSV Raya Apts.

FDA may withdraw order on drug price charts in hospitals, pharmacies

Jahnavi@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Karnataka Food Safety and Drug Administration (FDA) is set to withdraw its order directing hospitals, healthcare institutions and medicine retailers to disclose the landing cost, maximum retail price (MRP) and price charged to patients for medicines and medical devices.

The order, issued earlier this week, will be recalled in a couple of days, a source in FDA said, citing a related case in the Supreme Court. Moreover, the final call on this matter has to be taken by National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority based on its regulations, the source pointed out.

Under the now-scrapped order, hospitals were required to issue itemised bills from Nov 1, listing every medicine, medical device, implant and consumable separately. Each entry had to include the product name, generic and brand names, wherever applicable, batch number, and manufacturing and expiry dates.

The order was issued after officials flagged a huge mismatch in prices between landing costs of medicines and medical devices and the prices at which patients were billed. FDA and health minister UT Khader had also written to NPPA, highlighting these stark differences and calling for greater scrutiny of drug pricing.

The bills were required to specify the base price excluding taxes, the MRP printed on the pack or notified by NPPA, the price charged to the patient and any applicable taxes not already included in the MRP.

Karnataka has been flagging concerns over the wide gap between procurement costs and patient billing prices for the past two months. Khader recently called for a central inter-ministerial expert group and a nationwide study of high-value medicines and medical devices.

Photo for representation

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Tourist buses from Keralam pay ₹30k/mth at Attibele checkpost?

Forum Files Plaint Seeking Investigation

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

The complaint alleges that bus operators transferred between Rs 16,000 and Rs 30,000 every month through UPI to a private intermediary to facilitate the movement of their buses in Karnataka

Bengaluru: Keralam-registered tourist buses allegedly pay monthly bribes of up to Rs 30,000 to cross the Attibele checkpost on Hosur Road and operate in Karnataka without facing enforcement action, according to a complaint alleging a nexus between middlemen and transport department officials.

Karnataka State Travel Operators' Association president S Nataraj Sharma filed a complaint seeking an independent investigation into the suspected involvement of regional transport office (RTO) officials and motor vehicle inspectors in the alleged racket.

The complaint alleges that bus operators transferred between Rs 16,000 and Rs 30,000 every month through UPI to a private intermediary to facilitate the movement of their buses in Karnataka. The allegations reportedly surfaced in the 'Bus Owners of India' WhatsApp group during discussions on all-India tourist permit and alleged harassment by enforcement authorities.

One operator allegedly claimed to have paid Rs 26,000 a month to facilitate the movement of his buses from Attibele towards Devanahalli. He reportedly shared screenshots of the payments and alleged that a woman RTO official in Devanahalli continued to harass operators despite the payments.

Another operator allegedly said he paid around Rs 30,000 per bus every month. According to his claim, buses whose operators refused to pay the intermediary risked being detained and taken to an RTO office, where they could be asked to pay substantial amounts towards taxes and other dues.

A third operator reportedly said he paid around Rs 16,000 a month to cross Attibele border. Sharma alleged that a person identified as Guru, whom he claimed was related to some RTO officials, collected around Rs 30,000 a month from operators through Google Pay, assuring them that they won't have to pay taxes to the state govt.

He further alleged that officials at RTOs, including those in Electronics City and Devanahalli, received Rs 5,000 to Rs 6,000 every month from each operator. Complaints had been submitted to Lokayukta and senior transport department officials, he said.

Transport commissioner R Selvamani said he instructed the additional commissioner to examine the complaint.

Transport operators have previously demanded the removal of checkposts across Karnataka, alleging that they are used to extract money from interstate operators. Truck drivers recently protested against alleged demands for bribes and harassment by RTO officials and police at the Zalki checkpost in Vijayapura district.

Min: Long delays in response time, hence ambulance overhaul

▶Continued from page 1

Under the aegis of Suvarna Karnataka Arogya Kavacha (108) Noukarara Sangha, around 3,500 ambulance staff have placed several demands, including salary revisions, annual increments and improved working conditions, before the state govt and GVK EMRI, the agency that provides the service. Association members said repeated negotiations had failed to yield satisfactory results and that they would suspend services from 10pm on Oct 14.

'Won't encourage blackmailing tactics'

Khader said govt will not attempt to pacify the protesters. "The dispute is between them and the agency, GVK. We do not want to encourage blackmailing tactics. If a patient suffers because of service disruptions, we will take action against GVK," he said.

He also criticised the existing 108 ambulance service over delays in response times. "If someone calls during an emergency, these ambulances take at least 45 minutes to arrive. Recently, I called for an ambulance in Ullal, and it took them 50 minutes to arrive. This is why we need about two months to rectify the system," Khader said. The service was introduced in 2008 and that the state operated its own ambulances before that. "Even now, there are thousands of govt ambulances at district and taluk hospitals. I urge citizens to make use of them in emergencies," he said.

Man kills nephew, 15, in sleep, surrenders

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Soladevanahalli police arrested a man for allegedly murdering his 15-year-old nephew with a machete while he was sleeping.

The accused is **Mohan** and the deceased teenager is M Krishna, a class 10 govt school student. Police said Krishna's father Muniraju alias Murali had died around 12 years back and his mother Puspha abandoned them around 15 years ago. Krishna and his elder brother Yashwanth, a daily-wage worker, lived in a small house in Ivarakandapura near Hesaraghatta in Soladevanahalli.

PROPERTY DISPUTE

Muniraju owned about one acre of ancestral land near Kundana in Devanahalli. Last year, accused Mohan allegedly forged the signatures of Krishna and his brother Yashwanth without their knowledge and sold the land to GK Builders, Yelahanka, read the FIR.

Following this, the elder sister of Muniraju, Pushpa, filed a complaint at Vishwanathapura police station.

When the builders discovered the fraudulent transaction, they transferred payments directly into the bank accounts of Pushpa, Yashwanth and Krishna.

Enraged by this financial settlement, Mohan frequently visited the brothers to pick fights and harass them.

On Monday around 10pm, Mohan went to Krishna's house and hacked him to death with a machete. At the time of the crime, Yashwanth was reportedly away at a cinema hall. After committing the crime, Mohan walked into Vishwanathapura police station Tuesday morning and surrendered.

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tender & notices

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public notice is hereby given that **Evana Foods Private Limited ("EFPL")**, having its registered office at #36, 23rd Block, SBM Colony, Srirampura, 2nd Stage, Vivekanandanagara, Mysuru, Karnataka – 570023, and operating its food and beverage outlet under the brand name "House of Andhra" from Food Court Unit No. 05, Ground Floor, Tower B1, Brigade Tech Gardens, Kundanahalli, Bengaluru ("Premises"), under the Lease Deed dated 12.06.2023 read with the Supplementary Agreement dated 21.03.2024 executed with **Brigade Properties Private Limited ("BPPL")**, has abandoned the Premises and ceased operations without notice or intimation since 03.08.2025.
EFPL has failed to respond despite repeated communications. BPPL has therefore terminated the Lease Deed vide Termination Letter dated 08.09.2026, taken physical possession of the Premises, and removed the belongings found therein to a designated storage space for safe custody, by video recording the inventory and movement.
BPPL has exercised its lien over the said belongings in accordance with the Lease Deed. Failing receipt of any valid claim or objection within 15 days from the date hereof, BPPL shall proceed with appropriate legal action for disposal of the belongings and recovery of its dues.

Brigade Properties Private Limited
Mr. Sunil Munshi
sunil@orionmalls.com
Place: Bengaluru, Date: 14.10.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public notice is hereby given that **Jubilant Foodworks Limited ("JFL")**, having its corporate office at 15th Floor, Tower E, Skymark One, Sector 98, Noida, Uttar Pradesh – 201303, and operating its food and beverage outlet under the brand name "Dunkin" from Kiosk No. 1, opposite Block B1, Brigade Tech Gardens, Kundanahalli, Bengaluru ("Premises"), under the Lease Deed dated 16.02.2024 executed with **Brigade Properties Private Limited ("BPPL")**, has abandoned the Premised and ceased operations without notice or intimation since 30.06.2025.
JFL has failed to respond despite repeated communications. BPPL has therefore terminated the Lease Deed and have taken physical possession of the Premises, and removed the belongings found therein to a designated storage space for safe custody, by video recording the inventory and movement.
BPPL has exercised its lien over the said belongings in accordance with the terms of the Lease Deed. Failing receipt of any valid claim or objection within 15 days from the date hereof, BPPL shall proceed with appropriate legal action for disposal of the belongings and recovery of its dues.

Brigade Properties Private Limited
Mr. Sunil Munshi
sunil@orionmalls.com
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A prominent educational institution intends to engage an experienced computer agency for confidential work relating to OMR scanning and result/data processing. Agencies undertaking such work may express their interest by email at **confidentials.office@bseh.org.in** by 18.10.2026

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I, MICHAEL FALERIA S/o late Manuel Falera, resident of D-11, Bearys Anugraha Apartments, 3rd A Main Road, KSFC Layout, Lingarajapuram, Bengaluru North, Karnataka - 560084, have changed my Name from MICHAEL FALERIA to MICHAEL MANUEL FALERA vide Maharashtra Government Gazette Part II (From 31-03-2022 to 06-03-2022) Registration No M-21201251 page 273 and Affidavit dated 24-9-2026 sworn before XXXVIII Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bengaluru City at Bengaluru. MICHAEL MANUEL FALERA and MICHAEL FALERIA both are same and one identical person.

I, ROSELINE JOYCE FALERA spouse of MICHAEL MANUEL FALERA resident of D-11, Bearys Anugraha Apartments, 3rd A Main Road, KSFC Layout, Lingarajapuram, Bengaluru North, Karnataka - 560084, have changed my Name from ROSELINE JOYCE FALERA to ROSELINE FALERA vide Affidavit no. 690/2026 dated 24-9-2026 sworn before XXXVIII Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bengaluru City at Bengaluru. ROSELINE FALERA and ROSELINE JOYCE FALERA both are same and one identical person.

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I, Rohit Adolphus Rego S/o Cedric Rego, resident of D-11, Bearys Anugraha Apartments, 3rd A Main Road, KSFC Layout, Lingarajapuram, Bangalore North, Karnataka 560084 do hereby declare that I have changed my name from Rohit Adolphus Rego to Rohit Rego and henceforth I shall be known as Rohit Rego in all purpose, vide affidavit no. IN-KA07086877863416Y sworn before the Notary Public at Bangalore on 30th Sep 2026 Rohit Rego and Rohit Adolphus Rego both are same and one identical person.

I, PRALHAD NARAYAN GUDI, S/o NARAYAN KRISHNACHARYA GUDI, residing at A 108, Ihita South AVENUE,No 70, 2nd Cross,12th Main, Uttarahalli Main road, Bangalore -560061, do hereby declare that I have changed my old name Pralhad Narayan Gudi to Prahlad Narayan GUDI vide Affidavit No.IN-KA18975321886366Y signed and sworn before Notary S N Madhu dt. 10th July 2026.

I, Mohd Moulali, S/o Mohd Azam, residing at No. 32, 1st Cross Rd, Basavalingappa Nagar, Sampigehalli, Hegde Nagar, Bangalore - 560064, declare that my name and DOB were wrongly mentioned as Shaik Moulali and 10/09/1961 in my old Passport No. H1846023. My correct name is Mohd Moulali and correct DOB is 08/10/1964, vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 sworn before notary S.R. Nanjunda Swamy, Bengaluru.

I, (Old Name) Vijay Kumar Yadava, No. 15685964N, Rank: Hav, Son of Laxmi Narayan Yadav, permanently residing at, Village- Majira, Post- Munari, Tehsil- Pindra, District- Varanasi, State- Uttar Pradesh, PIN - 221104, have changed my name from (Old Name) Vijay Kumar Yadava to (New Name) Vijay Kumar Yadav vide affidavit dated 09.10.2026 sworn before Judicial Magistrate First Class Traffic Court-1 Bangalore.

I, SHWETA ARUN JOG, d/o Arun Jog, R/o GRC SHREEKRISH, CHOODASANDRA 560099, Bengaluru, declare that my name appears as SHWETA JOG in my matriculation marksheet and as SHWETA ARUN JOG in Aadhaar and PAN cards. Both refer to the same person. MY FATHER'S CORRECT NAME IS ARUN JOG.

I, Karthik Mahalingam Raman, S/o Mahalingam Anantha Raman, residing at 103, Vars Jacaranda, Fern City Road, Doddanakundi, Karnataka – 560037, hereby declare that I have changed my name from Karthik Raman to Karthik Mahalingam Raman, vide affidavit dated 12-10-2026, sworn before J.Anand Kumar, Advocate & Notary, Bengaluru.

I, Dastagir, aged 46 years, son of Mohammed Sabjan & Shataj Begum, r/s at 3/10, 4th Cross, Nr. Venkateshwara School, Gangondanahalli, Nayandahalli, Bengaluru-560039, have changed my name to MOHAMMED DASTHAGIR vide affidavit dated 25-09-2026 before notary H S Sakalesh Aradhya.

I , I Gowtham Jain S/O J Inderchand, R/O Symbiosis Mahaveer Flat No. GFC #59, 5TH main road 6TH cross Opp to Amar Nursing Home Chamrajpet Bangalore , have changed my name to I Goutam Chand.

I Anusree P P W/O, Baiju G Bhaskar R/o #43, 4th Main, 1st Cross, Muthyalanagar, Gokul Extn, Bangalore - 560054. have changed my name to Anusree Baiju.

EVENTS AND EXHIBITIONS
TIMES interact

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Kumaraswamy demands CBI probe into sting ops, plans to meet Shah

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Union minister and JD(S) state president HD Kumaraswamy Tuesday demanded a CBI probe into alleged sting operations targeting political figures and their families in Karnataka and said he would soon meet Union home minister Amit Shah with a formal complaint.

He said an investigation should establish who masterminded the operations, who carried them out and what roles various individuals played. Those found guilty should be penalised, he said.

On former CM Siddaramaiah seeking an injunction in an alleged sting case, Kumaraswamy urged him "to stand firm" instead of seeking orders to restrain proceedings, and to speak as forcefully as he did in his earlier struggles. He also appealed to Ahinda functionaries to oppose such practices, warning that silence could have consequences.

Kumaraswamy also cited a complaint filed on Oct 9 by Bengaluru Nijada Horatagarara Vedike with Chief Justice of Karnataka high court, juvenile justice committee and Karnataka State Legal Services Authority officials.

It alleged that a 14-year-old girl, now an adult, was influenced to take part in a sting operation. This should also be examined, Kumaraswamy said.

Justifying his demand for a CBI probe, Kumaraswamy said the truth should emerge through constitutional and judicial institutions, and everyone should abide by court verdicts. He said his own family had faced similar difficulties but had not sought court protection, adding that even his mother, who had devoted her life to religious observances, was not spared.

"Earlier, a sting operation was conducted against a former CM. Then Ramesh Jarkiholi was finished off, followed by KN Rajanna, who belongs to the same community," he alleged. "Rajanna had said that a functionary of our party was running a CD factory, but he was subsequently silenced. Now it is Siddaramaiah's turn."

Kumaraswamy also asked why references to Prajwal Revanna's alleged incidents in Parappana Agrahara prison surfaced whenever the Bidadi farmers' agitation and BMIC-NICE project issues came up. "What had officials done for one-and-a-half years, and who ordered Prajwal's transfer to Hindalga prison in Belagavi and who made the calls?" he asked.

File pictures

TRUTH TEST: HD Kumaraswamy urged Siddaramaiah (right) to "stand firm" instead of trying to restrain proceedings

READY TO SUBMIT DOCUMENTS: DKS

CM DK Shivakumar took a sarcastic swipe at Union minister HD Kumaraswamy, saying he had "drawn the state's attention to a good issue", while dismissing the former CM's allegation that he was behind a sting operation targeting his cabinet colleagues. Shivakumar said these allegations "would be answered in time" and challenged Kumaraswamy to submit evidence he claimed to possess for investigation. to a good issue", while dismissing the former CM's allegation that he was behind a sting operation targeting his cabinet colleagues. Shivakumar said these allegations "would be answered in time" and challenged Kumaraswamy to submit evidence he claimed to

SURVEILLANCE AT DKS' HOUSE

Union minister HD Kumaraswamy alleged that after becoming CM, DK Shivakumar hired four retired police officers to gather information on discussions among ministers and others using "advanced equipment" at his Sadashivanagar residence. He said the alleged surveillance had become a topic of discussion within the police department and called for a CBI probe to establish facts. He insisted that he was not accusing Shivakumar of personally ordering the surveillance. Asked whether his phone had been tapped, Kumaraswamy said he had nothing to conceal and spoke openly about everything.

Central govt proposes panel as cane farmers' fury grows

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Sugarcane farmers blocked national highways at several places in north Karnataka Tuesday, demanding better cane prices and implementation of the Swaminathan Commission's recommendations. The Centre, meanwhile, promised a joint committee and asked the state govt to introduce a state-advised price (SAP).

Protests were reported in Belagavi, Bagalkot, Vijayapura and Dharwad, affecting traffic on the Pune-Bengaluru highway and NH 50 near Nidagundi. Near Hattargi toll plaza in Hukkeri taluk, farmers blocked both carriageways, with some lying on the road to prevent vehicles from passing. They said the stir would continue as Monday's talks with Union ministers in Delhi "brought no immediate decision on prices".

Farmers are seeking a higher MSP, determination of FRP and implementation of the National Commission on Farmers report, chaired by Prof MS Swaminathan and set up in 2004 as a blueprint for structural reforms in agriculture.

Meanwhile, Union food minister Pralhad Joshi rejected claims that the Delhi meeting had failed and appealed to farmers to withdraw the agitation. He said it was the first time the Centre had invited cane growers to Delhi, and discussions with farmers from Karnataka and Maharashtra were "constructive". Agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, secretaries, three state ministers and farmer representatives attended.

"Modi govt is with you," Joshi said. "But this cannot be done by one or two ministries alone. Several ministries are involved, and all state govts have a role to play. Before determining prices, we obtain information from state govts. The govt will soon have good news for cane growers, so there is no need to blockade roads."

Joshi said Tamil Nadu, Haryana, Punjab and Uttar Pradesh have already implemented SAP and Karnataka has been urged to follow suit. The Centre also asked the state to act against mills on sugar recovery rates, the 9% wastage deduction and discrepancies in weighing.

Chief minister DK Shivakumar, who spoke to Joshi Monday night in New Delhi, said the issue needed consultations with other states. "Farmers want a higher price for their cane. We discussed their situation and the condition of factories. This is not an issue confined to our state. They have said they will speak to everyone and arrive at a decision," he said.

TOI

SOUR STORY: Sugarcane farmers protested by blocking traffic at Hattaragi toll plaza in Hukkeri taluk on Tuesday

STUDY TO ENSURE FAIR RETURNS

The state will conduct a 'scientific study' to ensure fair returns for sugarcane farmers by improving transparency in cane weighing, sugar recovery, harvesting practices and payments, sugar and textiles minister Rudrappa Lamani said. The study will assess optimal harvesting periods and regional recovery rates, with findings submitted to a proposed joint committee of the Centre. The state will also examine govt-supervised weighbridges, waste deductions and alternative pricing models, including the state-advised price, to improve transparency and ensure predictable returns for farmers.

Khajane upgrade put off over steep costs

Sandeep.Moudgal
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: The govt has put on hold its plan to upgrade its integrated financial management system (IFMS) to Khajane 3, apparently because of the heavy cost of overhauling the existing platform and doubts over value for money.

Proposed in 2023, the proposal to upgrade Khajane 2 (K2) was reiterated in the finance department's annual report for 2025-26 "to enable the govt reap the transformative potential of e-financial system platform".

The proposed system would go beyond process re-engineering to "leverage potential of emerging new technologies", it added.

Committee formed

A roadmap committee headed by the finance secretary (budget and resources) was formed in 2023 to study the current framework and recommend administrative, technical and procedural changes, along with an action plan to improve technology and processes. However, officials say Khajane 3.0 is not an immediate need and is now being viewed as a "long-term goal".

Ritesh Kumar Singh, additional chief secretary (finance), told TOI the project remains in the pipeline, but the govt believes there is still "some juice" left in K2. "For now, we are working on adding more modules to the existing platform to improve its functionality," he said. "Almost every year, 10 to 15 new modules are added."

Khajane, meaning treasury in Kannada, was introduced in 2001, when computerisation of public administration was still at an early stage. K2 followed in 2009, making the system web-based and accessible online for internal govt operations. It was revamped in 2015 with a friendlier interface for citizen-facing transactions as online services expanded.

K2 now handles a wide range of govt transactions, from stamp duty and property registration payments to traffic fines and property tax penalties.

AI

Proposed in 2023, officials now say Khajane 3.0 is not an immediate need and is being viewed as a "long-term goal"

STARTUP POLICY PLANNED TO BOOST TOURISM

Tourism department will formulate a startup promotion policy to leverage the state's startup ecosystem to develop innovative tourism solutions, minister KJ George said. The policy will identify sector-specific challenges and invite startups to develop solutions in visitor experience, digital services, destination management, safety, mobility and sustainable tourism. Tourism department secretary Ram Prasath Manohar said select solutions could be tested at identified destinations, evaluated and scaled up if successful. The initiative aims to help startups access real-world testing opportunities while improving tourism services and management.

SHORT TAKES

Induct 25 Congress MLAs now, Shivakumar challenges Vijayendra

Responding to BJP state president **BY Vijayendra**'s claim that 25 Congress MLAs, including ministers, would join the saffron party if elections were held now, chief minister DK Shivakumar challenged him to induct them immediately. Speaking in New Delhi, Shivakumar pointed out that it was BJP and JD(S) legislators who had cross-voted in the June MLC elections and that the brass of the two parties were yet to identify those involved. Vijayendra had claimed the political mood favoured BJP and that Congress was facing heavy anti-incumbency.

BJP ridicules DKS over Delhi shove

Opposition BJP criticised Congress after chief minister DK Shivakumar was elbowed away by security personnel guarding Rahul Gandhi during INDIA bloc's protest march in New Delhi Monday. BJP mocked Shivakumar, alleging "humiliation" by Congress central brass. Karnataka BJP president BY Vijayendra said any insult to a Kannadiga occupying the CM's chair concerned the state's pride. Deputy CM G Parameshwara said crowd management was challenging and security personnel prioritised Rahul's protection, adding Shivakumar was pushed by the crowd.

Roadmap for disaster preparedness

Deputy CM G Parameshwara set a 2030 target for Karnataka to become a national leader in disaster prevention and preparedness. Inaugurating State Platform for Disaster Risk Reduction, he called for stronger early warning systems, resilient infrastructure and coordinated action across departments. He stressed the use of AI, satellite imagery and predictive analytics to identify risks and alert vulnerable communities. Karnataka State Disaster Risk Reduction Roadmap 2025-2030, he said, must deliver measurable outcomes through time-bound implementation, monitoring and livelihood protection.

Overseas offices to attract investment

Karnataka is exploring ways to set up Invest Karnataka Forum (IKF) offices in the US, Japan, Taiwan, South Korea and France to attract industrial investment, industries minister MB Patil said. The proposal was discussed at an IKF board meeting at Khanija Bhavan, where officials were asked to assess its merits and submit a report. Patil said Karnataka must engage investors in their home countries amid growing competition among states. The initiative will focus on priority sectors, including semiconductors and defence.

ADGP Ravi opts for voluntary retirement

Additional director general of police **S Ravi**, who served as head of state intelligence during Siddaramaiah's second tenure as CM, has opted for voluntary retirement due to "personal reasons". He is due to retire in May 2027. A 1998 batch IPS officer, Ravi presented his VRS papers to DG-IGP MA Saleem last Friday. "He has applied for leave till the first week of Jan. If the govt accepts his resignation, it will be applicable only after that," a source said.

Enhanced quota: Cabinet to weigh legal options

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Deputy chief minister **G Parameshwara** Tuesday said the cabinet would discuss the Karnataka high court order striking down enhanced reservation for Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs) and decide whether to challenge it in Supreme Court.

He said govt will examine all legally permissible options in consultation with the advocate general and the law department.

HC on Monday struck down provisions of a 2022 law that increased reservation for SCs from 15% to 17% and for STs from 3% to 7%, taking the overall quota to 56%. The court held that the enhanced reservation breached the 50% ceiling laid down by Supreme Court in the Indra Sawhney case.

Parameshwara said the previous BJP govt headed by Basavaraj Bommai had introduced the revised quota, which the present Congress govt had also followed in recruitment processes. He said the state defended the enhanced reservation when it was challenged in court.

On a personal note, Parameshwara said the court should have considered Karnataka's social conditions as an exception and cited Tamil Nadu's 69% reservation, protected through a constitutional arrangement. He said the state will examine the verdict's implications for existing appointments, admissions and future recruitment.

Responding to BJP allegations of negligence, he said govt could not influence judicial decisions. Any reduction in the overall quota could also require changes to internal reservation percentages, potentially affecting opportunities for different communities, he added.

HC upholds GP move to cancel OCs for 33 villas

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: The high court has upheld the decision of Samethanahalli gram panchayat in Hosakote taluk of Bengaluru Rural district to revoke occupancy certificates issued for 33 villas in Raffles Park project by Raffles Residency Pvt Ltd.

The villas were incomplete and unfit for occupation when occupancy certificates (OCs) were issued. The certificates were granted without complying with statutory requirements, including site inspection, verification of construction against the sanctioned plan and obtaining the requisite technical opinion, Justice Suraj Govindaraj noted.

The gram panchayat and the principal secretary of rural development and panchayat raj department have been directed to complete the inquiry ordered on July 7, 2025, into the role of then panchayat development officer C Muniraju and other officials responsible for processing and issuing the OCs.

The judge directed that compliance be reported within three months.

Justice Govindaraj also noted that an inspection conducted pursuant to the court's directions had revealed several deviations, including the location of the sewage treatment plant, encroachment on a rajakaluve, incomplete internal roads and inadequate maintenance of the diesel generator.

However, the cancellation of OCs should not, by itself, be construed as a determination by the court on whether the project qualifies as an "ongoing project" under Real Estate (Regulation and Development) Act, 2016. That question remains to be decided by Rera during the pending proceedings, the judge clarified.

The court observed that the completion certificate issued by the project's architects, M/s Karan Grover and Associates, did not reflect the actual condition of the development, certifying an incomplete project as complete.

Hobbyist seeks return of seized African grey parrot, court orders notice to dept

Bengaluru: The high court Tuesday ordered notice to the forest department in response to a petition by a resident, R Mahesh Kumar, seeking return of his pet African grey parrot and quashing of proceedings initiated under Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972.

The petitioner, who claims to be a hobbyist, has stated that an acquaintance gave him the parrot in 2018, when it was about three years old. According to him, the bird cannot fly normally as one of its wings is ineffective. Kumar added he was looking after the bird, spending Rs 6,000 to Rs 10,000 a month. CID forest cell took physical possession of the bird on July 27, 2026, and the same day, Kumar was served a notice under BNSS Section 35(3). On July 31, 2026, the authorities invoked relevant provisions of Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972. TNN

Officer pulled up for making land owner, 102, wait for justice

Bengaluru: A 102-year-old landowner was forced to approach Karnataka high court to get officials to act on his plea for enhanced compensation for land acquired to build an alternative road to Kempegowda International Airport.

Pulling up the special land acquisition officer (SLAO) for failing to discharge his statutory duties and comply with a court order, the high court has directed the officer to pay Rs 1 lakh in compensation to B Ramaiah of Bettakote village in Devanahalli taluk.

In an order dated Aug 31, Justice R Nataraj directed the SLAO of Doddaballapura subdivision to refer Ramaiah's claim for enhanced compensation to the competent court within one month.

Ramaiah alleged that although the authorities had notified the acquisition of 28 guntas of land, they took possession of 29 guntas to construct an alternative road connecting Bettakote village to the airport.

He contended that, instead of following the procedure prescribed under Sections 9 and 10 of Land Acquisition Act-1894, the SLAO determined compensation at just Rs 4.2 lakh for the 29 guntas. He also alleged that officials had damaged the stone slabs he installed around his property.

Dissatisfied with the compensation, Ramaiah sought Rs 18.5 lakh and repeatedly approached the SLAO. However, his representations went unheeded, forcing the centenarian to seek the high court's intervention. TNN

IAS officer questioned cops when they asked for age proof from girls

▶ Continued from page 1

First, Vikas, saying he was an IAS officer, asked what rights we had to ask the girls to produce age documents. We replied stating this was part of a special drive against pubs and bars that serve liquor to minors. Then, Vikas asked under whose direction we were doing it. We replied that our police commissioner has directed it. Then, Vikas asked what's our jurisdiction limit. We replied CCB covers the entire city. At this, Vikas became furious, saying no such powers have been given to police, where one branch can act anywhere in the city like Bengaluru. By then, he abused us. When we resisted, Abhay Uday Singh pushed and attacked us," a cop present at the scene told **TOI**.

Nitish and Roshan too allegedly abused and pushed other cops, asking them to go out. Vikas allegedly hurled expletives at the cops, which was videographed and the same went viral online Tuesday. Soon, more police force reached the place and all four men were taken to Cubbon Park police station.

Police inspector Arun Salunke registered the FIR stating the four allegedly picked up an altercation, abused and attacked the cops on duty.

Accordingly, police registered a case against Vikas, Abhay, Nitish and Roshan for criminal intimidation, assault on a public servant to prevent them from discharging their duties and use of criminal force to dishonour a person.

AP CM Naidu orders probe

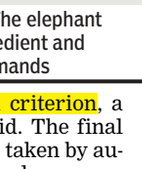
Following demands by YSRCP, Andhra Pradesh chief minister Nara Chandrababu Naidu has directed the chief secretary to submit a detailed report on the incident. The CM's office is said to have taken serious note of the incident and is reportedly reviewing the matter for potential disciplinary action.

Ex-CM: Hidden camera, politically loaded caption suggest intent to damage dignity

▶ Continued from page 1

The plaint states that the first video was uploaded on Sept 27 under the title 'Karnataka honey trap nexus part 1'.

The second was an hour-long programme streamed by a Kannada YouTube channel on Oct 2 under the title 'Biggest CD blast in Karnataka politics?'



Leader of the opposition in the legislative assembly, R Ashoka, alleged Congress had betrayed Siddaramaiah, leaving him with no option but to seek judicial relief.

Ashoka further demanded immediate registration of an FIR over the alleged sting operation and the video clips circulating online.

Siddaramaiah said while he always supported freedom of expression and never obstructed the media, the freedom was misused by certain outlets to malign his reputation.

"The extraordinary delay, the manner of questioning, the hidden-camera presentation and the politically loaded caption, followed by sudden digital publication, disclose a calculated and malicious design to cause maximum injury to the reputation and political standing," Siddaramaiah's suit said.

As on Oct 4, video got 3.2L views, states Siddaramaiah's plaint

It was further submitted that as on Oct 4, 2026, the videos had garnered approximately 3.2 lakh views online on YouTube.

"If the impugned materials, alleged objectionable videos are shared, circulated, published in the social media, print media, digital platform, TV will definitely cause immense damages to the dignity, status, position and reputation of the plaintiff in the public image and privacy of the plaintiff, which cannot be compensated in terms of money," B Pushpanjali, the 19th Additional City Civil and Sessions Judge, further observed in her order.

Mysuru Dasara: Will 5,100kg Prashantha make the cut?

Milton.Lawrence
@timesofindia.com

With Mahendra failing the endurance test, Karnataka forest officials must now choose the Mysuru Dasara golden howdah elephant from the remaining contenders. Prashantha, 54, a seasoned participant for over 18 years, is among the frontrunners.

A tusker at Dubare elephant camp, Prashantha is handled by mahouts JA Chinnappa and Kavadi Chandru. Captured in Karekoppa forest area in 1993, he weighs 5,100kg.

Five elephants were initially shortlisted, but Mahendra was ruled out after failing during rehearsals. The remaining four performed well in cannon-fire tests, wooden-howdah rehearsals and regular exercises, besides gaining weight — a key selection criterion, a govt official said. The final decision will be taken by authorities in Bengaluru.

With Dhananjaya assigned to carry the golden howdah at Srirangapatna Dasara, established practice rules him out of the Mysuru event. The final contenders are now Prashantha, Ekalavya and Gopi.

DN Nagaraj, a former veterinarian who led Arjuna, Balarama and Abhimanyu as lead elephants in the Dasara procession for nearly two decades, said selection involves assessing physical build, gait, emotional steadiness, endurance, obedience and temperament.

The golden howdah, cushion, decorative clothes and other items weigh around 1,000kg. The lead elephant must carry this load for over two hours during the procession. The 5km route from Mysuru Palace to Banni Mantap Parade Grounds takes 70-80 minutes to cover.

TOI

A tusker at Dubare elephant camp in Kodagu, Prashantha is handled by mahouts JA Chinnappa and Kavadi Chandru

CHOOSING RIGHT HOWDAH ELEPHANT

PHYSICAL FITNESS: Well-built, must be able to bear the weight of the heavy howdah and other decoratives weighing around 1,000kg

ENDURANCE: The animal must withstand long hours of walking while carrying the load

TEMPERAMENT: Composure amid crowds and noise; must remain calm during cannon-fire tests

TRAINING: The elephant must be obedient and follow commands

DURATION AND DISTANCE: Elephant carries the load for more than 2 hours across a 5-km stretch from Mysuru Palace to Banni Mantap Parade Grounds

AGE RESTRICTION: Karnataka high court directed that elephants aged 60 and above must not be assigned physically demanding tasks

FINAL SELECTION: Forest officials assess the contenders. The final decision is taken by authorities in Bengaluru

TIMES NATION

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

KERALAM GOVT MULLS SPECIAL LAW FOR FATAL CRASHES INVOLVING DRUNK DRIVERS, SAYS MINISTER

UNION ENVIRONMENT MINISTER BHUPENDER YADAV REVIEWS POLLUTION CONTROL MEASURES IN NATIONAL CAPITAL

YOU SAID IT

Kid 'thrown off' Gujarat building

A two-year-old girl died Monday after falling from the fifth floor of a residential building in Rajkot, reports Nimesh Khakhariya. Snehal Sakariya left the flat to play at 7pm. Minutes later, neighbours told the family she had fallen. Police said the parapet wall is four feet high, while Snehal was only three feet tall. Her body was found six feet away from the building's base, leading cops to suspect she was picked up and thrown.

Cop kills dhaba worker over alcohol tiff

A 38-year-old head constable allegedly shot a dhaba worker twice after the latter objected to him drinking outside the eatery in Agra on Oct 9, reports **Sudeep Lavania**.

The victim died during treatment the next day. Jackie Singh Chaudhary, who joined the police force in 2011 and was posted in Prayagraj, was arrested Tuesday.

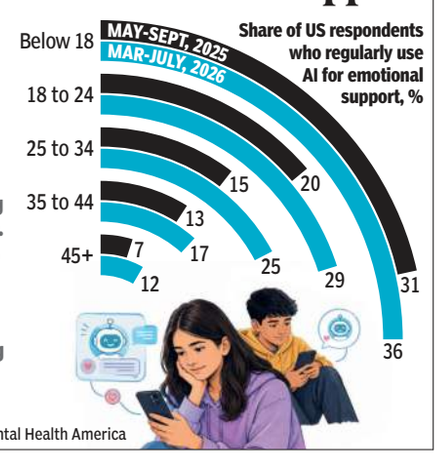
During interrogation, Chaudhary allegedly admitted he and his friends had been drinking near the dhaba when Bittu Lavania objected, triggering an argument. ADCP Agra Manoj Kumar Yadav said, "Angered by the altercation, he went home, collected his pistol and returned on a motorcycle. He then fired at Bittu. When he did not die, Chaudhary fired at him again."

Police sources told **TOI** Chaudhary had in 2012 faced an abetment-to-suicide case following a woman's death in Gujarat.

STATOISTICS A slice of life in numbers

Over 1 in 3 young Americans turn to AI for emotional support

AI use for emotional support has risen across all age groups in the US, but remains more common among younger people. Usage declines with age, with just 12% of those aged 45 and above using it in 2026



Source: Statista, Mental Health America

4 FIRs over INDIA bloc protest; 4 over disinfo campaign online

Barricades Were Broken, Roads Defaced

Abhay@timesofindia.com

PTI

Rahul Gandhi greets AISA president Neha Bora during high tea in New Delhi on Tuesday

New Delhi: Delhi Police have registered four FIRs in connection with INDIA bloc's protest on Monday, allegedly over violation of prohibitory orders clamped in the area. Police sources said the cases pertained to alleged breaking of barricades and defacement of public roads with graffiti.

Two of these FIRs were registered at Tilak Marg police station, while Mandir Marg and Barakhamba Road police stations have registered one FIR each.

Another four FIRs have been registered by Delhi Police over an alleged disinformation campaign, with investigators suspecting Pakistan-based social media handles of attempting to exploit the ongoing protests to spread anti-India narratives and to disturb communal harmony in the country. They have also written to social media platforms seeking the removal of around 500 pieces of objectionable and misleading content.

Sources said intelligence agencies and police have found several social media accounts allegedly operated from across the border have been circulating old and edited videos of riots and violent incidents, falsely portraying them as footage of recent protests in Delhi. On Oct 10, several social media handles circulated claims that widespread violence had erupted during the demonstrations in Delhi. An X handle claimed Tuesday that the Army had been deployed in Delhi and markets shut down. Delhi Police responded, saying the video "is out of context and has nothing to do with current events".

On the INDIA bloc protest on Monday, police said prohibitory orders under Section 163 of Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita were in force at the time, making the gathering unauthorised. Police said the restrictions were imposed to prevent unauthorised assemblies and maintain law and order in the area.

Led by leader of opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, top functionaries of the INDIA bloc and supporters had gathered at Barakhamba Road and marched to Supreme Court where a petition was filed. Thousands of people turned out on the roads between Connaught Place and Supreme Court, waving flags and shouting slogans demanding the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar and a halt to the SIR process. On Bhagwan Das Road, many climbed onto a parked police vehicles and cheered as the INDIA bloc politicians waved at them.

INDIA challenges SIR process in SC but not its validity

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New Delhi: Why did opposition INDIA bloc, after making SIR the central point of its attack on Election Commission and govt, give up the challenge to the constitutional and statutory validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in their joint petition before Supreme Court?

Opposition members led by Rahul Gandhi stated in the petition that they were not challenging SIR's validity in view of SC judgment on Bihar SIR, which was conducted by EC based on its June 24, 2025, decision.

That could be because SC in its May 27 judgment had examined the following questions — whether EC had the power to conduct SIR, whether SIR had a legitimate purpose and the process was proportionate to the object to be achieved, and whether the SIR procedure was contrary to Representation of the People (RP) Act and Registration of Electors Act, 1960 — and found there was nothing amiss in SIR's conduct or the process adopted to achieve the objective of weeding out voters who have died, shifted base or duplicate voters.

SC had categorically ruled that SIR exercise "neither stands in direct conflict with RP Act and the 1960 Rules, nor does it detract from the constitutional imperative of free and fair elections".

Importantly, it had said, "The impugned SIR exercise, as conducted, satisfies requirements of proportionality. The measures adopted bear a rational nexus to the objective sought to be achieved, are not manifestly excessive, and are accompanied by sufficient procedural safeguards to prevent arbitrary exclusion."

Since the judgment was of May 27 and attained finality as no one sought its review or correction, the INDIA bloc petitioners could not have challenged SIR's validity, thus limiting their challenge to alleged irregularities in the process of SIR and large-scale deletion of voters without giving them proper opportunity to rebut deletion.

SC in its five-month-old judgment had said, "The statutory framework of RP Act itself provides for a situation where the commission may direct a special revision under Section 21(3), in such manner as it may think fit and for reasons to be recorded."

It said "a reading of the impugned order, dated June 24, 2025, reveals that EC has recorded the basis on which it decided to conduct SIR." "We are equally satisfied that, in its object and design, SIR bears a direct nexus to the constitutional goal of a free and fair election. Free and fair elections do not rest merely upon the mechanics of polling. They equally depend upon the integrity, accuracy and purity of the electoral roll which forms the foundation of the democratic process," it had said.

Oppn slams govt over Jantar Mantar denotification, vows to continue fight

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: A day after its Supreme Court march, the united opposition Tuesday lashed out at Modi govt for denotifying Jantar Mantar as a protest site, accusing it of hatching a conspiracy to push protests to Delhi's fringes. The opposition vowed that the fight to "restore democracy" will continue, while warning that farmer and worker organisations will join the agitation soon.

"We have extreme respect for SC, CJI and judicial system. They have a role to play, we hope they will play that role. But we are political people. Irrespective of what happens, which institution plays a role or not, people's resistance will continue," leader of opposition in LS Rahul Gandhi said.

At a tea hosted by Rahul for INDIA bloc members, they are learnt to have argued that they should challenge govt's 'Jantar-Mantar-not-for-protest' decision. They termed it a "vindictive" step.

Elated over the turnout for SC march, it was felt the momentum should be sustained, though specific plans were not spelt out, especially in view of the festive season. In the informal discussion, it was decided to keep political organisations on "alert mode" for quick agitational action. Besides the scheduled Nov 1 rally, there could be improvised programmes like a mock parliament to remove the CEC.

Rahul said govt has decided that Jantar Mantar can no longer be used to express feelings for democracy. "We will challenge that idea, and it won't be so simple for govt to decide that Indians will not fight for their voice," he added.

Voters deleted from rolls on suspicion, alleges Lavasa

Kolkata: Former election commissioner Ashok Lavasa accused EC of removing voters from electoral rolls on suspicion rather than evidence, alleging electoral registration officers (EROs), the only officials authorised to delete names, were denied access to the centrally controlled ECINET system during the special intensive revision, reports **Subhajoy Roy**.

Addressing a citizens' convention online Tuesday, Lavasa said EC had shifted its priority from including eligible voters to weeding out those it considered ineligible, calling the denial of access to EROs illegal.

He said appeals against ERO decisions could normally be taken to district election officers or the chief electoral officer. Lavasa cited EC figures submitted to the Supreme Court showing 38.3 lakh appeals before tribunals, of which close to 1.3 lakh had been decided. Of the total, 22.2 lakh appeals were against voter deletions and 16.1 lakh against inclusions. Actor Prakash Raj accused Modi govt of benefiting from chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, alleging that Centre's efforts to protect him showed how EC had helped it politically.

SC seeks presence of senior Delhi Police officer to respond to 'sexual harassment' of women scribes

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New Delhi: Taking cognisance of allegations that women journalists were sexually harassed by police while covering the Oct 10 protest for the resignation of CEC Gyanesh Kumar, Supreme Court Tuesday asked Delhi Police to depute a senior officer to the court on Thursday to respond to the charges.

Senior advocate Indira Jaising said that 'Network of Women in Media' has filed a petition narrating the incidents of sexual harassment of women reporters during the anti-SIR protest on Saturday. When Jaising said she has already served an advance copy of the petition on solicitor general Tushar Mehta, who is representing Delhi Police, a bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said, "We would like some senior police officer to remain present in the court to explain and assist the court."

TOI

Women journalists were allegedly sexually harassed by police on Saturday

The day also saw senior advocate Gaurav Bhatia and Mahesh Jethmalani mentioning a petition seeking initiation of criminal contempt action against political leaders for storming SC on Monday evening and obstructing access to SC's petition filing counter, thus blocking the access to justice. The reference was clearly to leader of opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA bloc members who were part of a procession to SC on Monday.

Bhatia and Jethmalani sought a ban on political activity inside the court's premises and preservation of CCTV footage of Monday evening.

More journalists, senior advocate G Sankaranarayanan said, have filed contempt petitions and a writ petition related to the protest. SC had directed that professional activities of lawyers, journalists and other professionals would not be hindered.

Oppn has no reach in hinterland: Shah

▶ Continued from page 1

Shah's sharp comments came after BJP notched up another facile win in three local body polls in Gujarat, leaving Congress far behind. AAP lost deposits in all 32 seats it contested in Gandhinagar Municipal Corporation, he noted.

This win coupled with BJP and its allies' similar impressive show in local body elections in Tripura and Rajasthan, besides in the recent assembly and Lok Sabha bypolls, demonstrated people of the country are standing with PM Narendra Modi, BJP, and NDA like a rock, Shah said.

"These elections are a lesson for Rahul Gandhi... You (Rahul) cannot win the confidence of people by fabricated media events, 'jhooth ki goonj'," Shah said, riffing on Rahul's "Chhatron ki Goonj" outreach to students in different cities. Mocking the opposition's march in Delhi on Monday, he said Rahul cannot become the voice of the people by mobilising cadres of 14 parties to collect a crowd of 8,000 through a distance of 1.5km. They have no reach in the vast hinterland, he added.

Man gets 5 yrs jail for crimes committed as a juvenile

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Agra: An Aligarh court sentenced a 23-year-old man to five years of rigorous imprisonment and imposed a fine of Rs 10,000 under the Uttar Pradesh Gangsters and Anti-Social Activities (Prevention) Act in a case filed in 2020, when he was a juvenile.

The prosecution accused him of belonging to a gang involved in extortion, kidnapping, murder and land grabbing. The Juvenile Justice Board had determined his age as 16 years, nine months and 29 days in Jan 2022. Additional district judge Abhishek Kumar Bagaria pronounced the sentence after hearing arguments on the seriousness of organised crime and the defence's plea for leniency on account of the convict's age.

Special public prosecutor Raghuvansh Sharma said on Tuesday that Delhi Gate police in Aligarh had registered the case under sections 2 and 3 of the Gangsters Act in 2020. The prosecution identified the convict as a member of a gang led by Gagan Gupta, which allegedly committed offences for financial and other gains.

The prosecution alleged that the gang had created an atmosphere of fear, intimidated witnesses and discouraged victims from approaching police. It also presented details of other criminal cases involving the convict under IPC sections 364 (kidnapping or abducting to murder), 302 (murder), 201 (causing disappearance of evidence) and 506 (criminal intimidation).

Jaisalmer's Sam dunes shut to tourists after sunset

Vimal Bhatia | TNN

Jaisalmer: Rajasthan forest department has banned camel safaris, sightseeing, and other tourism activities in Sam Sand Dunes after sunset and prohibited laser lights at night-time cultural events in the Sam and Kanoi areas of Jaisalmer's Desert National Park to protect wildlife and the fragile ecosystem.

Regional forest officer (tourism and wildlife), Jaisalmer, Ajgar Ali, has written to Jaisalmer Hotel Association, directing hotels, camel safari operators, and other tourism stakeholders to ensure strict compliance.

The department said some hotels in Sam and Kanoi had been dumping waste within the sanctuary area. Tourists visiting the dunes have also been found littering, with plastic bags, glass bottles, and other garbage posing a threat to wildlife and the natural environment.

It termed waste dumping in the protected area a violation of directions issued by National Green Tribunal (NGT).

TOI

The restrictions prohibit camel safaris, sightseeing, and other tourism activities in designated dune areas after sunset

Old Monk sales curbs cost Maha ₹350cr in excise revenue, HC told

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Mumbai: Maharashtra has allegedly lost around Rs 350 crore in excise revenue following restrictions on the sale of Old Monk rum from its manufacturer's affected unit, the Bombay high court was told Monday. Mohan Rocky Springwater Pvt Ltd, which makes the popular spirit, has also claimed business losses exceeding Rs 500 crore as it challenges the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India's (FSSAI) prohibition order over the product's formulation and labelling.

The company submitted that the sales restrictions had affected its business even as the same formulation continued to be sold through other manufacturing units. It also cited the impact on about 300 workers, according to the submissions reported in connection with the proceedings. Meanwhile sources in the excise department confirmed that the ban since May this year had resulted in revenue losses as company's all rum variants were out of shelves.

The financial claims, including the alleged loss to the state exchequer, are the manufacturer's submissions and have not been independently established as official revenue or employment figures.

The dispute pits the manufacturer's contention that its formulation and use of approved additives are permissible under the applicable regulations against FSSAI's position that a spirit made with added rum flavouring cannot automatically be marketed under the standard product name "rum".

Change MTP form to include unmarried women: Bby HC

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Mumbai: Bombay HC has directed the Maharashtra govt to make appropriate changes in a form related to medical termination of pregnancies between 20 and 24 weeks to include single unmarried women. Chief Justice MC Tripathi and Justice Advait Sethna on Monday said, "It would be fair, just and proper to direct the concerned respondents to make appropriate changes as the law would require in the forms, formats and procedures to be followed in such cases in consonance to the observations / directions issued by the Supreme Court."

The direction was passed while permitting a single unmarried woman (22) to terminate her over-22-week pregnancy. In 2022, SC had held that Rule 3 B of MTP Rules, that enumerates women eligible for MTP between 20 and 24 weeks, shall also include single unmarried women. The woman had urged a direction for a change in Form E, which is filled by a doctor giving an opinion that a case falls under one of the permitted categories.

TOI

The HC was hearing a single woman's plea seeking to terminate her pregnancy

She sought HC's permission as the MTP Act and Rules do not permit a single unmarried woman to terminate her pregnancy that has crossed 20 weeks. She is pursuing a professional degree. She has a history of polycystic ovary syndrome which involves irregular or absent periods. In May 2026, she had sexual relations with her partner. Till Oct, when she did not get her periods, a sonography revealed she was 21 weeks and 1 day pregnant. Her petition said continuing the unwanted pregnancy would have a serious adverse impact on her mental and emotional well-being. She would face stigma.

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K KRISTAPPA SHETTY
Retd. General Manager, Vijaya Bank
Passed away on
Wednesday, 30th September, 2026
Vaikunta Samaradhane
Wednesday 14.10.2026 at 12.00 Noon
in Bunts Sangha, Bangalore.
Survived by his grieving
Wife Mukambika Shetty,
Son, Daughters, Sons-in-law,
Daughter-in-law and Grand children.

OBITUARY

DEATH ANNOUNCEMENTS

DEATH ANNIVERSARY

REMEMBRANCE

Sri. R RAMACHANDRA REDDY
Engineer, IIA-Bengaluru
Days may pass and turn into years, but you live in our hearts forever.
Sudha and Anurag

REMEMBRANCES

8th Year Remembrance
In treasured memory of

Smt. Bhavani A Rao
Fondly remembered by
Husband, children and family.

"You are our Gift from God and we will cherish your memory forever."

Jessie Domingo
81 years (W/o late P. J. Domingo)
Reached her Heavenly Abode on 12th October 2026.
Requiem Holy Mass at 3 PM on 14 th October 2026 at Resurrection Church, Indiranagar, followed by burial in Ulsoor Cemetery.
With enduring love,
Son – Joseph Polly,
Daughter – Prithi,
Son-in-law – Dr. Xavier V.K.,
Daughter-in-law – Dr. Rosemary,
Grand Children – Rahul, Sharon, Vanessa and Vivian

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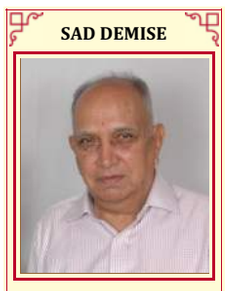

Mr. N. A. P. S. Rao
General Manager (retd.), Indian Railways
6th January 1933 - 30th September 2026
Contact: arati.rao.nadig@gmail.com

Centre sets 60-min benchmark for road crash emergency care

Ministry Asks States/UTs To Implement SOP

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It aims to standardise pre-hospital emergency care and improve coordination among first responders, ambulance and hospitals to check preventable deaths and long-term disability due to road crashes

New Delhi: With India reporting over 1.8 lakh road crash deaths and injuries to 5.57 lakh people in 2025, the Union health ministry has laid down a framework to monitor emergency care from the first distress call to hospital arrival, including a 60-minute benchmark for time-sensitive cases.

The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Pre-hospital Care in Road Traffic Injuries aims to standardise pre-hospital emergency care and improve coordination among first responders, ambulance services and hospitals to check preventable deaths and long-term disability due to road crashes. It calls for emergency calls to be answered within 10 seconds and lays down indicators to track ambulance response times and "Golden Hour" compliance. The latter measure the proportion of patients with time-sensitive conditions, including severe trauma, stroke and cardiac arrest, who receive initial pre-hospital care, including assessment, resuscitation and stabilisation, and reach a facility equipped to provide definitive treatment within 60 minutes of the incident.

In a letter to chief secretaries of all states and UTs, the ministry said it had "formulated and finalised" the SOP in accordance with directions of the Supreme Court Committee on Road Safety.

It asked states and UTs to circulate the document among all stakeholders for implementation. The SOP cites National Health Mission's recommendations that ambulances should reach crash sites within 20 minutes of receiving a call in urban areas and 30 minutes in rural areas. It further recommends, as a quality benchmark, that patients should reach a health facility within the next 30 minutes.

States and UTs are to monitor ambulance response and transport time periods, golden-hour compliance, population coverage, on-scene triage and patient outcomes. These indicators can be assessed every three months, with states and UTs responsible for identifying service gaps and taking corrective action. The SOP does not provide a national baseline showing how many road-crash victims currently get definitive care within 60 minutes.

The protocol calls for GPS-enabled ambulance tracking and strategic deployment based on population density, facility demand and traffic or accident heat-maps. It recommends one advanced life support ambulance for every five lakh people and one basic life support ambulance for every one lakh people.

Each ambulance should have a driver and at least one trained emergency medical technician, with regular training, annual skill updates and equipment checks vis-a-vis Automotive Industry Standard 125 specifications.

UP man kills 2 friends in 2 yrs over remarks about spouse

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Meerut: A 34-year-old man from Baghpat allegedly killed two friends within two years for talking about his wife in an "objectionable way". Manoj Kashyap, who was married in 2018 and has two children, strangled Pushpendra Singh while drinking at a farm Saturday. SHO (Doghat) Keval Singh said, "We came to know about a 2024 incident in which Kashyap was accused of thrashing another friend, Yogesh, with an iron rod in Haryana's Sonipat over remarks about his spouse. He had been in jail for almost a year before securing bail."

Pushpendra's body was found in a sugarcane field the next morning.

The accused tried to make it look like a road accident, police said. But CCTV footage and surveillance revealed Kashyap's involvement and he was arrested after a brief encounter on Monday evening in which a bullet hit his leg.

Keralam CM introduces India's first senior citizens' bill in assembly

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Thiruvananthapuram: Keralam Senior Citizens (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, was introduced in the state assembly on Tuesday.

Presenting the bill, chief minister **V D Satheesan** said the proposed legislation sought to ensure care and protection of senior citizens while also enabling the state to make use of their knowledge and experience through a silver economy designed to meet the needs of older adults.

The bill was subsequently referred to the subject committee for scrutiny. Satheesan said Keralam was undergoing significant demographic changes, with the number of young people declining due to factors such as falling birth rates, delayed marriages and migration of students and young professionals to other places.

Also, rising life expectancy was increasing the proportion of senior citizens. By 2036, the proportion of senior citizens in Keralam is expected to be twice the national average, he said, stressing that demographic changes should be a key consideration in the state's planning.

Satheesan said the proposed department for senior citizens shouldn't be viewed merely as a welfare initiative. While care and protection formed an important component, govt also wanted to develop a silver economy, using the experience, expertise and knowledge of people aged above 60. He said experienced professionals could help young entrepreneurs who lacked technical, marketing or management expertise. Retired professionals could be engaged as mentors and provided an honorarium.

Their expertise could also be used to advise Kudumbashree units, help prepare projects and support women in becoming financially self-reliant. Satheesan said govt had examined models adopted in countries such as Japan, the US and UK, and was working on adapting suitable approaches to Keralam's needs. On the care component, he said many senior citizens were living alone because their children had moved elsewhere or because they had no children.

Air ambulance on three Maha highways for accident victims

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Pune: The Maharashtra govt plans to launch an emergency air ambulance service on the state's three major highways from early next year, transport minister Pratap Sarnaik said on Tuesday. The service aims to provide faster medical assistance to road accident victims during the 'golden hour' — the first hour after an accident, when timely treatment can significantly improve survival chances. It will cover Mumbai-Nagpur highway, Pune-Mumbai Expressway and Mumbai-Goa highway.

"The aim is to ensure timely medical treatment for those injured in severe road accidents and help save lives," Sarnaik said. The govt plans to secure approval for a standard operating procedure by Nov 15. The tendering process will begin after approval from a high-powered committee, expected by Nov-end. It is scheduled to become operational at the beginning of the new year, he added. Aviation experts cautioned that implementing such a service would require substantial infrastructure and coordination.

Carney thanks Modi for Ukraine peace efforts

▶ Continued from page 1

According to a Canadian readout, the PMs welcomed the increased engagement between Canada and India over the past year, including in areas such as finance, defence and security, people-to-people ties and artificial intelligence. They underscored the opportunity to build on this renewed momentum.

"The leaders also discussed the impact of geopolitical instability on the Indo-Pacific region and the need for trusted partners in the areas of energy and agriculture," said the Canadian readout, adding that Carney thanked Modi for his leadership in seeking a peaceful resolution to Russia's war on Ukraine.

The leaders agreed to remain in close contact ahead of PM Modi's visit to Canada in Dec.

Man gets divorce as HC terms quarrel, distrust 'mental cruelty'

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Raipur: Chhattisgarh high court granted a divorce decree to a husband on the ground of mental cruelty, holding that persistent disputes, serious distrust, strained relations between the wife and his family, and continued disagreements over separate residence, when viewed cumulatively, went beyond the ordinary wear and tear of matrimonial life.

A division bench of Justice Parth Prateem Sahu and Justice Sachin Singh Rajput on Monday set aside a Jagdalpur family court order that rejected the husband's divorce petition, observing that the lower court failed to properly appreciate the evidence and examine the cumulative effect of the circumstances established on record.

The husband appealed in the high court challenging the family court's Dec 10, 2022, order dismissing his divorce petition under Section 13(1)(ia) of the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955. According to the husband, the matrimonial relationship became strained soon after marriage in June 2017. He stated that his wife frequently quarrelled with him, used abusive language, suspected his character, insisted on a separate residence and repeatedly put pressure on him to live apart from his mother and other family members. He also alleged physical assaults and threats of suicide by his wife during their disputes.

The wife denied the allegations and accused her husband and his family of harassment and ill-treatment. She maintained that she was not provided proper food and was confined to a room in the matrimonial home. She also expressed her willingness to resume marital life.

Examining the evidence, the HC noted that the husband's testimony regarding recurring disputes and demands for separate residence received support from his mother and other witnesses. It observed that although some witnesses admitted omissions in their earlier statements and did not report certain incidents to police, these shortcomings did not, in themselves, completely discredit their testimony regarding the matrimonial discord they witnessed.

The bench also noted that the wife's witnesses did not establish specific acts of cruelty personally witnessed by them. One witness admitted that no quarrel between the couple took place in his presence.

HC: Attempt alone doesn't establish rape

Patna: Patna high court has reduced a man's rape conviction to indecent assault, ruling that allegations of him entering a woman's hut at night, covering her mouth and mounting her body, without supporting medical or material evidence, were insufficient to establish rape. A single-judge bench of Justice Sandeep Kumar passed the verdict on Oct 8 while partly allowing a criminal appeal by Mohammad Ainul Haq.

The judgement became public Tuesday.

According to the prosecution, Ainul entered the woman's hut around 10pm on Feb 8, 2010, covered her mouth and mounted her "with evil intentions". TNN

Firecracker prices set to soar 15% to 20% this Deepavali

Higher Making Costs, Factory Restrictions Hit Sivakasi Hub

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ANI

At the factories, the biggest blow has come from chemicals

Madurai: Firecracker buyers will have to shell out more this Deepavali for their favourite sky shots and sparklers, with retail prices likely to see an increase of 15% to 20% compared to last year as soaring raw material costs and production curbs squeeze Sivakasi, the country's fireworks hub.

N Elangovan of Federation of Tamil Nadu Fireworks Traders said bulk sales were gaining momentum, with retail quotations already reflecting higher costs. "Prices could rise further after the puja holidays as demand peaks," he said.

At the factories, the biggest blow has come from chemicals. T Kannan of The Indian Fireworks Manufacturers Association (TIFMA) said sulphur price had surged from Rs 75 to Rs 140 a kg before easing to Rs 100. Aluminium, sodium nitrate and other inputs have also become around 30% costlier.

P N Deva of Firecrackers and Matchbox Manufacturers Association said supplies of sulphur and adhesives were delayed as shipping disruptions in the Gulf forced vessels to take longer routes.

Manufacturers estimated that delays and costlier chemicals could increase production expenses by around 15%. Factory inspections have compounded the situation. District authorities say they have inspected more than 700 firecracker manufacturing units following the deaths of 41 people and injuries to 39 in 24 accidents reported in the last 10 months.

Manufacturers disagreed over the impact of the crackdown. TIFMA's Kannan said repeated checks at licensed factories were disrupting production while illegally leased and subleased facilities, where he said serious violations occurred, escaped sufficient scrutiny.

Deva said unlicensed production had fallen sharply. "Some licensed brands previously bought popular crackers, including rockets, flower pots and ground spinners, from unlicensed makers and sold them under their own labels to cut costs, affecting registered workers' earnings," he said.

India is a partner of choice, Canada committed to trade deal by Dec-end

Anita Anand

"... India's growing demand presents an opportunity to match our expertise in sectors like aerospace, agri-food and clean technology, with the goal of more than doubling our trade to $70 billion by 2030

This week, I am visiting New Delhi to meet with my counterpart Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, minister of external affairs, and to participate in Bloomberg's New Economy Forum. My message to minister Jaishankar and the Indian people is clear: as democracies bound together by people-to-people ties and committed to a free, open, and inclusive Indo-Pacific, Canada and India are natural partners, and we are making steady progress in elevating our relations.

Canada and India share nearly 80 years of diplomatic relations, and now, we are finding new ways to work together. As our world becomes more dangerous and divided, Canada is building up its strategic autonomy and resilience. Strategic autonomy does not mean isolation or disengagement. Rather, it requires Canada to diversify our international relationships. This means reinforcing our ties with small states, middle powers, and large nations. As we pursue this work, India is a partner of choice, and there is much that our countries can do to elevate our relations. This is the purpose of my visit, which comes at an important anniversary, and a time of great opportunity.

Almost exactly one year ago, minister Jaishankar and I agreed on a New Roadmap for Canada-India Relations, outlining the work that our countries will pursue on six thematic areas: trade, climate action, energy, science and technology, agriculture, and people-to-people linkages.

Over the past year, we have been making steady progress on implementing our plan. Canada and India are advancing work on a Canada-India comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA). Canada is committed to concluding a mutually beneficial CEPA by the end of this year, when Prime Minister Narendra Modi visits our country.

Through the CEPA, Canada and India will open the door to an even stronger economic relationship, but Canada is also working to help Canadian and Indian and businesses alike walk through that door.

I am especially pleased that my colleague Maninder Sidhu, Canada's minister of international trade, is currently leading Canada's largest trade delegation to India in over 30 years, with stops in Mumbai and Bengaluru. Nearly 300 delegates are currently visiting India to connect with Indian decision makers, key industry players and potential clients to expand commercial relations and build new partnerships that create good-paying jobs. Ultimately, Canada's goal is to match our expertise in sectors like aerospace, agri-food and clean technology with India's growing demand, with the goal of more than doubling our trade with India to $70 billion by 2030.

We have also been pleased to welcome Indian delegations to Canada over the past year. In May, during his visit to Canada for the Trade and Investment Forum in Toronto, minister Goyal led the largest trade delegation that India has ever sent anywhere in the world. In Sept, Prime Minister Carney hosted the first Canada Investment Summit in Toronto, bringing together businesses and investors from around the world, including India. Visitors to Canada heard first-hand how Canada is advancing major projects in critical minerals, mining, energy, and infrastructure, creating significant opportunities for long-term investment and partnership, including for Indian investors.

Our cooperation is also on track in other areas of our New Roadmap. High-level dialogues are taking place at a healthy pace, including between our foreign ministries, and on mobility and migration issues. Earlier this month, our leaders' national security advisors held discussions to ensure that issues on both sides are addressed collaboratively. Our countries have recently seen joint meetings of the Joint Science and Technology Cooperation Committee, and earlier this year, we launched Canada-India Talent and Innovation Strategy to deepen education collaboration, with 13 new partnerships between Canadian and Indian universities. Officials from Canada, Australia, and India recently met to plan a path forward for the Australia-Canada-India Technology and Innovation (ACITI) Partnership. Importantly, negotiations are also taking place to establish a General Security of Information Agreement between Canada and India and to determine a path forward on increased defence cooperation.

Work is also underway to strengthen our political relations. Building on visits to Canada by India's minister of finance, Nirmala Sitharaman and India's minister of commerce and industry, Piyush Goyal, Canada and India are launching Raisina Americas to strengthen the opportunities for exchanges and cooperation. Further, we welcome India's membership in the Partnership for Multilateralism, launched by Canada and its partners at the recent United Nations General Assembly High-Level Week.

In sum, Canada and India are natural and complementary partners. In a world where international rules are under threat and countries must work together pragmatically to grow our economies and solve global challenges, there is much more that Canada and India can do together. I am very pleased to be in New Delhi this week, and I am more optimistic than ever about the future of our bilateral relationship.

(The writer is the foreign minister of Canada)

BJP sweeps Gandhinagar civic polls; Congress gains

Gandhinagar: BJP has retained control of Gandhinagar Municipal Corporation (GMC), winning 38 of the 44 seats in the civic body election, although it fell short of its 2021 tally of 41 seats. Congress upped its tally from two seats in 2021 to five this time, while an independent candidate secured one seat. AAP, which had bagged one seat last time, failed to open its account.

Both BJP and Congress gained vote shares at the cost of AAP in the election. BJP secured 56.46% votes, up from 46.49% in 2021, while Congress garnered 36.93% compared to a vote share of 28.02% last time. AAP's vote share, on the other hand, plummeted to 4.37% from 21.77% in 2021.

BJP also retained the Thara and Okha municipalities. In Thara, in Banaskantha district, the party won 19 of the 24 seats, with Congress securing five. In Okha, in Devbhumi Dwarka district, BJP bagged 29 of the 32 seats, while Congress got three. CM Bhupendra Patel, his deputy Harsh Sanghavi and BJP state chief Jagdish Vishwakarma led celebrations at the party headquarters on Tuesday afternoon.

GMC carries a prestige tag as the civic body in the state capital has historically seen a tougher fight between BJP and Congress. In 2011, in the first election after the civic body was formed, Congress won 18 seats against BJP's 15. In 2016, the two parties were tied at 16 seats each. BJP subsequently registered landslide victories in 2021 and 2026. TNN

Nilekani calls for wider computer-based testing

▶ Continued from page 1

Asked whether artificial intelligence could generate papers on examination day, he replied, "Yeah, sure." The proposal comes as the six-member task force prepares to submit its report later this month, following extensive consultations on examination security, technology and governance.

TOI had reported on Oct 1 that the panel was prioritising "debundling" examination responsibilities by separating question-paper setting, examination conduct, test-centre management and security among different agencies. The proposed restructuring seeks to reduce concentration of control over examinations. A common calendar for major recruitment and entrance tests is also under consideration.

Earlier, on Sept 16, TOI reported that multiple attempts at high-stakes entrance examinations and better-equipped, secure testing centres were among the prominent suggestions received by the task force. The recommendations included reliable electricity, internet connectivity, biometric verification and CCTV surveillance.

Nilekani also stressed expanding computer-based testing infrastructure. Nilekani, the chairperson of thehigh-powered task force onexamination reforms, saidsaid the existing network of around 1.5 lakh testing locations needed to grow to accommodate a wider shift towards computer-based examinations. "If you look at it systematically and go to root causes of why it's happening and use technology to solve it... they are solvable issues," Nilekani said.

Constituted on July 26 following the NEET-UG controversy and student protests, the task force has held around 18 panel meetings and 40 consultations. It has received over 50,000 suggestions from students, parents, professional associations and examination bodies.

A recent parliamentary committee report has also recommended expanding computer-based testing facilities, with at least one centre in every district to reduce candidates' travel and accommodation costs.

Cartographic tussle comes amid ongoing normalisation of ties

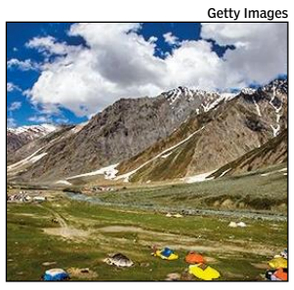
▶ Continued from page 1

The announcement mentions that the 28 places/features located in the UT of Ladakh have been identified with standard place and feature names on the official map of Survey of India, and it has been done in consultation with the UT of Ladakh and local stakeholders," he said.

"China has never recognised the so-called Union territory of Ladakh unilaterally and illegally established by India and firmly opposes the so-called standardised names publicised by India," said Chinese foreign ministry spokesperson Mao Ning.

However, China itself has renamed places in Arunachal Pradesh on at least half a dozen occasions in the past 10 years, including twice in 2026,

Getty Images



KEY MATTERS

to reinforce its claim over the Indian state.

The fresh cartographic tussle comes in the middle of the ongoing normalisation of the bilateral relationship after a military stand-off in eastern Ladakh. The Chinese response was a throwback to its statement in 2019 — a day after India revoked the special status of J&K — accusing New Delhi of undermining China's territorial sovereignty by unilaterally changing its domestic law and establishing Ladakh UT.

"Such practice is unacceptable and will not come into force," it had then said, warning India to exercise prudence in words and deeds on the boundary question. The military conflict in eastern Ladakh started eight months later.

Beijing maintains that it has always opposed India's inclusion of "Chinese territory in the western sector of the China-India boundary into its administrative jurisdiction". For China, Aksai Chin in the western sector remains of critical importance as it links the politically sensitive autonomous regions of Xinjiang and Tibet.

Prototype of India's first ever AI-piloted fighter jet unveiled

Surendra.Singh
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: India has joined the race for AI-piloted fighter aircraft as an Indian company, Flying Wedge Defence & Aerospace (FWDA), on Tuesday unveiled the full-scale static prototype of the country's first AI-piloted fighter jet.

An AI-piloted fighter jet is a combat aircraft controlled by artificial intelligence rather than or alongside a human pilot, enabling it to fly, navigate and execute tactical manoeuvres autonomously. FWD Supreme Heavy is a one-tonne-class aircraft envisioned for autonomous combat operations and configurable for missions, including intelligence, reconnaissance, strike and collaborative combat.

One of the prominent AI-piloted aircraft in the world is Shield AI X-BAT, belonging to US company Shield AI. Suhas Tejaskanda, founder and CEO of Bengaluru-based FWDA, said, "FWD Supreme represents our commitment to building advanced defence capabilities through Indian design, engineering and manufacturing. Our ambition is to develop a family of AI-piloted fighter aircraft that combines operational relevance with affordability."

SIR equal to first preparation of a roll, says EC's counsel

▶ Continued from page 1

He said it only meant "non-inclusion" in a roll that is a draft, which is to be finalised after following due process of suggestions and objections. "Thus, such non-inclusion in the draft SIR necessitates following due process by the elector for inclusion," he said. "Special Intensive Revision is equal to the first preparation of a roll."

He told court there is a difference between special summary revision (SSR) and SIR. "This distinction between SSR and SIR is really confusing and, therefore, all these issues have arisen, and all these issues have cropped in," he said. "...therefore, an impression is created that somebody's name which doesn't appear in draft SIR is someone whose name is dropped, deleted, removed," Kumbhakoni argued.

"Under SSR, the existing roll continues and is only updated based on information received in the prescribed manner, whereas under SIR, the roll is rebuilt from those enumerated. SSR is routine and annual, whereas SIR is intensive and exceptional," he said, adding that in SIR, people have to respond to enumeration forms.

EC blamed Paresh Salgaonkar and his family of five for not registering their names despite shifting their residence within the same constituency around eight years ago.

He said Form 8, which the Salgaonkars filled, is for shifting an existing entry from one place to another or for correction. "If your entry is not there in the electoral roll, which is prepared afresh as result of SIR, how can that Form 8 help him? Therefore, in the second appeal (filed by Salgaonkars) it is observed and held that there is no occasion for shifting of the entry of Form 8, since there is no entry at all in the original electoral roll — draft roll of SIR," Kumbhakoni said.

The counsel representing the Salgaonkars told court it was the booth-level officer who uploaded Form 8 for change of address and not the petitioners.

He said the family received a message on Jan 21, two days after the last date to file objections to the draft roll where their names were missing, that their Form 8 was rejected.

The counsel told HC there is not a single guideline of EC stating that Form 8 shall stand suspended during SIR. "I'm neither in a boat nor in a canoe. I'm left in the sea," he said.

The high court has reserved its order in the case.

Puri may return to Parl amid reshuffle

▶ Continued from page 1

Ravneet Singh Bittu and George Kurian have already resigned earlier under similar circumstances.

Two other ministers, Pankaj Chaudhary and Harsh Malhotra, have been made presidents of BJP in Uttar Pradesh and Delhi, respectively, making their departure only a matter of time. Interestingly, an imminent RS vacancy from Madhya Pradesh also opens up the possibility for Puri, the lone Sikh face in govt, to return to Parliament. Murugan has been BJP president in Tamil Nadu, the last one among big states where the party remains at the margins of electoral politics, and it was given a jolt when K Annamalai, who enjoyed a certain following, quit it in June this year.

APSRTC

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) FOR SELECTION OF OPERATOR FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF 1450 AC (9M/12M) ELECTRIC BUSES AND DEVELOPMENT OF ALLIED ELECTRICAL AND CIVIL INFRASTRUCTURE FOR CHARGERS ON GCC (Dry Lease & Wet Lease)

e-tenders are invited from the interested bidders for procurement, supply, operation and maintenance of 1450 AC Electric buses (9M/12M) and development of allied electrical and civil infrastructure for chargers on Gross Cost Contract (GCC) model - dry lease & wet lease, at 29 depots of APSRTC. **(1)** Bids shall be submitted in the e-commerce portal of MSTC. **(2)** Start date for submission of bids: **09-11-2026 from 10.00 hrs. (3)** Last date for submission of bids: **24-11-2026 up to 17.00 hrs. (4)** For full details visit our website **http://www.apsrtc.ap.gov.in** (Tenders) and MSTC Portal **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/eproc**. **(5)** APSRTC reserves the right to cancel this notification without assigning any reason.

TENDER NOTICE NO: APSRTC/C&B-03/2026-27-MED, Dt.13-10-2026 Sd/-Chief Mechanical Engineer(C&B)

DELHI METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India and Govt. of Delhi)

INVITATION FOR BIDS

Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Ltd. invites online open e-tenders from eligible Bidders for the **"Bid PRS1: Design, Manufacture, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of 102 Nos. of Standard Gauge Cars for Corridor 1 & 2 of Patna Metro along with associated Training, Spares, DLP etc."**

International Competitive Bidding will be conducted in accordance with Japan International Cooperation Agency's "Single–Stage Two-Envelope" Bidding Procedure.

For detailed information log on to **www.delhimetrorail.com** or e-tendering website **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app**.

Advertisement No.: DMRC/1001/2026

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
NOTIFICATION
Bengaluru, the 16th September, 2026

S.O. 5173(E).-In the exercise of the powers conferred by clause (6) of section 20F and clause 7A of section 2 of the Railway Act, 1989 (24 of 1989) the Ministry of Railway (South Western Railway, Construction Organization, Bengaluru Cantonment) hereby authorizes the officers mentioned in column (4) of the table below as 'Competent Authority' and the officers mentioned in column (5) of the table below as 'Arbitrator' to perform the functions as such authority under the said act with effect from date of publication of this notification in the official gazette in respect of Special Railway Projects mentioned in column (2) relating to district mentioned in column (3) of the table below for public purpose of execution, maintenance, management and operation of such Special Railway Project.

SN	Name of the Project	District	Competent Authority	Arbitrator
1.	Quadrupling of Track between Whitefield Bangarpet Station (47 Km)	Bengaluru Urban	SLAO, V.V. Tower, Bengaluru	Regional Commissioner, Bengaluru
2.	Quadrupling of Track between Whitefield Bangarpet Station (47 Km)	Bengaluru Rural	SLAO, Doddaballapura Bengaluru Rural	Regional Commissioner, Bengaluru
3.	Quadrupling of Track between Whitefield Bangarpet Station (47 Km)	Kolar	Assistant Commissioner/ LAO, Kolar	Regional Commissioner, Bengaluru

[F.No.W.271/CN/BNC/2026-27 Land SRP/1727]

For details log on : https://egazette.gov.in

ASHUTOSH MATHUR, Chief Engineer-IV/Construction, Bengaluru Cantonment

PUB/527/AAD360/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the **RailOne** app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

South Western Railway - SWR SWRRLY @SWRAILWAYHQ @sw_railways

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website : www.pspcl.in
(Contact Number 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 14/2026 **Dated : 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No. D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (**www.Powermin.nic.in**) and PFC Consultancy Limited (**www.pfcindia.com**). For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note : Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com**

C977/26, DPR/Pb.:1079/12/2026-27/16127

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT DIVISION, VIJAYAPUR.
I.F.T.No:EE/PWD/VJP/PB-5/3054/5054/2026-27/3702
Dated:12.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION (E-Procurement)

The- **Executive Engineer, Public Works Dept. Division, Vijayapur** Invites tender from eligible tenderers (registered in Public Works Department) Total 3 work, As per standard bid documents KW- 3 & 4 with Different Head Of Account costing Maximum & Minimum of amount for Rs. 130.00 Lakhs and 80.00 lakhs, the EMD Maximum & Minimum amount of Rs. 1,95,000/- and 1,60,000/- For the works. For the above works G.S.T shall not be paid in the extended period of Contract for which the contractor alone is responsible for delay as determined by the authority while granting the extension of time. The calendar events of tenders, dates are fixed as follows (1) Pre-Bid Meeting for Contractors. Date-21.10-2026 at 11:00 AM (2) Last Date for Receipt of Tenders Date-28.10.2026 upto 4.30 PM. (3) Opening of Technical Bid Date-29.10.2026 upto 4.31 PM. (4) Opening of Financial Bid Date-30.10.2026 upto 4.30 PM On words Clause-3 Conditions of Standard Bid Document may be seen in Departmental Website i.e "https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in" and for more information may contact help desk Bangalore (Phone No. 91 80 46010000, +91 80 68948777) or office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer, PWD Division, Vijayapur

ಪಾಸಾಸಂಂ/ವಿಜಯಪುರ/356/ಕೆಎಸ್ಎಂಪಿ/2026–27

25001/1314/2627

ନିର୍ବାହୀ ଯନ୍ତ୍ରୀଙ୍କ କାର୍ଯ୍ୟାଳୟ
ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ଜଳ ଯୋଗାଣ ଓ ପରିମଳ ଖଣ୍ଡ, ସୋନପୁର

Pin-767017
Ph.-06654-220259 (O)
Email: eerwss.sonepur@gmail.com

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
RURAL WATER SUPPLY & SANITATION DIVISION, SONEPUR

OFFICE ORDER No. 3510 Date. 09.10.2026

The Bid identification No.01 of 2026-27 Dt.07.10.2026 the work Construction of 04 nos of 'E' type quarter (G+F) at RWS&S Division Sonepur for the year 2025-26, which was issued to I&PR Deptt. on Dated. 07.10.2026 has been cancelled due to technical issue.

Sd/-
(Er Muna Kalundia)
Executive Engineer
RWS&S Division Sonepur

OIPR-25001/25037/1/26-27/0003

34001/1001/2627

Government of Odisha, e- Procurement Notice
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
Bid Identification No. C.C.E.Dkl.(R&B) 15/2026-27 Email Id-sedklpwd@gmail.com
Letter No. 2195 /Dt. 12-10-2026

The Chief Construction Engineer, Dhenkanal (R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage Rate bids in double cover system to be received in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road & Building works as detailed below:

1.	Name of the work	:	Road & Building works
2.	No of works	:	02 (Two) Nos
3.	Estimated Cost	:	**Rs.1.61 Crore to Rs. 1.95 Crore (as given in column No. 03 of table)**
4.	Cost of tender paper	:	Rs 10,000.00
5.	Class of contractor	:	'B' Class, 'A' Class **(as given in column No. 07 of table)**
6.	Period of Completion of work	:	05 (Five) to 07 (Seven) calendar months **(as given in column No. 08 of table)**
7.	Date and time of availability of bid Document in the website	:	From Dt.16.10.2026 to 5.00 P.M. of Dt.30.10.2026
8.	Date of opening of bid	:	Dt.31.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.

The bidders have to participate in ONLINE biding only further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal: **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Dhenkanal (R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal

OIPR-34001/34132/1/26-27/0018

INDIA DIGEST

13 held for selling women's intimate videos online

Manipur Police arrested 13 people, including a minor, for allegedly circulating and selling non-consensual intimate photographs and videos of women through instant messaging platforms. Some of the channels were found distributing child sexual abuse material (CSAM), police said, describing the nexus as an organised, profit-driven and self-sustaining network that worked on a subscription model. Cops said channel administrators allegedly ran exclusive private groups on a subscription basis, charging Rs 150 to Rs 500 or more. "They used teasers and previews posted on open platforms to attract subscribers, who paid through UPI applications for access," a police officer said.

Truck crushes 2 teens to death in Jamui

Two teenagers died while six others were injured after an allegedly speeding truck ploughed through a group of devotees returning from Maa Netula temple on Sikandra-Nawada main road in Bihar's Jamui district early Tuesday. Police launched a search to locate the truck and its driver, who fled with the vehicle after the accident. Cops identified the deceased as Sulekha Kumari (13) and Anshu Kumari (16), both from Panchmahua village. Sulekha was in Class 7 while Anshu studied in Class 9.

Missing head of Khajuraho idol will be restored soon: ASI chief

Pankul.Sharma
@timesofindia.com

The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has found the missing head of an 11th-century Vishnu idol at Khajuraho, whose restoration became the subject of a recent controversy involving the Supreme Court, and plans to reattach it after expert examination. ASI has also introduced a three-year deadline for archaeological excavations to curb delays in research and cut approval times for most conservation projects to 15-20 days, director general **Yadubir Singh Rawat** told **TOI** in an exclusive interview. He also revealed plans for a preliminary excavation at Ujjain's Vaishya Tekri, where a Buddhist stupa could be larger than Sanchi's, although its actual scale and significance remain to be established.

Controversy over the beheaded Vishnu idol at Khajuraho's Javari temple reached the Supreme Court last year when advocate Rakesh Dalal sought restoration, replacement or reconstruction of the seven-foot statue. While dismissing the petition, then CJI BR Gavai had said, "Go and ask the deity itself to do something now." Though Gavai later said he respects all religions and that his statement was taken out of context, a lawyer had tried to throw a shoe at him inside the court.

The missing head had been found in an ASI store. "During a visit to Bhopal for the Brics summit, I learnt that the statue's head — which had been kept in our store — had been found. The person in charge informed me that someone likely tried to break off the head to steal it but failed to do so. We are having experts examine it and will soon reattach it to the statue."

On encroachments at protected monuments, Rawat said "The root of this problem lies in the list prepared by British rulers in 1904 under the 'Ancient Monuments Preservation Act' — a list that the then govt adopted post-Independence without any review. The British had included cemeteries and graves of their obscure soldiers, horses and pets — which they deemed highly significant — among protected monuments." Rawat said a review in 1953 incorporated state monuments into a definitive list, but the central list remained unchanged. The resulting difficulties led to 17 monuments being removed.

Regarding funding disparities, he said allocations depended on visitor numbers, maintenance requirements, and security expenses. Taj Mahal and Red Fort, he said, served as showcases for ASI, while Taj Mahal's maintenance required substantial expenditure because of its delicate structure and heavy tourist footfall. ASI paid around Rs 3 cr monthly for over 200 CISF personnel deployed there. He said ASI circles had been instructed to prepare conservation and tourism development proposals for lesser-known sites like Bareilly's pyramid-like Bhim ki Gada structure.

Pjb activist's father refuses cremation until killer is caught

▶ **Continued from page 1**

His magazine empty (video footage shows the slider locked back), Kumar then walked back to his shop before fleeing the scene. The police have detained a cousin for allegedly helping him escape.

Jhota's father Bhim Singh, an ex-Armyman, has refused to cremate him until the killer is caught and vowed to continue the fight his braveheart son started. Anger over the murder led to a complete business shutdown in Mansa and protesters blocked Barnala-Sirsa Road. A large crowd gathered at Mansa Civil Hospital and had a showdown with police as they insisted on taking Jhota's body to the protest site.

Bathinda DIG Harjit Singh said the murder was out of personal enmity, and promised to have the accused in custody within 24 hours.

The public killing of an anti-drugs campaigner triggered a major political backlash against Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) govt. State finance minister Harpal Singh Cheema and AAP Punjab president Aman Arora condemned the murder and said it was triggered by personal enmity but opposition parties ripped into the govt, alleging a complete breakdown of law and order.

Punjab BJP chief Kewal Singh Dhillon wrote to the governor for a CBI probe. Congress Leader of Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa on Tuesday said the murder raises grave questions about AAP's 'Yudh Nasheyan Virudh' campaign. It must be seen against a disturbing series of cases involving people who have raised concerns about the availability of drugs in Punjab, he remarked, mentioning the recent suicide of Gulzar Singh and the suicide bid of Jagseer Singh aka Jagga.

Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargajj said the murder of an activist, who was putting his life in danger by raising his voice against drugs, is "a very serious matter", and authorities should take serious note of it.

Police said Jhota and Kumar had a bitter history as the activist had paraded the chemist around the bazaar with a garland of shoes around his neck in 2023, accusing him of selling drugs. Cases were filed against both of them. Jhota was arrested on charges of assault, trespass and rioting and remanded in jail, but a number of social and farmer organisations held protests for days, demanding his release. The complainant approached court to withdraw his complaint and Jhota walked out of jail on Sept 11, 2023. The case against the chemist for selling prohibited substances is on.

Jhota continued campaigning against drugs. Lately, he was raising his voice against certain medical stores allegedly selling intoxicating pills and synthetic drugs.

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client intends to purchase the property mentioned and described in the Schedule hereunder from its Owner **Sri. Subodh, son of Sri. Rajendra Babu.** The Owner represents and warrants that he is the absolute owner of the Schedule Property and has a good marketable, right, title and interest therein and that apart from him there are no other person/s having any right or claim over the Schedule Property. The Owner further represents that, he has not entered into any Agreements/MoU with any third party and that the Owner has not mortgaged, created any right, interest, lien or encumbered the Schedule Property or any part thereof in any manner to any person/s.

Any person/s having objection/s or claims, shall with documentary evidence lodge their objection/s or claims within **five (5) days** from the date of this Notice with the Undersigned, failing which, my client shall proceed with the above-mentioned transaction.

SCHEDULE

All that piece and parcel of the portion of residentially converted land bearing Survey No. 85 (earlier part of Survey No. 35/4, much earlier part of Survey No.35), measuring **1 acre 30 guntas** (7084.57 square meters), comprising a residential building having a built-up area of 169 square meters (converted vide Official Memoranda in Nos. ALN(DE)SR. 22/2004-05 issued by the Deputy Commissioner, Bengaluru Rural District, Bengaluru and ALN(DE)SR. 62/2004-05 issued by the Deputy Commissioner, Bengaluru Rural District) situated at **Thimmegowdana Hosahalli (T. Hosahalli) Village, Kasaba Hobli, Devanahalli Taluk, Bengaluru Rural District,** now within the revenue jurisdiction of Kannamangala Village Panchayat and assessed to taxes under PID No.150300200400500305, Property No. 97/85, which is bounded on the :

East by : Road; West by : Property belonging to Sri. Bhovi Papaiah; North by : Remaining portion of the property bearing Survey No. 85; and South by : I V C Road.

Jayanth M Pattanshetti and Sushanth J Pattanshetti,
Advocates,
Jayanth Pattanshetti Associates LLP., Advocates,
102, Ground Floor, "Rams Infantry Manor",
No. 70, Infantry Road, Bengaluru - 560 001.
Ph:080-41238367/080-41238516/7625006767
Place: Bangalore Date:14/10/2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

We are investigating the title of the land parcel situated at Chikkabellanduru Village, Varthur Hobli, Bengaluru East Taluk, Bengaluru more fully set out in the **"Schedule"** below and hereinafter referred to as **"Schedule Property"** from the respective owners **("Owners").**

Any person/s having objection/s to the above mentioned transaction or any person/s claiming to have any manner of right, title, interest, claim or demand in relation to the Owners or the Schedule Property or any part thereof, may lodge his/her/their statement/s, objection/s and/or claim/s in writing, along with documentary evidence in support thereof, with the undersigned, within 15 (Fifteen) days from the date of publication of this notice. In the absence of any genuine and/or rightful objections and/or claims, we will issue our report on title in respect of the Schedule Properties, and our client will proceed to finalize and conclude the proposed transaction of the Schedule Property, as if no claim/s or objection/s exist and that they have been consciously waived and abandoned by such person/s.

SCHEDULE PROPERTIES

All that piece and parcel of the undeveloped residentially converted land bearing Sy.No. 23/1, Previous Sy.No. 23/5, presently coming within the jurisidictional limits of Bengaluru East City Corporation (Greater Bengaluru Authority) bearing E.PID No. 3557975396, Khatha No.182/Sy.No. 23/5, Municipal No.25, Totally Measuring 250470 Square Feet or 23269.41 Square Meters or Measuring 5 Acres 30 Guntas, Situated at Chikkabellanduru Village, Varthur Hobli, Bengaluru East Taluk, Bengaluru District, and Bounded on :

East by : Land Bearing Sy. No's 20 and 22;
West by : Chikkabellandur Lake;
North by : Sy.No.23/2 and Portion of Land bearing Sy.No.23/1; and
South by : Road and Mulluru Village Boundary.

Prasanna Swaminathan,
Head of Chambers,
Law Chambers of Prasanna Swaminathan,
Advocates & Solicitors, No. 109, Level-1, Prestige Center Point, Cunningham Road, Bengaluru - 560 052.
Ph. +91 99860 95950

Interested Sand Artists
are requested to apply by logging on to
odishatourism.gov.in

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OIPR: 37001/37001/2/26-27/0014

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10 October 2026 (9:00 AM)	17 October 2026 (9:00 PM)	15 Questions to be answered within 300 Seconds

Prizes

Prize Category	Amount	No. of Prizes	Amount
First Prize	Rs. 5,000 /-	10	Rs. 50,000 /-
Second Prize	Rs. 4,000 /-	10	Rs. 40,000 /-
Third Prize	Rs. 3,000 /-	10	Rs. 30,000 /-
Consolation Prize	Rs. 1,000 /-	10	Rs. 10,000 /-

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Bureau of Indian Standards
Bengaluru Branch Office
Peenya Industrial Area, 1st Stage, Tumkur Road, Bengaluru -560058.

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH

CORRIGENDUM

Organization Chain : Municipal Corporation/Engineering-MCC/Public Health Division II, Chandigarh
RFP Reference : MCPH2/2026/70
RFP ID : 2026_MCC_95976_1
Title : RFP for Design, Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning and Comprehensive Operation and Maintenance of Effluent Treatment Plants (ETPs) at Municipal Dhobi Ghats in Chandigarh.

The amendment in the approved RFP regarding Condition of the Contract No.6 is hereby made and the same may be read as part of the approved RFP. Due to this the schedule may be read as below :-

I)	Last date of receiving pre-Bid queries	21.10.2026 by 11:00 AM
ii)	Pre-Bid Meeting	23.10.2026 at 3:00 PM at office of the Executive Engineer, MCPH Divn.No.2, Sector 11-B, Chandigarh.
iii)	Bid Submission start Date/Time	10.10.2026 at 9:00 AM
iv)	Due/End date for submission of bids	27.10.2026 at 11:00 AM
v)	Opening of Technical Bids	27.10.2026 at 11:30 AM

All other terms and conditions of the above mentioned RFP notice issued vide this office No.5681-90 Dated 09.10.2026 will remain unchanged.

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
M.C.P.H. Division No. 2, Near Karuna Sadan Building, Sector 11, Chandigarh

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH

E-AUCTION NOTICE

Municipal Corporation Chandigarh is going to held E-Auction on Monthly Rent Basis in respect of Kiosk No. 3 of Night Food Street, Sector 14, Chandigarh

SCHEDULE FOR E-AUCTION

Auction Publish Date	Document Submission/ Payment Date		Document/payment Approval Date		Bid Start Date	
Start	Start	End	Start	End	Start	End
14.10.26 9.00 AM	15.10.26 10.00 AM	21.10.26 5.00 PM	22.10.26 9.00 AM	26.10.26 7.00 PM	27.10.26 9.00 AM	27.10.26 3.00 PM

The detailed terms & conditions of e-auction including eligibility and earnest money deposit (EMD) can be downloaded from the website http://eauction.gov.in/2026_CH_200

Helpline : 0172-5021521

Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Chandigarh

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD

(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2945600,),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616

No.KMSCL/ED/30/2026 **Date : 12.10.2026**

E- TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited from manufacturers/direct importers / loan licensees on behalf of Department of Health, Govt of Kerala for the procurement of Drugs/ Consumable for Thalassemia Management for the year 2026 - 2027.

Sl. No.	Tender No. and Date	No. Drugs
1.	KMSCL/ED/THALASSEMIA /RC/2026/026 dtd. 13/10/2026	06

Last date and time of online uploading of tender - 26.10.2026, 10.00 am.
Date and time of opening of Technical bid - 28.10.2026 11.00 am.

Tenders shall be downloaded and submitted online through the e-tender portal **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**.

(Sd/-) MANAGING DIRECTOR (Tender Inviting Authority)

ODISHA COAL AND POWER LTD.

(A GOVT. OF ODISHA COMPANY)

Zone-A, 4th Floor, Fortune Towers, Chandrasekharpur
Bhubaneswar – 751023, Odisha, Ph No: 0674-2300654 / 2300664

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

NIT No: OCPL/SER-248/2026 **Date: 14.10.2026**

Sealed bids in prescribed format are invited from Companies/firms/agencies for the following work:

Sl. No	Name of the work	Cost of Tender Paper	Issue of Tender Document	Last date & Time of Submission of bid	Date & Time of Opening of Techno-Commercial of bid
1	Providing Integrated Coal Logistics Services for Transportation of 2.25 Million Tonne of Coal from Manoharpur Coal Mine to different Power Plants of NTPC Ltd. on FOR-Destination Basis	Rs. 20,000/- (Rupees Twenty Thousand only) including GST.	14.10.2026	05:00 PM on 03.11.2026	03:30 PM on 04.11.2026

For further details, bidders shall visit Tender Odisha Portal (Odisha Govt. e-Procurement System) i.e., **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** or may refer our website i.e. **www.ocpl.org.in.** Any clarification may please be addressed to the undersigned at the above address or by email to: **contracts@ocpl.org.in.**

Sd/-
Chief Operating Officer

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact Number 9646123323

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 15/2026 **Dated: 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No.D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Non Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPS & CPPS from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power (**www.Powermin.nic.in**) and PFC Consultancy Limited (**www.pfcindia.com**). For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com**

C978/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16128

Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation Limited

(A Joint Venture of GoI & GoK)
Metro Rail Depot, Old Madras Road, Near NGEF Bus Stop, Baiyappanahalli, Bengaluru - 560 038. Ph: 080-25191039.
e-mail: contactus@bmrc.co.in Website: www.bmrc.co.in

Bid No.BMRCL/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT164/Call-2 Date: 13.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

BMRCL invites tenders from eligible Tenderers for **"Special Track Maintenance in Reach-1 Section (BYPH-CBPK)".** The works details can be obtained from the e-procurement website. The Tender documents can be obtained and submitted **on or before 12.11.2026 up to 15:00 hrs.** Further details can be obtained from the website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** or contact this office during office working Hours.

Sd/- Executive Director (O & M)

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಲೋಕಸೇವಾ ಆಯೋಗ

ಉದ್ಯೋಗ ಸೌಧ, ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು-560 001.

ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ: KPSCKA/ADMN/CLSD/1/2026-ADMN ದಿನಾಂಕ: 13-10-2026

ಅಲ್ಪಾವಧಿ ಇ-ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ ಸಂಕ್ಷಿಪ್ತ ಅಧಿಸೂಚನೆ

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಲೋಕಸೇವಾ ಆಯೋಗವು ನಡೆಸಲಿರುವ ವಿವಿಧ ಸ್ಪರ್ಧಾತ್ಮಕ/ ಇಲಾಖಾ ಪರೀಕ್ಷೆಗಳಿಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದಂತೆ ಅಗತ್ಯವಿರುವ ಕ್ಲೋಸ್ಡ್ ಕಂಟೇನರ್ ವಾಹನಗಳ ಸೇವೆಯನ್ನು ಒಂದು ವರ್ಷದ ಅವಧಿಗೆ ಪಡೆಯಲು ದಿನಾಂಕ: 13-10-2026 ರಂದು ಅಲ್ಪಾವಧಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ (ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ: KPSC/2026-27/SE0039) ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದ್ದು, ಆಸಕ್ತ ಮತ್ತು ಅರ್ಹ ಬಿಡ್ದಾರರು https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮೂಲಕ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬಹುದು. ಸದರಿ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಲು ಕೊನೆಯ ದಿನಾಂಕ: 22-10-2026ರ ಸಂಜೆ 5.00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ ನಿಗದಿಪಡಿಸಿದೆ. ಈ ಬಗ್ಗೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ಮಾಹಿತಿಯನ್ನು ಕಛೇರಿಯ ವೇಳೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಆಯೋಗದ ದೂರವಾಣಿ ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ: 080-30565802 ಮೂಲಕ ಪಡೆಯಬಹುದು.

ಕಾರ್ಯದರ್ಶಿಯವರ ಆದೇಶದ ಮೇರೆಗೆ,
ಸಹಿ/-
ಸಹಾಯಕ ಕಾರ್ಯದರ್ಶಿ(ಪ್ರ)
ಆಡಳಿತ ಶಾಖೆ
ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ಲೋಕಸೇವಾ ಆಯೋಗ

ಪಾ.ಸಾ.ಸಂ.ಇ/ಪಾಪ್ರ/3221/ಆಕಾ/2026-27

Sardar Sarovar Narmada Nigam Ltd.

(A Wholly Owned Government of Gujarat Undertaking)

Block No.12, 5th Floor,
New Sachivalaya Complex,
Gandhinagar-382010, Gujarat

CIN : U45200GJ1988SGC010493
E-mail: dgm-depo-ssnnl@gujarat.gov.in
Ph: 079-23254589,23254592,23252414

FORM DPT-1

CIRCULAR OR CIRCULAR IN THE FORM OF ADVERTISEMENT INVITING DEPOSITS

[Pursuant to section 73 (2) (a) and section n 76 and rule 4(1) and 4(2) of the Companies (Acceptance of Deposits) Rules, 2014]

1. GENERAL INFORMATION:

a. Name, CIN, Address, Website and other Contact details of the company	Sardar Sarovar Narmada Nigam Ltd. (U45200GJ1988SGC010493) Regd. Office : Block No.12, 1st Floor, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar, Gujarat-382010 INDIA
Web site Address	**https://ssnnl.gujarat.gov.in**
Contact Details	079-23254589, 23254592, 23252414
Email Id	dgm-depo-ssnnl@gujarat.gov.in
b. Date of incorporation	24/03/1988
c. Business Carried on by the Company and its subsidiaries with the details of branches or units, if any:	The Company is executing the Sardar Sarovar (Narmada) Project comprising a dam across the river Narmada in Nandod Taluka of Narmada District in the State of Gujarat; a canal system emanating from the reservoir called the Sardar Sarovar impounded by the construction of the said dam; Power Houses at foot of the Said dam and at the canal head and all other works incidental or ancillary to the said project, in accordance with the directions of the Government of Gujarat.
d. Brief particulars of them engagement of the company	The Company is a wholly owned Government Company and the appointment of Board of Directors is made by the Government of Gujarat. At present, constitution of the Board is having total 12 Directors meeting with Chairman & Managing Director.

e. Name, Address, DIN and Occupation of the Directors

Sr. No.	Name with Office Address	Designation	DIN	Occupation
1.	**Shri Mukesh Puri, IAS (Rtd.)** Chairman & Managing Director, SSNNL, Block No. 12, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar.	Chairman and Managing Director	03582870	Former Additional Chief Secretary, Home Department, Government of Gujarat
2.	**Shri Manoj Kumar Das, IAS** Chief Secretary to Government of Gujarat, Block No. 1, 5th Floor, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar.	Director	06530792	Chief Secretary to Government of Gujarat.
3.	**Shri Abhay Kumar, IAS** Additional Chief Secretary to Water Resource Department, Government of Rajasthan, Water Resource Department, Jaipur-, Rajasthan, India.	Director	02389148	Additional Chief Secretary, Water Resource Department, Government of Rajasthan
4.	**Dr. Amarjit Singh, IAS (Rtd.)** Rtd. Secretary, MoWR, 524/2, Sector 8 Gandhinagar	Independent Director	-	Former Secretary, Ministry of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation, Government of India.
5.	**Shri C. V. Som, IAS** Additional Chief Secretary to Government (Narmada) Water Resources, Water Supply & Kalpsar Department, Block No. 9, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar – 382 010.	Director	06986828	Additional Chief Secretary (R&R) & Additional Chief Secretary (Narmada) (I/C) to Narmada Water Resources, Water Supply & Kalpsar Department, Government of Gujarat.
6.	**Dr. Jayanti Ravi, IAS** Additional Chief Secretary Revenue Department, Block 11, 5th Floor New Sachivalya Complex, Gandhinagar – 382010.	Director	07327139	Additional Chief Secretary, Revenue Department. Government of Gujarat.
7.	**Dr. T. Natarajan, IAS,** Principal Secretary to Government, Finance Department, Block No. 4, 5th Floor, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar – 382 010.	Director	00396367	Principal Secretary, Finance Department, Government of Gujarat
8.	**Shri Amit Arora, IAS** Chief Administrator, Statue of Unity, SOUADTGA, Kevadia, Narmada-Rajpipla. Block No. 12/3, New Sachivalaya Complex, Gandhinagar – 382 010.	Joint Managing Director	08364794	Chief Administrator, Statue of Unity, SOUADTGA, Kevadia, Narmada-Rajpipla.
9.	**Dr. Sharad Kumar Jain** Former Director, National Institute of Hydrology, Roorkee, Visiting Professor, IIT Gandhinagar	Independent Director	11033796	Former Director, National Institute of Hydrology, India; Roorkee, Visiting Professor, IIT Gandhinagar
10.	**Shri Ashwin B. Pandya** Sahayadri Apartments 4A, I.P. extension,	Independent Director Delhi-110092	03068985	Secretary General at International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage
11.	**Dr. Rajesh Rajora, IAS** Vice Chairman, Narmada Valley Development Authority, Narmada Bhavan, 59, Arera Hills, Jail Road, Bhopal-462 011 (Madhya Pradesh).	Director	02601908	Vice Chairman, Narmada Valley Development Authority, Madhya Pradesh
12.	**Dr. Sanjay Belsare** Secretary (CAD), Government of Maharashtra, Hutatma Rajguru Chowk, Madam cama Road, Mantralaya, Mumbai – 400032.	Director	-	Secretary (CAD), Government of Maharashtra,

f. Management's perception of risk factors:	The Fixed Deposits proposed to be taken are unsecured and are not backed by tangible assets. However, the management envisages that the Company will continue making sufficient arrangement to service the interest and repay principal amount.
g. Details of default, including the amount involved, duration of default and present status, in repayment of: (a) Statutory Due (ii) Debenture and Interest thereon (iii) Loan from any bank or financial institution and interest thereon.	The Company has an excellent track record for debt servicing to the public, banks and financial institutions and has been paying regularly statutory dues.

PARTICULARS OF THE DEPOSIT SCHEME:

a. Date of passing of Board Resolution:	30/09/ 2026
b. Date of passing of resolution in the General Meeting authorizing the invitation of such deposits:	To be passed
c. Type of deposits: Secured/ Unsecured	Unsecured
d. Amount which the Company can raise by way of deposits as per the Act and the rules made there under, and aggregate of deposits actually held on the last day of the immediately preceding financial year and on the date of issue of the Circular or advertisement and amount of deposit proposed to be raised and amount of deposit repayable within the next twelve months:	Amounts that the Company can raise: 35% of the paid-up capital and free reserves of the Company. (a) Total Amount that the Company can raise: Rs.22064.58 Crores (approx.) as on 31/03/2026. (as per provisional data for F.Y.2025-26) (b) Aggregate deposits of the Company as on 31/03/2026: Rs.721.10 crores. (c) Aggregate amount of deposits as on the date of issue of the circular i.e. Date: 31/08/2026 : Rs.912.15 crore. (d) Amount of deposits proposed to be raised: Rs.2,000 Crore. (The total amount of deposits that can be raised from public is up to Rs.22064.58 at any point of time). (e) Amount of deposits repayable within the next twelve months i.e. from Date: 01/04/2026 to 31/03/2027, Rs.499.48 Crores.

e. Terms of raising Shree Nidhi Fixed Deposits

	Scheme A Non Cumulative	Scheme B Cumulative	Scheme C Monthly Income
	Interest per annum	Interest per annum	Interest per annum
Duration	1 Year 2 Year	2 Year	1 Year 2 Year
Rate of Interest p.a.	5.50% 6.00%	6.00 %	5.25% 5.75%
Mode of Payment	Cheque / Bank Draft		
Repayment	Cheque/ Bank Draft		

Terms & Conditions:

1. For Scheme A & B minimum amount of deposit is Rs.5,000/- and in multiple of Rs.1,000/- thereafter. And for Scheme-C minimum amount of deposit is Rs.15000/- and if multiple of Rs.5000/- threreafter.
2. Interest will be paid on 30th September and 31st March and on maturity in case of non-cumulative deposits.
3. Interest will be compounded half yearly on 30thSeptember and 31st March in case of cumulative deposits.
4. The Depositor(s) can give instructions with regard to en-cash/renewal before a week, in the absence of such a mandate, Nigam will automatically renew the deposit for the same period as the original deposit at the prevailing rate on the date of maturity with principal amount of deposit.
5. Above revised rates will be applicable on new deposits and renewals of old deposit w.e.f. 01/10/2026.

NOTE: ***(1) Ceiling of Minimum amount of deposit shall not be applicable in case of schemes implemented by Government of Gujarat. (2) As per the policy of the Nigam no brokerage is payable for mobilization of deposit under the scheme.***

f. Proposed time schedule mentioning the date of opening of the Scheme and the time period for which the circular or advertisement is Valid	The Scheme is proposed to be opened on 01/10/2026 and will valid until the expiry of the six months from the closure of the financial year in which it is issued i.e. 30th September, 2026 or until the date of on which the financial statement is laid before the Company in Annual General Meeting, whichever is earlier.
g. Reason or object of raising the Deposits	For execution of Sardar Sarovar Project.
h. Credit Rating Obtained	Name of Credit Rating Agencies: CARE Ratings Limited Rating obtained: 'CARE BBB+; Stable [Triple B Plus Outlook:Stable]. Meaning of Rating obtained: Instrument with this rating are considered to have moderate degree of safety regarding timely servicing of financial obligations. Such instruments carry moderate credit risk. Date on which rating obtained: vide CARE letter dated 30.03.2026
i. Short particulars of the charge created or to be created for securing such deposits, if any :	As the deposits are unsecured therefore charge is not created.
j. Any financial or other material interest of the directors, promoters or key managerial personnel in such deposits and the effect of such interest in so far as it is different from the interests of other persons :	There is no financial or other material interest of Directors or Promoters or key managerial personal of the Nigam in such deposits.

2. DETAILS OF ANY OUTSTANDING DEPOSITS:

a. Amount Outstanding (as on 31/03/2026)	Rs.872.48 Crores (5,94,113 depositors)
b. Date of acceptance :	From 01/04/2025 to 31/03/2026
c. Total amount accepted :	Rs.206.31 Crores
d. Rate of interest:	Ranges from 5.75 % To 6.50%
e. Total number of depositors :	5,94,113 Position as on 31/3/2026
f. Default If any, in repayment of deposits and payment of interest thereon, if any, including number of depositors, amount and duration of default involved;	No
g. Any waiver by the depositors, of interest accrued on deposits;	No

Note: The company has obtained extension of time for repayment of outstanding deposits & hence repayable on maturity vide CLB Mumbai order No.07/2015 u/s 74(2) Dated 09/03/2015.

3. FINANCIAL POSITION OF THE COMPANY:

a. Profits of the Company, before and after making provision for tax, for the three financial years immediately preceding the date of issue of circular or advertisement:

Year Particular	2025-26 (Provisional)	2024-25 (Audited)	2023-24 (Audited)
Profit Before Tax	-793.90	-509.59	-1056.12
Profit After Tax	-793.90	-509.59	-1056.12

b. Dividends declared by the Company in respect of the said three financial years; interest coverage ratio for last three years (Cash profit after tax plus interest paid or interest paid)

Year	2025-26 (Provisional)	2024-25 (Audited)	2023-24 (Audited)
Dividend declared by the Company	Nil	Nil	Nil
Interest coverage ratio for last three years (Cash profit after tax plus interest paid or interest paid)	Nil	Nil	Nil

c. A summary of the financial position of the Company as in the three audited balance sheets immediately preceding the date of issue of circular or advertisement:

(Rs. in crore)

Year	2025-26 (Provisional)	2024-25 (Audited)	2023-24 (Audited)
I. Equity and Liabilities			
(1) Shareholder's fund			
(a) Share Capital	73,532.19	71,181.22	71,181.22
(b) Reserve & Surplus	-11,237.44	-10,441.26	-9,937.56
(2) Share application money pending for allotment	746.90	2,350.99	1,501.14
(3) Non-Current Liabilities			
(a) Long term borrowings	459.11	640.76	476.96
(b) Other Long Term Liabilities	310.35	314.27	313.99
(c)Long Terms provision	10.86	10.88	11.42
(4) Current Liabilities			
(a) Short Term Borrowings	773.05	577.12	463.24
(a) Trade Payables	-	-	137.70
(b) Other Current Liabilities	678.64	644.43	762.63
(c) Short Term Provisions	268.89	359.50	3.61
Total	**65,542.55**	**65,637.91**	**64,914.35**
II. Assets			
1. Non-current Assets			
(a) Fixed Assets			
(i)Tangible Assets	59,424.28	59,072.38	59,252.91
(ii) Intangible Assets	6.14	4.63	4.63
(iii) Capital Work-in-Progress	1,506.35	1,408.23	1,042.90
(iv) Intangible assets under development	-	-	-
(v) Incidental Expenditure pending capitalization	-	-	-
(b)Non-current Investment	4.95	4.23	4.23
(c) Long term Loans and advances	453.49	502.26	271.94
(d) Other non-current assets	184.72	370.27	588.87
2. Current Assets			
(a) Trade Receivables	5.98	6.57	3.85
(b) Cash & Cash equivalents	2,348.88	2,885.16	2,538.00
(c) Short term Loan and Advances	-	-	-
(d) Other Current Assets	1,607.76	1,384.18	1,207.02
Total …	**65,542.55**	**65,637.91**	**64,914.35**

d. Audited Cash Flow Statement for the three years immediately preceding the date of issue of circular of advertisement.

(Rs. in crore)

Particulars	As at 31st March 2026 (Provisional)	As at 31st March 2025 (Audited)	As at 31st March 2024 (Audited)
(A) CASH FLOW FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES :	-70.70	20.90	-436.87
(B) CASH FLOW FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES :			
Net Decrease/(Increase) in fixed assets, Capital Work	-1,415.44	-1,031.64	-516.98
Decrease / (Increase) in Loans and Advances	185.55	218.35	60.61
Decrease / (Increase) in Trade Receivable	-	-	-
Decrease / (Increase) in Investments	591.66	-851.37	-10.73
Investments			
Consideration received on disposal of assets	30.42	2.97	0.74
Decrease / (Increase) in Other Current Assets	-	-	-
Consideration received on disposal of assets	-	-	-
Decrease / (Increase) in Investment	-	-	-
(Decrease) / Increase in Provisions	-	-	-
(Decrease) / Increase in Trade Payable & Other Liabilities	-	-	-
Interest Received	91.65	73.70	45.44
Net Cash Outflow from investing activities	**-516.16**	**-1,587.99**	**-420.92**
(C) CASH FLOW FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES :			
Proceeds from issue of share capital	749.69	849.85	2,463.77
Proceeds from Borrowing (net)	14.27	277.68	-327.61
Interest & Other Financial Costs	-93.00	-64.64	-65.45
Net Cash Inflow from financing activities	670.96	1,062.89	2,070.71
Net increase/(decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	84.10	-504.20	1,212.92
Add : Cash and Cash equivalents - Opening Balance	1,914.09	2,418.29	1,205.37
Cash and Cash equivalents - Closing Balance	1,998.19	1,914.09	2,418.29

e. Any change in accounting policies during the last three years and their effect on the profits and the reserves of the Company: There is no change in accounting policy except that capitalisation of capital work in process was done w.e.f. 01/04/2015 as cut-off date.

6. A DECLARATION BY THE DIRECTORS THAT:

a. the Company has not defaulted in the repayment of deposits accepted either before or after the commencement of the Act or payment of interest there on;
b. the Board of directors have satisfied themselves fully with respect to the affairs and prospects of the Company and that they are of the opinion that having regard to the estimated future financial position of the Company, the Company will be able to meet its liabilities as and when they become due and that the Company will not become insolvent within a period of one year from the date of issue of the circular or advertisement;
c. the Company has complied with the provisions of the Act and the rules made there under;
d. the compliance with the Act and the rules does not imply that repayment of deposits is guaranteed by the Central Government;
e. the deposits accepted by the Company before the commencement of the Act will be repaid along with interest within the stipulated term of Fixed Deposit on their due dates and until they are repaid, they shall be treated as unsecured and ranking paripassu with other unsecured liabilities;
f. in case of any adverse change in credit rating, depositors will be given a chance to withdraw deposits without any penalty;
g. the deposits shall be used only for the purposes indicated in the Circular or circular in the form of advertisement;
h. the deposits accepted by the Company are unsecured and rank paripassu with other unsecured liabilities of the Company;

The text of this circular has been approved by the Board of Directors of the Company in its meeting held on **dated 30/09/2026** and is being issued under the authority and in the name of the Board of Directors of the Company. A copy of this advertisement duly signed by majority of the Directors of the Company is being delivered to the Registrar of Companies, Gujarat, for registration.

Date : 30 /09/ 2026
Place : Gandhinagar

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of Sardar Sarovar Narmada Nigam Limited
-sd-
(MukeshPuri, IAS)
Chairman & Managing Director
(DIN:03582870)

SIGNED BY

-sd-
Shri Mukesh Puri, IAS (Rtd.)
Chairman & Managing Director
(DIN : 03582870)
-
(Shri Abhay Kumar, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 02389148)
-sd-
(Shri C. V. Som, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 06986828)
-sd-
(Dr. T. Natarajan, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 00396367)
-sd-
(Dr. Sharad Kumar Jain)
Independent Director
(DIN : 11033796)
-
(Dr. Rajesh Rajora, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 02601908)

(Shri Manoj Kumar Das, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 06530792)
-sd-
(Dr. Amarjit Singh, IAS (Rtd.))
Independent Director
(DIN : -)
-
(Dr. Jayanti Ravi, IAS)
Director
(DIN : 07327139)
-sd-
(Shri Amit Arora, IAS)
Joint Managing Director
(DIN : 08364794)
-
(Shri Ashwin B. Pandya)
Independent Director
(DIN : 03068985)
-
(Dr. Sanjay Belsare)
Director
(DIN : -)

INF/1556/2026-27

Odisha Coal and Power Limited

(A Govt. of Odisha Company)
Zone-A, 4th Floor, Fortune Towers, Chandrasekharpur, Bhubaneswar-751023, Odisha. E- mail : hrd@ocpl.org.in

Advertisement No: OCPL/HR/2026/01 **Date: 14/10/2026**

Odisha Coal and Power Limited (OCPL), A Government of Odisha company, is in the field of Coal Mining. OCPL intends to recruit dynamic and competent professionals in the below mentioned positions:

Sl. No.	Name of the Post / Grade & IDA Pay Scale	Number of Posts (Reserved for)*
1.	Addl. General Manager (Finance) E7 / (Rs.1,23,100/- to Rs.2,15,900/-)	01 (UR)
2.	Manager (Finance) E4 / (Rs.73,300/- to Rs.2,06,100/-)	01 (UR)
3.	Manager (Mining) E4 / (Rs.73,300/- to Rs.2,06,100/-)	01 (UR)
4.	Dy. Manager (Mining) E3 / (Rs.67,700/- to Rs.2,08,700/-)	01 (UR)
5.	Dy. Manager (Geology) E3 (Rs.67,700/- to Rs.2,08,700/-)	01 (UR)
6.	Dy. Manager (Environment) E3 / (Rs.67,700/- to Rs.2,08,700/-)	01 (UR)
7.	Sr. Asst. Manager/Asst. Manager (Survey) E2/E1 (Rs.67,700/-to Rs.2,08,700/-) /(Rs.56,100/- to Rs.1,77,500/-)	01 (UR)
8.	Asst. Manager (Mining) E1 / (Rs.56,100/- to Rs.1,77,500/-)	04 (ST:01, SC:01, UR:02)
9.	Medical Officer (Male/Female) E2/E1 (Rs.67,700/-to Rs.2,08,700/-) /(Rs.56,100/- to Rs.1,77,500/-)	01 (UR)
10.	Overman S2/S1 (Rs.35,400/-to Rs.1,12,400/-)	02 (UR)

For detailed advertisement, eligibility, pay scale & procedure to apply, please visit our website www.ocpl.org.in.
Last date for submission of online application: 5:00 PM of 14.11.2026
 # Corrigendum, if any, will be published in our website only.

Dy. General Manager (HR)

ನಗರಸಭಾ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಲಯ, ನಂಜನಗೂಡು

ಮೈಸೂರು ಜಿಲ್ಲೆ, ಮೈಸೂರು, ದೂರವಾಣಿ: 08221-226236/08221-226888
ಇ-ಮೇಲ್: itstaff_ulb_nanjangud@yahoo.co.in ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್ : www.nanjanaguducity.mrc.gov.in

ಸಂ: ನನಕಾ/ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕಶಾಖೆ/ಸ.ಇಂ/ಟೆಂ-12/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ: 12.10.2026

ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ (ಕೆ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ)

ನಂಜನಗೂಡು ನಗರಸಭಾ ವ್ಯಾಪ್ತಿಯಲ್ಲಿ 2023-24ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನ 15ನೇ ಯೋಜನೆ (ಎನ್.ಎಂ.ಪಿ.ಸಿ) ಅನುದಾನ ಹಾಗೂ 2026-27ನೇ ಸಾಲಿನ ನಗರಸಭಾ ಅನುದಾನದಲ್ಲಿ ಅನುಮೋದನೆಗೊಂಡಿರುವ ಈ ಕೆಳಕಂಡ ಕಾಮಗಾರಿಯನ್ನು ಲೋಕೋಪಯೋಗಿ ಇಲಾಖೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಚಾಲ್ತಿ ಸಾಲಿಗೆ ನೋಂದಾಯಿತ ಅರ್ಹ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ದಾರರು KTTP ನಿಯಮಗಳ ಅನ್ವಯ 1999 ಹಾಗೂ 2000ರ ಪಾರದರ್ಶಕ ಕಾಯ್ದೆಗೆ ಒಳಪಟ್ಟು ಪ್ರತ್ಯೇಕವಾಗಿ ಕೆಪಿಪಿಪಿ ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ನ್ನು ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದೆ. **1) ಇಡೆಂಟ್‌ನಂ: DMA/2026-27/WS/WORK_INDENT62974** ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ ರೂ. 125.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು. **2) ಇಡೆಂಟ್‌ನಂ: DMA/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT62996** ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ ರೂ. 50.00 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು. **3) ಇಡೆಂಟ್‌ನಂ: DMA/2026-27/OW/ WORK_INDENT61703** ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ ರೂ. 9.90 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು. **4) ಇಡೆಂಟ್‌ನಂ: DMA/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT62997** ಅಂದಾಜು ಮೊತ್ತ ರೂ. 5.75 ಲಕ್ಷಗಳು. ಆಸಕ್ತಿಯುಳ್ಳ ಅರ್ಹ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ದಾರರು **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** ನಿಂದ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಷರತ್ತು, ಇಎಂಡಿ ವಿವರ ಹಾಗೂ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ದಸ್ತಾವೇಜನ್ನು ಡೌನ್‌ಲೋಡ್ ಮಾಡಿಕೊಂಡು ಆನ್‌ಲೈನ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ಗಳನ್ನು ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬಹುದು. ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಆಕ್ಷೇಪಣೆಗಳನ್ನು ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವ ಮತ್ತು ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಫಾರಂ ಡೌನ್‌ಲೋಡ್ ಮಾಡಿಕೊಳ್ಳುವ ಹಾಗೂ ಭರ್ತಿ ಮಾಡಿದ ಟೆಂಡರ್‌ನ್ನು ಸಲ್ಲಿಸುವ ಕಡೆಯ **ದಿನಾಂಕ: 28.10.2026** ಹಾಗೂ ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಬಿಡ್ ಹಾಗೂ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ತೆರೆಯುವ ದಿನಾಂಕ: **29.10.2026.** ಟೆಂಡರ್ ನಿಬಂಧನೆ, ಷರತ್ತುಗಳು ಹಾಗೂ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ಮಾಹಿತಿಯನ್ನು ಕಛೇರಿಯ ವೇಳೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ತಾಂತ್ರಿಕ ಶಾಖೆಯನ್ನು ಸಂಪರ್ಕಿಸುವುದು.

ಸೂಚನೆ:- ಕಾರಣಾಂತರಗಳಿಂದ ಮೇಲೆ ತಿಳಿಸಿದ ಟೆಂಡರ್ ದಿನಾಂಕಗಳು ಹಾಗೂ ಇತರೆ ಬದಲಾವಣೆಗಳಾದಲ್ಲಿ ದಿನಪತ್ರಿಕೆಗಳಲ್ಲಿ ಪ್ರಕಟಿಸಲಾಗುವುದಿಲ್ಲ. ಕೆ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ.ಪಿ ಪೋರ್ಟಲ್‌ನಲ್ಲಿ ಸೂಚಿಸಲಾಗುವುದು

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Onboarding's Missing Link

By Sujaya Banerjee

One new hire at a Bengaluru product firm reportedly spent her first week signing 41 acknowledgment forms, sitting through a two-hour culture film, downloading nine apps, and hunting for the one login that lets her open her email. By Friday she had met the founder on a video call, received a branded hoodie, and completed a personality quiz. What she had not done, however, was understand her first deliverable.

That gap between activity and clarity is the quiet crisis in organisations' onboarding process. Companies spend months finding the right candidate, then lose them almost immediately. Research shows enterprises may be losing 30-40% of new hires within the first 90 days simply because onboarding is still stuck in the classroom era.

The problem with onboarding in most places is that it has become pretentious, heavier and more complicated. Process weight buries the person under paperwork, and sometimes a stretched-out timeline turns orientation into a year-long calendar. The instinct behind elaborate onboarding is sound. But a new employee doesn't need 41 forms. They need to understand how the business makes money, where their role sits in the value chain, and what problems they have been hired to solve. The data on early attrition is brutal. Nearly 60% of resignations occur within the first 18 months, and employees take 6-9 months to reach full productivity. Replacing a mid-level manager costs opportunity, training, and lost productivity.

The organisations getting this right share a common philosophy: they delay tasks, accelerate context. The best onboarding programmes do not rush new hires into execution. They spend the first days and weeks building a mental map of the business, its model, value chain, customers, constraints, and current challenges.

Here's how some front runners are getting it right:

1. Build on values: At one leading Indian organisation, new employees follow a carefully designed induction schedule, meeting key stakeholders and learning essential processes. But the most important element is interaction with the managing director, who focuses not on targets or operations, but on values. This emphasis on values from the outset builds the cultural foundation that drives performance and retention.

2. Focus on training: Another leading engineering and technology company takes a different but equally effective approach. This company conducts a detailed gap analysis to identify where new graduate hires need the most training. The result is a structured, self-paced curriculum that cuts training time from five months to three months and reduces hiring and onboarding costs by 40%. New hires can contribute from day one because they understand the technical landscape they are entering.

3. Emphasis on business: The most neglected element of onboarding is also the most important: helping new employees understand where they add value. This requires more than a PowerPoint on company history. It requires an honest conversation about the business model, how revenue is generated, what the cost structure looks like, where the organisation wins and where it struggles.

4. Being transparent: New hires will be better equipped to contribute meaningfully if they know the real problems the organisation is facing. They won't waste time solving the wrong problems or propose solutions that have already been tried and failed.

They will also have a better understanding of the constraints within which they are operating. This is not about overwhelming new joiners with organisational dysfunction. It is about treating them as adults who can handle complexity and challenges, and who deserve to understand the context in which they will work.

(The writer is CEO, Capstone People Consulting)

NAGARJUNA VIDYANIKETAN

Walk-in-Interviews 25th October 2026
Time 9:00 am to 2:30 pm
CBSE / CAMBRIDGE CURRICULUM

Applications are invited for various positions as indicated below:

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PRT : All Subjects

TGT: All Subjects - English, Maths, Science, Social Studies, Hindi, Kannada, Sanskrit, French, Computer Science.

PGT: All Subjects - English, Maths, Physics, Biology, Chemistry, Psychology, Economics, Business Studies, Computer Applications, Physical Education, Artificial Intelligence, Accountancy, Political Science,History, Informatics Practices.

Co-curricular Activities: Sports Coaches,Dance,Music,Yoga,Art & Craft

TEACHING POSITIONS FOR IGCSE, AS & A LEVEL (CAMBRIDGE CURRICULUM)
English, Maths, Physics, Biology, Chemistry, Global Perspective,

NON - TEACHING POSITIONS
Relationship Manager • Creative and UI Designer • Science lab Assisstant
Professional Marketing Executive • Front Office Executive
Accountant • Admin Officer • Librarian • Special Educator

Candidates must possess good communication skills in English and adequate computer literacy. Updated resumes with a recent passport-size colour photograph can also be emailed to hr@nagarjunavidyaniketan.com

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- **Shobhaben Pratapbhai Patel School of Pharmacy & Technology Management:** Management - Marketing, Operations.
- **Anil Surendra Modi School of Commerce:** Accounting & Finance, General Management/ Marketing/ Management/ Business Management, Quantitative Techniques, Law.
- **Balwant Sheth School of Architecture:** Architecture.
- **School of Branding & Advertising:** Marketing, Branding and Advertising, Creative Communication and Execution. **Post Graduate Program in Digital Media & Marketing Communication:** Digital Marketing.
- **School of Performing Arts:** Western Music (Vocals), Western Music (Drums), Western Music (Piano), Western Music (Guitar), Indian Music (Sitar).
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NAVI MUMBAI CAMPUS
- **School of Technology Management & Engineering:** Data Sciences/ Business Analytics/ Artificial Intelligence, BSH- Mathematics.

Last date to Apply: 25th October 2026

For detailed job descriptions and qualifications required for the above positions (School / Campus - wise), visit 'Careers' at https://nmims.edu or scan the QR code.

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Log on to https://rvu.edu.in/careers for detailed notification and to apply. Last date to apply is 15 November 2026.

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ESSENTIAL QUALIFICATION : Master's Degree with at least 50% marks & B.Ed. from any UGC recognized University
AGE : (For External Candidates) - Not more than 50 yrs.
(For Internal Candidates) - As per DAV norms.
PAY COMMISSION : As per DAVCMC norms

Applications are invited within 20 days from the date of publication of the advertisement on the prescribed form. Application forms can be downloaded from the website **www.davcmc.net.in** which will be submitted alongwith demand draft of Rs.250/- in favour of 'Secretary, DAV College Managing Committee, New Delhi' alongwith attested copies of educational qualification certificate. **The DAVCMC reserves the right to cancel the recruitment process at any stage.**

Applicants should indicate their preference for various "STATES" on the prescribed form. Candidates already working in DAV Institutions must apply through proper channel.

The services are transferable anywhere in India. General Secretary

PTC India Limited
CIN: L40105DL1999PLC099328
Regd. Offce : 2nd Floor, NBCC Tower, 15, Bhikaji Cama Place, New Delhi-110066

PTC India Limited has extended the timeline for submission of Applications for the Positions of

EXECUTIVE VICE PRESIDENT (EVP)

Candidate(s) with demonstrated experience in the domains of (i) Operations (ii) Business Development & Consulting (iii) Regulatory & Policy (iv) Risk & Compliance (v) Ethics & Vigilance may apply on the strength of upto three domains.

The annual turnover criterion of ₹ 2000 crores applicable to candidates working with SPSEs has been removed.

All other eligibility criteria advertised in July, 2026 shall remain unchanged.

Candidates who have already submitted their applications for the EVP positions during July, 2026 advertisement need not apply again.

Last date for receipt of applications; 11th November, 2026

Only Online application shall be accepted.
For more info; visit Careers Section at www.ptcindia.com

AI ENGINEERING SERVICES LIMITED
(A wholly owned subsidiary of AI Assets Holding Ltd.)
RECRUITMENT NOTICE

AI Engineering Services Limited (Formerly Known as Air India Engineering Services Ltd.) is the largest Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul facility in the aviation industry of India and is a Public Sector Undertaking of Government of India, invites applications from eligible candidates for filling up the following posts in **Security Department on Fixed Term Contract Basis:**

S No.	Post	Vacancies / Place of Posting	Consolidated Monthly Salary (All Inclusive)
1	Regional Security Officer	01 (Chennai)	₹ 47,625/-
2	Assistant Supervisor (Security) – Female	01 (Chennai)	₹ 27,940/-
3	Assistant Supervisor (Security) – Male	03 (Trivandrum)	₹ 27,940/-
4	Assistant Supervisor (Security) – Male	05 (Mumbai)	₹ 27,940/-
5	Assistant Supervisor (Security) – Male	01 (Kolkata)	₹ 27,940/-

TOTAL VACANCIES: 11

The detailed Recruitment Notification containing eligibility criteria, educational qualifications, requisite experience, age limit, terms & conditions and application procedure is available on the official websites: www.aiesl.in | www.aiahl.in

LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION OF APPLICATION: 03.11.2026

Candidates are advised to carefully read the detailed Recruitment Notification before submitting their applications.

HUMAN RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
AI ENGINEERING SERVICES LIMITED

B.M.S. EDUCATIONAL TRUST®

B.M.S. COLLEGE OF LAW
AUTONOMOUS
Bull Temple Road, BANGALORE-560 019

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for the following positions:

Office Superintendent	Graduate with proven administrative capabilities experience in HR operations, Accounts, Statutory Compliance with aptitude for drafting/noting.
Clerk cum Typist (SDA)	Graduate with proficiency in office software, office procedures, English & Kannada typing.

Note: Salary will commensurate with merit and experience as per Management norms. Preference will be given to candidates with work experience in educational institutions.

Apply Online: www.bmscl.ac.in/careers.php / email: info@bmscl.ac.in on or before 22 October, 2026

TATA INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES (TISS)
V.N. Purav Marg, Deonar, Mumbai-400 088
A Deemed to be University
A Grant-in-Aid Institute under Ministry of Education, GoI

Online applications are invited in the prescribed Application Form from eligible candidates for appointment to the post of **Deputy Registrar, Assistant Registrar, Deputy Librarian, Assistant Librarian, Assistant Manager (Publications), System Analyst cum Programmer, Health Officer, Field Work Co-Ordinator, Counsellor, Section Officer and Security Officer** at respective campuses of the Institute. Last date of receipt of application is 30 days from the date of publication of the advertisement in **"Employment News".** For detailed advertisement, please visit Institute website **https://www.tiss.ac.in/admin-positions/**

Henceforth, Any changes/corrigendum/amendments/updates/ cancellation notice related to this advertisement shall be published on the above Institute website only.

Date: 07.10.2026 **Officiating Registrar**

Advt. No. TISS/NON-TEACHING POSITIONS/2026/02

GSPL Transmission Limited | GSPL India Gasnet Limited

GSPL Transmission Ltd. (GTL) - Erstwhile Gujarat State Petronet Ltd. is having the mandate of laying the high-pressure cross-country pipeline across the State of Gujarat. GTL has successfully created Gas Grid of approx. 2800 kms in Gujarat. GTL has gone PAN India through its JV Companies- GIGL and GITL. GTL and its JV company- GIGL are currently seeking competent industry professionals for the following positions:

PROJECTS — JOB CODE: PROJ26
Manager/Assistant Manager/Senior Officer/Officer
Qualification : B.E./B.Tech. (Mechanical/Electrical/E&C/IC/Civil/HSE/Fire & Safety)
Age : Minimum 24 years and Maximum 45 years
Experience : 9/6/3/2 years of experience in the Hydrocarbon sector out of which minimum 03 years of experience for Assistant Manager & above and 01 year of experience for Senior Officer & below, in gas/product pipeline is must.

FINANCE & ACCOUNTS — JOB CODE: F&A26
Senior Officer
Qualification : Bachelors in Finance/Business Informatics/Information Systems/ Computer Science/Data Analytics with Masters in Finance/CA
Age : Minimum 26 years and Maximum 36 years
Experience : Minimum 03 years of experience with strong financial analysis skills along with Proficiency in SAP FICO module. Knowledge of financial master data concepts along with familiarity with reporting tools like Power BI and SAP Analytics Cloud (SAC) is preferred.

SECRETARIAL — JOB CODE: SEC26
Manager/Assistant Manager
Qualification : Graduate with Professional qualification of Company Secretary
Age : Minimum 28 years and Maximum 45 years
Experience : Minimum 09/06 years of post-qualification experience, with at least 05 years of proven expertise in managing corporate secretarial and compliance matters with only Listed entity.

SAP — JOB CODE: SAP26
Manager / Assistant Manager
Qualification : B.E./ B.Tech. (IT/ E&C/ Computers) /BCA
Age : Minimum 27 years and Maximum 45 years
Experience : 9/6 years of experience out of which minimum 6/4 years in handling SAP consulting or support role, including experience with end-to-end implementation projects activities in SAP ECC / HANA is required. Certification in SAP – ABAP and SAP-FICO is preferred.

The positions will be on Regular / Long term contract basis and compensation shall be at par with the industry standards.

Only Full-time regular courses from a recognized/AICTE approved Indian University/Institute shall be considered. For detailed job profile and to submit your application, please visit our website at www.gspltrans.com. Navigate to: **Careers → Latest Opening → Apply** with the mentioned Job Code by 23rd October, 2026.

GSPL Transmission Limited
GTL Bhavan, Plot E-18, GIDC Electronics Estate, Nr. K-7 Circle, Sector-26, Gandhinagar-382028

SVKM'S NMIMS Deemed to be UNIVERSITY

NAAC 'A++', Category-I

Invites Applications for Faculty Positions

Professor | Associate Professor | Assistant Professor

The University offers salary and other benefits in line with the 7th Pay Commission guidelines and has a policy of facilitating & rewarding research outcomes.

SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT — MUMBAI CAMPUS

India's top-ranking B-school, accredited by AACSB and EQUIS, with its MBA programme ranked 73rd globally in the Financial Times Masters in Management 2026 Ranking.

THE ACADEMIC AREA: Business Environment & Strategy, Communication, Finance, Human Resources & Behavioural Sciences, Marketing, Operations & Data Sciences (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Data Science and Analytics).

Candidates having a background in Information Systems, Healthcare Management, and Digital Transformation may also apply.

PRAVIN DALAL SCHOOL OF ENTREPRENEURSHIP & FAMILY BUSINESS MANAGEMENT — MUMBAI CAMPUS

THE ACADEMIC AREA: Business Environment & Strategy, Economics, Finance, Human Resources & Behavioural Sciences, Marketing, Operations & Data Sciences, Operations & Decision Sciences, Information Science/Technology, Law.

Last date to Apply: 25th October 2026

For detailed job descriptions and qualifications required for the above positions (School / Campus-wise), visit 'Careers' at https://nmims.edu or scan the QR code.

In world of uncertainty, India offers reliability, stability: PM

'We Don't Grow At Anyone's Cost. We Grow With World, For World'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: PM Narendra Modi Tuesday sought to position India as a trusted ally while stating that supply chains, energy, minerals, payment systems, and technology are increasingly becoming instruments of pressure and dominance and the routes created by globalisation over the past decades have become chokepoints in several cases.

"One of the biggest questions facing the world today is that of trust, of confidence — the confidence that supplies will continue uninterrupted in times of need. We do not grow at anyone's cost. We grow with the world, and for the world," the PM said at a Bloomberg event. He pitched India's expanding economic and technological capabilities to address global challenges during geopolitical tensions, supply-chain disruptions and growing competition for strategic resources.

The PM also said that India's economic growth is anchored in strong fundamentals, financial resilience and a sustained reform drive, as he cited the 7.8% growth recorded in the June quarter. Modi placed India as a global economic and technology power that seeks to help other countries prosper rather than growing at their expense.

"It is because of this strength that India's sovereign ratings are being upgraded. In a world filled with uncertainty, India offers the assurance of reliability and stability," he said, highlighting GST, labour reforms and steps to make it easier to do business. "We are pursuing reforms with a clear policy direction. India's reform express continues to move ahead at high speed. For us, reforms are not a compulsion. Reforms are our conviction," he said.

PM Modi with former UK PM Rishi Sunak in New Delhi Tuesday

Modi also said that the true measure of economic and technological strength lay not in the ability to control others but in creating opportunities for them, as he argued that India believes in the principle of "power to empower".

"Today, technology is power. Data is power. Knowledge is power. Innovation is power. But the real question is not who possesses power. Rather, the question is how that power is being used," he said, while highlighting the country's digital public infrastructure, affordable mobile data, digital payments and direct benefit transfer as examples of technology widening access to economic opportunities.

'North Indian' accused will flee if given bail, cops tell Madras HC, get a rap

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Chennai: Madras high court has pulled up the Tamil Nadu Police for opposing bail to an accused in a cheating case on the ground that he would flee since he was a "north Indian".

"A person's place of origin is not a ground for apprehending that he will flee. The petitioner (accused) has lived and worked in Chennai for more than two decades. Such an averment ought not to have appeared in an affidavit sworn by a police officer," Justice N Ramesh said on Tuesday.

The court then granted conditional bail to the petitioner, Ankur Kumar Jani, and directed him to to appear before the investigating officer in Coimbatore as and when required. The issue pertains to an arrangement between FIITJEE Limited with Suguna PIP School, Coimbatore, to conduct integrated coaching for students preparing for the JEE and NEET examinations. As per the course scheme, each candidate was required to pay a refundable caution deposit of Rs1 lakh, which was refundable within sixty days of the completion of the course.

However, since the institutions failed to refund the deposit, one D G Vikram, who paid the deposit for his son, filed a complaint against Dinesh Kumar Goyal of FIITJEE Limited and Lakshmi Narayanasamy of Suguna PIP School.

Ankur was not named in the complaint or in the FIR. According to police, he was named in view of an agreement dated Feb 26, 2011, which he is said to have signed on behalf of FIITJEE Limited with the school. It was alleged that the petitioner along with others have caused loss to 262 parents to the tune of Rs 2.62 crore.

Drone drops 7kg explosives near Indo-Pak border; 2 held

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Jaipur: A drone allegedly made three sorties over Rawla in Rajasthan's Sriganganagar district late Monday to drop one of the largest cross-border consignments recovered in the region: 7kg of explosives, two firearms, and more than 600 cartridges.

Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) arrested two suspects from Punjab, both allegedly involved in serious criminal cases there. Agencies are mapping their movements, phone records and possible local contacts.

The seizure triggered a multi-agency security probe amid the festive season. The scale of recovery has alarmed investigators because the consignment allegedly contains material—including what sources claim could be RDX—used to assemble IEDs. Experts are yet to confirm the composition of the haul.

Investigators are probing whether the consignment was meant for a terror plot, a criminal network—or a convergence of both—during the festive period. Police suspect the cache may have been headed for Punjab, though they didn't rule out other destinations. The explosives were packed in multiple layers of plastic sheets, suggesting a planned and protected delivery. Agencies are also examining whether the delivery was linked to criminal gangs operating across Rajasthan, Punjab and Haryana, including networks tied to the Lawrence Bishnoi-Rohit Godara syndicate.

How a photo reunited Nobel peace laureate with kin in TN

Ram.Sundaram
@timesofindia.com

Madurai: A photograph of four men, one of them her father and the rest unidentified, was all Navi Pillay had when she set out in 2007 to find the Tamil relatives her family left behind when they moved to southern Africa over a century earlier.

Nineteen years later, surviving members of the immediate clan at Old Batlagundu in TN's Dindigul gathered around a cake to celebrate the 2026 Nobel Peace Prize being conferred on one of their own.

"We are related by blood…She's my aunt," M Venkatesh Kumar said of Pillay, an 85-year-old jurist and former UN High Commissioner for Human Rights.

Pillay had first visited where her grandparents came from in 1970. Her return in 2007 was to fulfil her father's last wish – to see his native village, pray at the temple to the family deity and trace the kin he had left behind. He couldn't give her their addresses. He handed her instead the photograph that would be her beacon.

When she was in India in 2007 in search of her roots

Pillay stayed a week at a state-owned guesthouse in Dindigul, spending each day chasing clues that ended nowhere. Serendipitously, her search ended over a cup of tea at a shop when a stranger recognised a face in the photograph she showed him as Venkatesh's grandfather.

Much to her delight, the man also gave Pillay directions to what she would soon discover was indeed her ancestral home. "We spoke at length when we met, and she (Pillay) was delighted to finally find her relatives," Venkatesh recalled.

Pillay gave him and other relatives her postal address in Durban, starting a chain of correspondence that has continued since.

On Oct 9, when the Norwegian Nobel Committee named the South African for the Peace Nobel to honour her peace and international law advocacy, it wasn't just her relatives in Old Batlagundu who were elated. Rajkumar and his family, residents of the village but not related to Pillay, cut a cake too.

CM C Joseph Vijay has also congratulated Pillay while Tamil activist Pazha Nedumaran has called for a state felicitation. "We are planning to invite her here for an event when she comes to India next," Venkatesh said. This time, the laureate won't need a photograph to find her way home.

Judges stress that criminal justice system must protect the innocent

▶ Continued from page 1

Invoking English jurist William Blackstone's principle that it was better for guilty people to escape than for an innocent person to suffer, the judges stressed that the criminal justice system must protect the innocent. The court ordered immediate release of the 13 appellants serving life terms, unless they were wanted in another criminal case. It also directed Bihar DGP to constitute a three-member committee of senior officers to review the investigative failures and take administrative action within three months. The state home department must inform HC within a month about its policy for reviewing failed prosecutions and holding erring officers accountable.

TIMES ascent
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इंजीनियर्स इंडिया लिमिटेड (भारत सरकार का उपक्रम) EIL ENGINEERS INDIA LIMITED (A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Engineers India Bhawan, 1, Bhikaiji Cama Place, New Delhi – 110066

WALK IN INTERVIEW
FOR ENGAGEMENT OF EXPERIENCED ENGINEERS ON FIXED TERM BASIS – For Dangote Fertiliser Projects, Nigeria & Ethiopia (Construction Division)

Engineers India Limited, a Navratna PSU and India's leading Total Solutions Engineering Consultancy Company is looking for dynamic individuals with a passion for excellence and the drive to partner in the nation's growth story in various disciplines on Fixed Term Basis for deployment to foreign construction sites of EIL. Apart from consolidated monthly emoluments, personnel deployed to foreign locations will also be eligible for foreign allowances. (Compensation details are available in the detailed advertisement).

Sl. No.	Position	Qualification (Min. 60% for Engg. and 55% for other than Engg.)	Minimum post qualification relevant experience (as on 30.09.2026)	Upper Age (As on 30.09.2026)	Duration of Engagement	Tentative Requirement (Nos.)
1	Associate Engineer Gr.II	BE/B. Tech/B.Sc/ (Engg.) in Civil/ Mechanical/Welding/ NDT/Electrical/ Instrumentation	5 Yrs.	37	2 Yrs	19
2	Associate Engineer Gr.III	BE/B. Tech/B.Sc. (Engg.) in Civil/ Mechanical/Welding/ NDT/Electrical/ Instrumentation	9 Yrs.	41	2 Yrs	47
3	Associate Engineer Gr.IV	BE/B. Tech/B.Sc. (Engg.) in Civil/ Mechanical/Welding/ NDT/Electrical/ Instrumentation	13 Yrs.	45	2 Yrs	36
4	Associate Officer Gr II	Graduate in Arts/ Commerce /Science with Diploma in Material Mgt.	14 Yrs.	37	2 Yrs	7
		Diploma in Engg. with Diploma in Material Mgt.	13 Yrs.	37		
		Degree in any branch of Engg. with Dip. in Material Mgt.	5 Yrs.	37		
Total						109

Reservation and relaxations for PwDs (Persons with Disabilities) shall be as per GOI (Govt of India) guidelines.
Candidates interested in the above positions may go through the detailed advertisement given in Company's website "**http://www.engineersindia.com**" (Careers → Overview → Opportunities@eil) fill and submit application online. The link for online application will be available from **19.10.2026 @1400 hrs to 02.11.2026 @1400 hrs**. Eligible and interested candidates shall complete the registration and submit their application online within the above dates.
(**Caution:** Candidates are advised to beware of spurious recruitment advertisements. Refer to the detailed advertisement published on "**http://www.engineersindia.com**" for authentic information)
HRD/Rectt./Advt./2026-27/11

JAWAHARLAL NEHRU PORT AUTHORITY
Special Economic Zone

CORRIGENDUM

Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority Special Economic Zone (JNPA SEZ) had invited application for different posts vide newspaper advertisement dated 28/11/2025 and subsequent corrigendum dated 25/02/2026. In this regard it may be noted that, the recruitment for the post of Dy CEO and CAP (SEZ) stands withdrawn.
Fresh applications are now invited the post of the Manager (Project) and Fire Superintendent. Those who have applied earlier for the post of Fire Superintendent need not apply again. The detailed advertise may please be accessed through website https:\\jnport.gov.in\ (click on vacancy link). The application (hard copy is must) should be addressed to, Chief Executive Officer, JNPA-SEZ, Udhyam Bhawan, Navi Mumbai - 400707. The last date of submission of application along with the copies of documents as stated above is 28/10/2026 till 5 PM. The shortlisted candidates for the post of 'Manager (Project)' and Fire Superintendent will be called for an interview, which shall be notified in due course, separately to the concerned candidates accordingly.
For Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority - Special Economic Zone (JNPA SEZ)

ASSAM VALLEY FERTILIZER AND CHEMICAL COMPANY LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of Assam, OIL, NFL, HURL & BVFCL
Recruitment of Executive in Business Leadership role on Regular basis

AVFCCL invites applications in Executive cadre on Regular basisfor the post of Vice President (Project). Interested candidates may visit the link JOBS. AVFCCL.NET.IN regarding registration, application process, eligibility criteria, experience requirement, corrigendum, updates, etc.
Registration Start Date : **09.10.2026**
Registration End Date : **29.10.2026**
Regd Office:
4th Foor, NEDFi House, G.S. Road, Dispur, Kamrup - 781006, Assam, India

COAL INDIA LIMITED
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
(A Maharatna Company)
Advertisement No.: 08/2026
RECRUITMENT OF EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONALS IN E-8 GRADE THROUGH LATERAL ENTRY

Coal India Limited (CIL), a Schedule 'A' Maharatna Public Sector Undertaking under the Ministry of Coal, Government of India, invites applications from experienced professionals for lateral induction in its Renewable Energy and Thermal Power verticals. The recruitment aims to strengthen CIL's institutional, managerial and technical capabilities in the emerging energy sector and to support its diversification beyond conventional coal mining operations.
As part of its strategic expansion into the renewable energy and thermal power sectors, CIL seeks accomplished and dynamic professionals to join its leadership team.
A total of **03 (three)** positions are proposed to be filled through lateral recruitment in **E-8** grade across the Renewable Energy and Thermal Power verticals, as detailed below:

Sl. No.	Position / Grade	No. of Posts
1.	General Manager (E-8) – Renewables	01
2.	General Manager (E-8) – Civil (Thermal Power Projects)	01
3.	General Manager (E-8) – Mechanical (Thermal Power Projects)	01
	Total	03

For important dates, online application and detailed information on eligibility criteria, number of vacancies, upper age limit, process of applying, selection process, etc., please refer to the detailed advertisement, which will be released shortly on the CIL website **www.coalindia.in** under the link **"Career with CIL"**.
Any amendment/modification relating to this recruitment will be notified on the CIL website only. Legal jurisdiction shall be Kolkata only. For any queries, please write to **lateral-recruitment.cil@coalindia.in**
GM (HR / Recruitment)
Coal India Limited, Kolkata

StockHolding®
STOCK HOLDING CORPORATION OF INDIA LIMITED
Regd. Office: 301, Centre Point, Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Road, Parel, Mumbai-400 012 **CIN :** U67190MH1986GOI040506
RECRUITMENT NOTICE

StockHolding invites applications from the eligible candidates for the following positions under Fixed Term Engagement (FTE) for Mumbai / Navi Mumbai Location :

Sr. No.	Title of the Position	No. of Positions
1	AVP / VP- IT Infrastructure	01
2	AVP/ VP- IT Applications	01

The eligibility criteria and other details along with a link for online submission of applications are available on the Careers page of the Corporation's website i.e. **https://corporate.stockholding.com/careers/**
Application to be received only in online mode through the Career page of StockHolding. Any applications submitted through any other mode shall be summarily rejected.
Further, corrigendum/addendum, if any, with regard to this advertisement shall be uploaded only on our above website.
Please note that StockHolding reserves the right to rescind/cancel or postpone the recruitment process at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.
The online application window will open after 11:00 AM on **October - 15, 2026 and will be available till 6.00 PM on October 29, 2026.**
Vice President
HWD Department, Mumbai

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- The post of **Alumni Coordinator** from people with strong interpersonal and communication skills. Excellent command over English is mandatory. People with education from Tier I institutes will be preferred.
  The detailed job description for this post, can be found in the careers section at www.dalycollege.org
- **Alumni coordination and Management** from experienced agencies. Agencies with proven track record and working with premium educational institutions will be preferred.
- The post of **Bursar (Civil)** from Civil Engineers with minimum experience of 15 years and excellent communication and computer skills.

Apply to: **jobs@dalycollege.org** within 7 days of the publication date.
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16-ए, अरेरा हिल्स, भोपाल (म.प्र.)-462011
Ph. : 0755-4853295, 4853297, वेब. : www.mpbdc.gov.in
CIN : U45400MP2022SGC060277
No. 8652/E-1557705/HR/2026 (Phase-17) Bhopal, Date : 12.10.2026
RECRUITMENT NOTICE/ADVERTISEMENT

Madhya Pradesh Building Development Corporation Ltd. (MPBDC) is a wholly Govt. owned company incorporated under the Companies Act 2013 and has its registered office at 16-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal. To meet the manpower requirement, MPBDC invites applications for following indicative posts from eligible candidates :
Engineer in Chief (UR-01), Deputation/Contract
For the above posts, interested candidates must submit their application as per Rule Book before last date through proper channel. The last date for submitting online applications may refer the rule book, placed on MPBDC portal **https://mpbdc.mp.gov.in**
M.P. Madhyam/128560/2026 **MANAGER (HR & Admin.)**

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Send your Resume at: hr@futureuniversity.in | Call: 9105057515, 9105050220
Campus: Bareilly-Lucknow Road, Near Faridpur, Bareilly (U.P.) India
www.futureuniversity.in

Advertisement No. 110/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board
invites applications for the post of
Chairman & Managing Director
in
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE)
Last date of submission of online application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on
02nd November, 2026
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on
11th November, 2026
For details login to website **https://pesb.gov.in**
Link for registration of Nodal Officers / Competent authorities is available on PESB website.

GIFT INDIA'S GLOBAL FINANCE-TECH CITY
WE'RE HIRING
GIFT City invites applications from qualified and experienced professionals for the following positions:
- **Asst. Vice President** – Social Activation and Community Engagement
- **General Manager** – Procurement & Contracts (Engineering)

Remuneration will be commensurate with qualifications and experience. The above positions are based at GIFT City, Gandhinagar, Gujarat.
Scan to apply and know more details

MBM UNIVERSITY, JODHPUR
Ratanada, Jodhpur (342011)
No. MBMU/Reg/Estt/2026/7206 Date: 12.10.2026
ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE POST OF VICE-CHANCELLOR
The Chairman, Search Committee, invites applications/nominations from the distiguished academician having a minimum of Ten Years' experience as Professor in a University or College or ten years' experience in an equivalent position in a reputed research and/or academic administrative organization and possessing the highest level of competence, Integrity, morals and Institutional commitment, as per the provisions of Section 11 (2) of the MBM University, Jodhpur Act, 2021. (as amended).
The appointment will be for a period of three years from the date of assuming office or until the age of 70 years, whichever is earlier. The Vice Chancellor shall receive such pay and allowances as may be determined by the State Government from time to time. The applicants are required to apply in the prescribed application format **(Standard Format for C.V.)** alongwith required Information and supporting documents, shall be submitted in both soft (pdf) and hard copies. The softcopy should be mailed to **registrar@mbm.ac.in** on or before **08.11.2026 at 11:59 PM.** The hardcopy of the application/nomination, along with the required information and supporting documents, must reach the following address **"The Chairman, VC Search Committee C/o Registrar, MBM University, Ratanada, Jodhpur (342011)"** on or before **16.11.2026 at 05:00 PM.**
The envelope should be superscibed on the top as **"Application for the post of Vice Chancellor, MBM University, Jodhpur"** and **"Confidential".**
The applicants are required to download the prescribed application format (Standard format for C.V.) from the MBM university, Jodhpur **website: www.mbm.ac.in** or from the website of Lok Bhavan **www.lokbhavan.rajasthan.gov.in**
Registrar

Gautam Buddha University
(Established by the Uttar Pradesh Gautam Buddha University Act, 2002 UP Act No 9 of 2002, passed by the Uttar Pradesh Legislature)
Greater Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar- 201312 (U.P.)
Advertisement No: **GBU/Admin/TS/2026-09 Dated: 14/10/2026**

Gautam Buddha University invites applications from eligible candidates for the **post of Assistant Professors, Associate Professors and Professors** in the following schools:
School of Humanities & Social Sciences; School of Information and Communication Technology; School of Engineering; School of Vocational Studies & Applied Sciences; School of Law, Justice and Governance; School of Management; School of Biotechnology and School of Buddhist Study and Civilization.
For detailed information regarding subjects, specializations, qualifications, experience, pay level, and the prescribed application format, please visit the university website: **www.gbu.ac.in**.
Interested candidates may send their applications in the prescribed format to:
"The Registrar, Gautam Buddha University, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar-201312 (UP) India" on or before 13 November 2026 up to 5:30 PM.
Registrar

CHHATRAPATI SHAHU JI MAHARAJ UNIVERSITY, KANPUR
(Formerly Known as Kanpur University Kanpur - 208024)
Advt.No.:CSJMU/R.Camp./1388/SFS-Teaching/2026 Date : 17.09.2026
Rolling Advertisement (Session 2026-27) for Openings of Teaching Positions under Self Finance Scheme (SFS)
The University invites application from qualified persons with an established record of independent high quality research commitment to teaching and research for the Contractual faculty position under Self Finance Scheme (SFS) at the level of Assistant Professor, Associate Professor in discipline(s) offered by School of Advanced Agriculture Sciences and Technology, School of Creative & Performing Arts, School of Languages, School of Teacher Education (Physical Education Department) School of Engineering and Technology, School of Arts Humanities and Social Sciences (Deen Dayal Shodh Kendra) and Constituent Colleges (Shri Vishambhar Dayal Tripathi Rajkiya Mahavidyalaya, Rajkiya Mahavidyalaya Lotnar Purwa Unnao, Rajkiya Mahavidyalaya Ghatampur, Kanpur Nagar) for the Teaching Position. Salary not a bar for qualified candidate. For Further details and online submission of application against this advertisement please visit: **https://csjmu.ac.in/adsmedia/recruitments**.
Registrar

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Join L&T. Engineer the Future. Build a Legacy.

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Note: L&T does not ask for money from candidates at any stage of the recruitment process. Freshers and those who have applied / interviewed earlier (in the last 6 months) need not apply.

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www.Larsentoubro.com

Why this Maha village has pledged to 'protect darkness'

All the lights that soak our cities when evening comes have the effect of blotting out the night sky. Udmal in Nashik district is going the extra mile to make sure it holds on to the dark. Its efforts also have an economic dimension

Alka.Dhupkar@timesofindia.com

Researchers have found that a child who was born when 250 stars were visible in the night sky would be able to see fewer than 100 with the naked eye from the same place by the time they turned 18.

That's because, between 2011 and 2022, the night sky got about 9.6% brighter each year. Artificial light thrown into the night brightens the sky behind the stars, washing the faintest ones out first.

It's a haunting realisation.

Keeping The Lighting Dark

So, if you live in a place where the night still means darkness, you'll probably want to keep it that way. Udmal — a small Maharashtra village about 420m above sea level — is one such place.

Last year, Udmal's gram sabha formally resolved to protect the night sky, using PESA, a law that gives tribal communities greater control over decisions about their land and local resources. Soon, the village in Nashik district plans to mark every new moon with what it is calling "Batti Gul Amavasya", switching off public lights for the night so that people can stargaze.

"We will protect the darkness," said Vipul Khiradi, 22, who grew up in Udmal and has spent the past few years trying to turn that idea into something the village can actually live by.

But what does it mean to protect darkness? It's not about keeping a village unlit. Udmal today has almost no functioning public streetlights. Villagers once put ordinary bulbs on electricity poles around Diwali, but those have broken. Solar streetlights installed earlier no longer work either. Night-time illumination mostly comes from bulbs and tubelights inside homes. That is one reason the sky remains so dark—but it is hardly an ideal way to achieve it. A village should not have to choose between seeing the road and seeing the stars.

Udmal is now trying to do both.

The new lights planned for Udmal's lanes will point towards the ground rather than scattering light in every direction. They will be kept only as bright as needed, be of warmer intensity and, where possible, be switched off or controlled when nobody needs them.

It sounds like a small change, but it addresses the basic problem with light pollution: much of the light that hides the stars is light nobody actually needs. It escapes upwards, spills sideways or burns through the night long after the street or building it was meant to illuminate has emptied.

For now, the Milky Way is visible in Udmal with the naked eye on a clear, moonless night. Meteor showers can be witnessed, too, and there is relatively little surrounding glow to bleach the horizon.

A Student's Vision

The idea of protecting the night sky began with Khiradi. In 2019, when he was 14 and in class 8 at an Eklavya residential school in Satana, he attended a stargazing programme and learnt to set up a telescope. "I was attracted to the twinkling," he said. "I enjoy looking at the dark sky and understanding astrophysics." Later, during another astronomy programme in Manali, he found himself wondering, "Why can't my village be part of this map?"

In 2021, Khiradi was among a group of students trained as astronomy guides via AstronEra, an organisation that works on protecting dark skies and improving the way outdoor lighting is used. Even while studying for a science degree in Pune, he kept returning to Udmal and to the idea that the village could protect what it had.

But when Khiradi and Shweta Kulkarni, founder of AstronEra, began talking to people in Udmal about protecting the night sky, not everyone immediately saw why it should be a priority. People wanted roads, reliable electricity and piped water. Women walked about 4km to fetch water. Youths often left to study or find work elsewhere.

Not To Be Taken Lightly

But Udmal couldn't be asked to remain poorly lit simply because outsiders might like to visit for stargazing. The argument had to be that better infrastructure did not automatically require more light spilling into the sky.

There were practical concerns, too. Udmal is surrounded by forest. Would lower-intensity lights make people feel less safe given the proximity to wildlife? Could motion-sensitive lights come on when someone approached? When a consultant brought a sample light to the village some people understood the idea immediately. Others needed convincing.

Kulkarni said villagers wanted development, but "on their own terms". Khiradi's persistence helped. So did the growing attention from the administration. There was another reason, too, to care about darkness: insects and pollinators that use darkness to feed, navigate and reproduce. Wildlife changes their behaviour around bright lights. Human sleep and body clocks are also tied to natural cycles of light and darkness.

For a farming village, those effects are tangible. Farming, farm labour and daily-wage work remain the main sources of income. Fewer pollinators can eventually become an agricultural problem.

"We might think dark sky is only for astro tourism. But, actually, dark sky conservation is needed because more than 60% of the species on our planet rely on natural darkness. The first step is conservation of the dark sky and then comes astrotourism," Kulkarni said, adding that "development should happen how the villagers decide".

Udmal now wants its efforts formally recognised and has made an initial application under the "community" category to DarkSky International, a US-based nonprofit that recognises locations that take steps to keep unnecessary artificial light under control. Udmal will collect evidence on how bright its sky is, kinds of lights it has, presence of artificial light and what the village will do as new lighting arrives.

Nashik district has approved Rs 42 lakh for this, including measuring equipment, telescopes and training. That's because Udmal is one village in a much larger experiment, with the state govt working with AstronEra to identify 11 spots where it wants to test different ways of protecting dark skies.

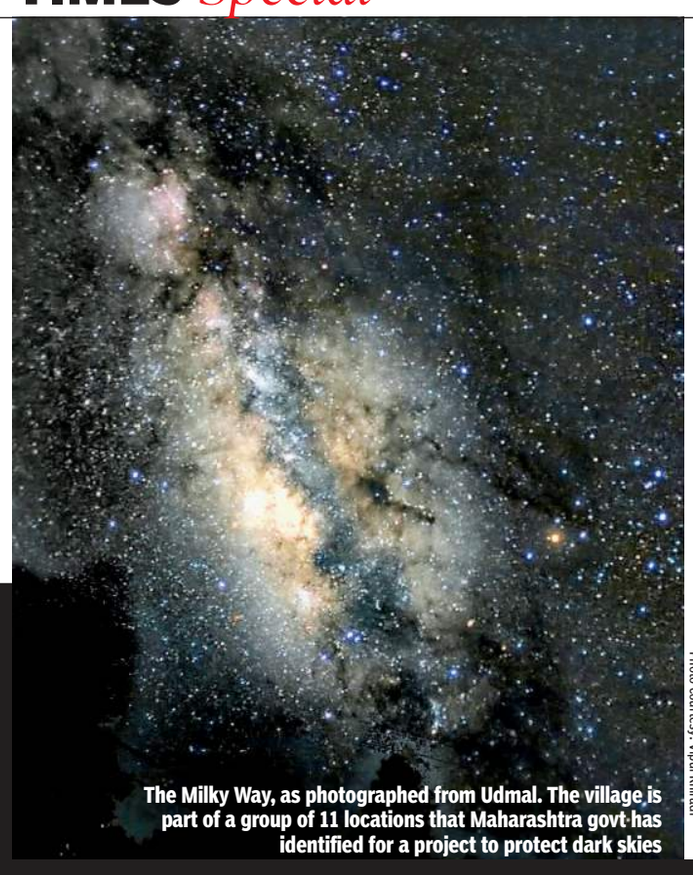
The hope is that the 11 sites can become testing grounds before the state govt decides whether broader rules on outdoor lighting are needed. There are examples elsewhere: France, Slovenia, South Korea and Chile have national controls on artificial light. In New Zealand, the Aoraki Mackenzie region began controlling outdoor lighting in the early 1980s, initially to protect an observatory; today, the Aoraki Mackenzie International Dark Sky Reserve covers 4,367 sqkm.

India has one important example of its own. Hanle in Ladakh became the country's first notified dark-sky reserve in 2022. Its altitude, dry air and limited artificial light make it unusually good for astronomy. But protecting that sky also involves things like warmer bulbs, lampshades and blackout curtains, along with training local residents as astronomy guides.

"Light is everywhere and it is an integral part of our lives. We need to consider how we use it and how it is impacting our environment and behaviour," said Dorje Angchuk of the Indian Astronomical Observatory in Hanle.

That's the concern that Udmal is now confronting. It is not a remote Himalayan observatory site, but a village of about 650 people that wants basic amenities and economic opportunities. The night-sky push can provide some solutions: local youth can be trained to handle telescopes, guide visitors and organise stargazing sessions. Villagers are beginning to work out how visitors might enter the village, where they might stay and how hospitality could be organised. In an agrarian village, this could mean another source of income.

There are no estimates yet for how many people might be trained or earning potential. Nor has Udmal settled on a tourism model. And success might bring its own problems. More visitors can mean more cars, buildings, and lights — things that can make a dark place brighter. But Udmal is taking the questions one at a time: first, work out how to keep the sky dark. Then find what can grow beneath it.



The Milky Way, as photographed from Udmal. The village is part of a group of 11 locations that Maharashtra govt has identified for a project to protect dark skies

Photo courtesy: Vipul Khiradi

HOW THESE URBAN AREAS FOUGHT LIGHT POLLUTION

➤ **Tucson, in Arizona, US,** tried to control light pollution not by switching off lights, but by changing how, where and when they shine, with its efforts going back to the early 1970s. It is a rare example of a major urban centre successfully controlling light pollution.

➤ **Antelope, in US's Oregon,** achieved Dark Sky Community certification by adopting a new outdoor lighting ordinance, conducting periodic measurements, etc. It removed non-compliant streetlights and replaced other lights with suitable alternatives.

➤ **Bisei Town, part of Ibara City in Japan's Okayama Prefecture,** enacted Japan's first Light Pollution Prevention Ordinance in 1989. Efforts to limit light pollution includes educating residents and visitors about the importance and value of night skies.

Source: darksky.org

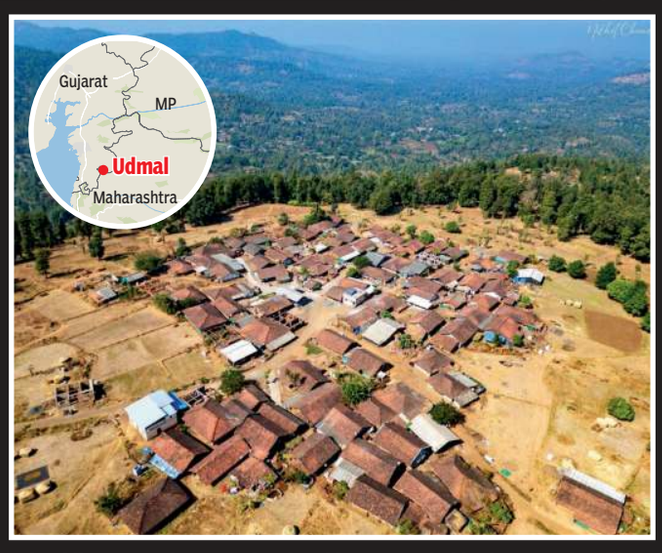


Photo: Tarun Rawat

Udmal lies 420m above sea level and is surrounded by forests. The village has decided to go for lighting that's specifically designed to keep the night sky visible, given that the scatter from a profusion of lights in urban areas — as evident in this photo of the night sky from Delhi — virtually renders any stars invisible to the naked eye

FOR 9 OUT OF 10 INDIANS, LIGHTS BLOT OUT NIGHT SKY

The last global study on light-pollution, published in 2016, estimated that nearly **94% of Indians lived under some degree of light pollution**, while about one in five lived in places where the Milky Way was no longer visible

HOW IS DARKNESS MEASURED?

Sky Brightness | An instrument called a sky quality meter measures how bright the night sky is. The darker the sky, the easier it is to see faint stars.

Bortle Scale | Astronomers also describe skies on a scale of 1 to 9. Bortle 1 is an exceptionally dark sky, where the Milky Way and very faint stars are clearly visible. Bortle 9 is a heavily light-polluted sky.

From Space | Satellites can measure artificial light escaping upwards from towns, and buildings, though it is not the same as measuring how dark the sky looks to someone standing on the ground.

Government of Karnataka
SUVARNA AROGYA SURAKSHA TRUST
(Department of Health & Family Welfare)
Arogya Soudha, 7th Floor, Magadi Road, Bengaluru-560 023.
Ph: 080-22536200 e-mail: directorsast@gmail.com

No: SAST/ADM/TEND/1/2026-ADM(e-Office-321496) Date: 12.10.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Sub: Suvarna Arogya Suraksha Trust invites Tender for Services of Chartered Accountant-reg.

Suvarna Arogya Suraksha Trust, Department of Health & Family Welfare, Government of Karnataka, registered under the Indian Trust Act of 1882, is implementing various Government health Schemes. For the successful implementation of its Schemes, the Trust seeks to hire the Services of Chartered Accountant for one year. Bids have to be submitted on the KPPP Portal at: https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/#/portal/portal-home **from 13.10.2026. The last date for submission of bids in the e-Procurement portal is on 28.10.2026 upto 5.30 p.m.**

Sd/-
Director (Operations)
Suvarna Arogya Suraksha Trust,
Bengaluru

Note approved by Executive Director

DIPR/CP/3216/MAA/2026-27

MANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka undertaking)
Corporate Office, "MESCOM BHAVANA", Bejai, Mangalore - 575 004
Ph: 0824-2885885 CIN: U40109 KA 2002 SGC 030425

No: MESCOM/IT/49/2026-IT/I/269512/2026 Date: 13.10.2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through KPP Portal)

MESCOM invites the tender from the prospective bidders for **"Selection of Service Provider for providing e-sign Aadhaar-based (v2) for Consumers, e-sign Organization-based (v3) for MESCOM officers, and digital execution of agreements using e-stamp services for MESCOM"** vide Tender Enquiry No: **MESCOM/2026-27/SE0201.**

The interested eligible bidders may log on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/** on or after **14.10.2026.** For information about the KPP portal, contact the helpline at +91-9240214000/9240214001 or e-mail address: support@eprochelpdesk.com.

Sd/-,
Superintending Engineer (Ele)(IT)

DIPR/DK/KSMCA/925/26-27 dt: 13.10.2026

For Power Related Complaints contact:
MESCOM Helpline: 1912
9483041912 mescom_official mescom_official

OFFICE OF THE SPECIAL OFFICER AND COMPETENT AUTHORITY
(IMA & other scam)
3rd floor, Podium Block, Visveswaraiah Towers, Dr. Ambedkar Veedhi, Bengaluru - 560 001
Ph: 080-29565353 | email: splocaima21@gmail.com

NOTICE / INVITATION FOR E-AUCTION FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Pursuant to attachment of Immovable properties by the Government under the provisions of the Karnataka Protection of Interest of Depositors in Financial Establishments Act, 2004 (KPIDFE Act) and pursuant to the absolute attachment order by the Hon'ble Special Court, the Special Officer & Competent Authority is issuing notice for e-auction of the Immovable property through e-auction on **'as is where is and whatever there is basis'.** The intending bidders will be required to furnish Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (as mentioned against each auction in the e-portal provided by the Service Provider/Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)

Short description of the Immovable Property (SPLOCA/AUC(2)/CR/06/2025-26)

Properties are free of all encumbrances and are in the name of Competent Authority appointed by Government and confirmed by the Special Court under KPIDFE Act, 2004 and Hon'ble High Court of Karnataka has cleared the title (Khata stands in the name of Competent Authority and Auctioning Authority)

	Details of the Scheduled Property (Clear Title by Court in order No. MISC No.692/2019)	Minimum Bid Price (Rs)	EMD (Rs)	Bid Increase Value (Rs)
1	No.2/3, New PID No.078-W0202-8 (Old PID No.91-76-2/3), Spencer Road, Frazer Town, Bengaluru-05, measuring East to West 52.6 ft and North to South 38 ft aggregatig 1998.8 Sq.ft Location: https://maps.app.goo.gl/MPsttJnuANmSDoKo8 Latitude and Longitude: 12°59'50.0"N 77°36'29.9"E			
(a)	1st Floor, Flat No. FF-01, UDS-399.76, SBA-1602.50 Sq.ft	1,47,06,000/-	14,71,000/-	1,48,000/-
(b)	2nd Floor, Flat No. SF-01, UDS-399.76, SBA-1602.50 Sq.ft	1,48,77,000/-	14,88,000/-	1,49,000/-
(C)	3rd Floor, Flat No. TF-01, UDS-399.76, SBA-1602.50 Sq.ft	1,46,20,500/-	14,63,000/-	1,47,000/-
(d)	4th Floor, Flat No. FRF-01, UDS-399.76, SBA-1602.50 Sq.ft	1,46,20,500/-	14,63,000/-	1,47,000/-

Date of Pre-bid meeting & time and place	Date of Inspection & Time	Last Date of Submission of Bids & EMD Submission	Date & Time of E Auction
30.10.2026, 3 pm to 4pm Place: O/o SPLOCA, 3rd Floor, Podium Block, Visveswaraiah Tower, Bengaluru-01	05.11.2026 11:00 am to 01:00 pm	11.11.2026 Before 5:00 pm	13.11.2026 11:00 am to 01:00 pm

For Registration & Online Auction, you can login to https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in (Helpdesk No.: 080-46010000, 080-68948777) The Interested bidders who require auction related information can contact Assistant Commissioner, Office of the Special Officer & Competent Authority, 3rd Floor, Podium Block, Visveswariah Towers, Dr. Ambedkar Veedi, Bengaluru - 560001, e-mail ID: splocaeauction@gmail.com or Contact Mob No.: 8861312111.

Place: Bengaluru
Date: 13.10.2026

Sd/-
Special Officer & Competent Authority
(IMA & other Scam), Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/3217/CCL/2026-27

HIGH POWERED ENQUIRY COMMITTEE
(Constituted by the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India vide order dated 18.08.2026 in W.P. (Crl.) No. 280 of 2026 and connected matters)

ShikshaSadan, 17 Rouse Avenue, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

The Hon'ble Supreme Court of India, vide its order dated **18 August 2026** passed in Writ Petition (Crl.) No. 280 of 2026 and connected matters, constituted a five-member **High Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC)** to enquire into all aspects of the incidents relating to violence at JantarMantar, Delhi, and at places outside Delhi, during the month of July 2026, including the broader issues arising therefrom.

The HPEC shall examine all issues enumerated in paragraphs 12 and 13 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court's Order dated 18 August 2026, with priority being given to the issues mentioned in **paragraphs 12(i), 12(vi), 12(vii) and 13(iii)** thereof, as well as the issue mentioned in **paragraph 5(i)** of the order dated 10 September 2026 passed by the Hon'ble Court.

These issues include, inter alia, matters pertaining to the **use of pellet guns, targeted violence and harassment of female protestors, and excessive violence and destruction of property occasioned on either side**.

Copies of the orders dated **18 August 2026** and **10 September 2026**, containing the composition of the HPEC and the issues referred to the Committee, including the priority issues, are available on the HPEC portal at:http://hpec.nic.in/supreme-court-orders

The Hon'ble Supreme Court has granted liberty to the parties to the writ petitions to approach the HPEC and submit such relevant material, documentary evidence and suggestions as they may deem fit, in such manner as may be decided by the HPEC through its Chairperson.

The Hon'ble Court has also permitted **complaints, representations and other relevant material to be submitted anonymously**, so as to protect the identity of complainants and witnesses. Further, in its Order dated 10 September 2026, the Hon'ble Court has issued directions to the HPEC to extend due protection to vulnerable witnesses and to keep their identities confidential and undisclosed. The Hon'ble Court has also directed that **utmost confidentiality shall be maintained in respect of statements made and evidence submitted by such vulnerable witnesses before the HPEC**.

In compliance with the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court, and with a view to safeguarding the interests of vulnerable witnesses and facilitating the submission of material by affected persons and other concerned stakeholders, the HPEC has developed an online portal, which may be accessed at:http://hpec.nic.in.

For the convenience of concerned persons, witnesses and other stakeholders, the HPEC has also prescribed formats for submission of information and material.

Accordingly, **affected persons, witnesses and other concerned stakeholders may submit their complaints, representations, statements, documents and other relevant evidence** by accessing the HPEC portal and selecting the appropriate format, wherever applicable.

Apart from the above, any person wishing to provide information relating to the issues referred to the HPEC under the Orders dated 18 August 2026 and 10 September 2026 may also submit such information through the aforesaid portal.Thosewho wish to submit the complaints, representations and other relevant material physically, can do so at the Office of the HPEC at ShikshaSadan, 17, Rouse Avenue Institutional Area, New Delhi 110002 between 1400 hrs. and 1600 Hrs. on all working days. Submissions can also be sent by post at the above address or by email at hpec2026.enquiry@nic.in

All such responses/submissions may be made without any delay.

Member Secretary
High Powered Enquiry Committee
New Delhi

CBC 19101/11/0016/2627

NISM — National Institute of Securities Markets
A Capacity Building Initiative of SEBI

Procurement of Desktops and Monitors for NISM

NISM intends to procure 45 Desktops with Monitors & MS Office 2024 and 170 Monitors. Suppliers may download the Expression of Interest (EOI) from the Live Tenders section of the Website **(https://www.tenderwizard.com/NISM)** for further details.

The Last Date of Submission of EOI is October 28, 2026

For details, please refer website **https://www.nism.ac.in/tenders/**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. JHS/Comm/e-Auction/26/159 **Date: 12.10.2026**

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of The President of India, The Divisional Railway Manager, (Commercial) Jhansi invites e-auction as per categories given as under:

Category: Parcel	**Catalogue No.:** JHS-PARCEL-SLR

Asset Details

(1) Train number 22194 = 01 SLR-F1 **(2)** Train number 12176 = 01SLR-F1
(3) Train number 12320 = 01 SLR-R1 **(4)** Train number 12049 = 01 SLR-F1
(5) Train number 22198 = 01 SLR-F1 **(6)** Train number 22195 = 01SLR-F1
(7) Train number 11086 = 01 SLR-F1

Auction Start Date & Time : 28.10.2026 at 11:00 hrs.

Auction End Date & Time : 28.10.2026 at 12:30 hrs.

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing module on IREPS website (**www.ireps.gov.in**). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **2326/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

K RIDE
RAIL INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT COMPANY (KARNATAKA) LIMITED
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of Karnataka & Ministry of Railways)

Regd. Office: K-RIDE, Samparka Soudha, 1st Floor, Opp. Orion Mall, Dr. Rajkumar Road, Rajajinagar 1st Block, Bangalore - 560010 Email ID- dgm@kride.in

No. KRIDE/HR/01/Retired Personnel/2026 Date: 13.10.2026

Vacancy Notice No. 01/2026

K-RIDE, a JV of Govt. of Karnataka & Ministry of Railways, executing the BANGALORE SUBURBAN RAIL PROJECT & RAILWAY DOUBLING PROJECTS, & other Railway doubling projects invites applications for the following post on Contractual basis.

Vacancy Notice No.	Post	No. of Posts
01/2026	General Manager (Civil)	02

Last date for submitting application is 12/11/2026.
For detailed eligibility conditions and other details please visit:
https://kride.in/careers-in-k-ride/.

DIPR/CP/YC/3213/2026-27 **Sd/- GENERAL MANAGER/HR**

KridePrm Kride Bsrp kride_bsrp KRIDE,BSRP

IDEMI
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
INSTITUTE FOR DESIGN OF ELECTRICAL MEASURING INSTRUMENTS, MUMBAI
वैद्युतिक मापन उपयंत्र अभिकल्प संस्थान, मुंबई

Government Certificate course on Export & Import Management

Course Duration 2 Days | Date- 24,25 Oct.2026 | Time- 10.30 AM to 5 PM

Venue: IDEMI- MSME DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE, WEST OF CHORD RD, INDUSTRIAL ESTATE, RAJAJINAGAR, BENGALURU, KARNATAKA-560010

Email ID: training@idemi.org Website : . Idemi.org Ph.:[022] 2405 0301/2/3/4

Content-Full foreign trade policy of Govt. Of India.2.what are the licenses required for doing import export activities.3.what are the import export incentives given by the Govt. of India.4. International commercial terms n payment terms. 5. Import export customs procedures.6. Import export cost sheet. 7. Freight forwarding activities.8.how to find out foreign buyer's n how to deal with them.

Fees-3500+18 % GST (fees are not refundable)

For people form IT & Management field, Entrepreneur Students & all general citizens.

After successful completion certificate will be issued

Call for details between 10am to 6pm

Contact - 9403566219, 8007765693 , 8291413843

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
NOTIFICATION
Bengaluru, the 19th September, 2026

S. O. 5172(E).-In the exercise of the powers conferred by clause (6) of section 20F and clause 7A of section 2 of the Railway Act, 1989 (24 of 1989) the Ministry of Railway (South Western Railway, Construction Organization, Bengaluru Cantonment) hereby authorizes the officers mentioned in column (4) of the table below as 'Competent Authority' and the officers mentioned in column (5) of the table below as 'Arbitrator' to perform the functions as such authority under the said act with effect from date of publication of this notification in the official gazette in respect of Special Railway Projects mentioned in column (2) relating to district mentioned in column (3) of the table below for public purpose of execution, maintenance, management and operation of such Special Railway Project.

SN	Name of the Project	District	Competent Authority	Arbitrator
1.	Proposed construction of the New Broad Gauge Double line between Hubballi - Ankola (163.00 Km) with Electrification in Dharwad and Uttara Kannada Districts of Karnataka, involving Government, Private and Forest Land.	Dharwad & Uttara Kannada	SLAO, Ankola/ Kumta	Regional Commissioner, Belagavi

[F.No.W.271/CN/BNC/2026-27 Land SRP/1727]

For details log on : https://egazette.gov.in

ASHUTOSH MATHUR, Chief Engineer-IV/Construction, Bengaluru Cantonment

PUB/526/AAD360/PRB/SWR/2026-27

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28001/33/2627

ODISHA BIGYAN ACADEMY
ADVERTISEMENT

Nominations in the prescribed proforma are invited by the Odisha Bigyan Academy, Science & Technology Department, Government of Odisha, Bhubaneswar for the following Awards:

Odisha Young Scientists Award for the year 2025 Engineering & Technology branch (Within the State category) **& Life Science Branch** (Outside the State Category) based on scientific contributions up to 31st December, 2024.

And

Odisha Young Scientists Award for the year 2026 Engineering & Technology Branch (Within the State Category) based on scientific contributions up to 31st December, 2025.

(Upper age of Young Scientists must not exceed 35 years on 31st December, 2024 for the award year 2025 and 31st December, 2025 for the award year 2026)

For detail guidelines and nomination proforma, please log on to Odisha Bigyan Academy website: **www.odishabigyanacademy.in.**

The nomination proforma can be downloaded from the above website (Duly filled-in proforma) as per guidelines to be sent to the Secretary, Odisha Bigyan Academy in the following address along with all particulars & documents. Nominees for Odisha Young Scientists Award are required to mention Thomson Reuter Impact Factor against the list of publications and should mention number of total Citations, ***h*** index & ***i 10*** index at the top of a publications list.

The last date for receipt of nominations is 18.11.2026 (upto 5.00 pm).

Secretary
Odisha Bigyan Academy
B/2, Saheed Nagar
Bhubaneswar-751 007
Odisha (INDIA)

OIPR-28001/28002/1/26-27/0002

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
Phulwarisharif, Patna- 801507

No.: FTS-15070(XVIII)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 10.10.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/ U.T. /Autonomous Bodies / Universities / Public Sector Undertaking /R&D Organization / Statutory / Local Self Government Bodies as applicable for filling up the following **Group 'B' Posts on Deputation Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Librarian Grade-I (Documentalist)	Level-7 (₹ 44900- 142400)	1
02.	Manager /Supervisor/ Gas Officer	Level-7 (₹ 44900- 142400)	1
03.	Laundry Manager	Level-6 (₹35400- 112400)	1

The number of posts is tentative and is liable to change based on the Institute's requirement. The period of deputation will be for a period of three (3) years and extendable for a maximum period of five years as per DoPT guidelines. Maximum age limit for applying for the aforesaid posts on deputation is 56 years as on last date of posting of application. The eligibility criteria will be regulated as per the relevant Recruitment Rules/DoPT instruction as applicable. The officers who fulfil the above qualifications/eligibility criteria may submit their application in the prescribed proforma at Annexure-I through proper channel to the **Recruitment Cell, All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Phulwarisharif, Patna-801507** through Speed Post/Registered post only. Application received through any other medium will not be accepted.

The last date for receipt of the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to 45 days from the publication of the advertisement in the Employment News. The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, पटना
All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna
Phulwarisharif, Patna- 801507

No.: FTS-15070(XVII)/Deputation/2026 Dated: 10.10.2026

VACANCY NOTICE ON DEPUTATION

Applications are invited in prescribed pro-forma from eligible Officers of Central/State Government/ U.T/Autonomous Bodies/Universities/Public Sector Undertaking/ Ministries /R&D Organization/Police Departments of Central/State/U.T/Armed Forces including Para Military Forces as applicable for filling up the following **Group 'A' Posts on Deputation Basis** at All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Patna. The essential qualification, experience etc. required for applying for these posts are as under:-

Sl. No.	Name of Post	Pay Matrix & Level	No. of post(s)
01.	Superintending Engineer	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹2,15,900)	1
02.	Chief Librarian	Level-13 (₹ 1,23,100 - ₹2,15,900)	1
03.	Senior Analyst (System Analyst)	Level-12 (₹ 78,800 - ₹2,09,200)	1
04.	Hospital Architect	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
05.	Senior Procurement-cum-Stores Officer	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
06.	Chief Medical Social Service Officer	Level-11 (₹67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
07.	CSSD Officer	Level-11 (₹ 67,700 – ₹2,08,700)	1
08.	Senior Dietician (Assistant Food Manager)	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	2
09.	Chief Medical Record Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	1
10.	Supervising Medical Social Service Officer	Level-10 (₹ 56,100 - ₹1,77,500)	1

The last date for receipt of the completed application in the prescribed proforma along with required documents through proper channel is up to **45 days from the publication of the advertisement in the Employment News.** The format of application and details regarding age, qualifications, experience and other information to the posts are available on the official website of AIIMS Patna i.e. www.aiimspatna.edu.in. All further addendum, corrigendum and notifications, if any, will be available on the Institute's website www.aiimspatna.edu.in.

Sd/-
Executive Director
AIIMS, Patna

Government of India, Ministry of Railways
Railway Recruitment Boards (RRBs)

CENTRALISED EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION (CEN) No. 07/2026

Recruitment for various posts of Non-Technical Popular Categories (Under Graduate)

Indicative Notice

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for various posts of Non-Technical Popular Categories (Under Graduate). Applications complete in all respects must be submitted **THROUGH ONLINE MODE ONLY (https://www.rrbapply.gov.in).**

Opening date of Application : 15.10.2026 (Tentative)
Closing date for submission of Application : 13.11.2026 (23:59 Hrs.) (Tentative)

Name of the post	Pay Level as per 7th CPC	Medical standard	Age (as on 01-01-2027)	Tentative Vacancies (All RRBs)
Various posts of Non-Technical Popular Categories (Under Graduate)	Level-2 & Level-3	As per the detailed CEN	As per the detailed CEN	1,688

1. Candidates are advised to verify their primary details using Aadhaar, during filling of online application, in order to avoid inconvenience and delays due to detailed scrutiny at every stage of recruitment process for Non-Aadhaar Verified applications.

2. In order to achieve successful verification using Aadhaar, Name and Date of Birth in Aadhaar shall be updated to match 100% with the Full Name and Date of Birth available in 10th class pass certificate. Similarly, Aadhaar needs to be updated with latest photo and latest biometrics (Fingerprint & Iris) before filling the online application.

3. This Notice is purely indicative in nature, issued solely for the purpose of keeping prospective candidates informed about the forthcoming CEN and to be in readiness with necessary certificates or documents required for applying. It is also clarified that all terms, conditions, eligibility criteria, procedures, and other requirements governing the recruitment shall be strictly as per the detailed CEN No.07/2026 (along with any corrigendum, which may be issued from time to time) that will be published exclusively on common website of All RRBs i.e. **https://rrb.indianrailways.gov.in**. Candidates can navigate to webpages of individual RRBs from this common website.

No.RRB/ADI/Advt./CEN/07/2026
Date: 14.10.2026

Chairpersons
Railway Recruitment Boards

"BEWARE OF TOUTS, BROKERS AND JOB RACKETEERS"

32001/1030/2627

Office of the Chief Construction Engineer
Anandapur Barrage Project, Salapada, Kenduihar
ମୁଖ୍ୟ ନିର୍ମାଣ ଯନ୍ତ୍ରୀଙ୍କ କାର୍ଯ୍ୟାଳୟ, ଆନନ୍ଦପୁର ବ୍ୟାରେଜ ପ୍ରକଳ୍ପ, ଶାଳପଡା
ଜିଲ୍ଲା: କେନ୍ଦୁଝର, ପିନ୍: ୭୫୮୦୨୦
Mail Id: cceabp@gmail.com

E-procurement Notice No. CCEABP-08 of 2026-27

E-Procurement officer	Name of the work	Bid id No.	Tender cost in Lakh (Appx.)	Bid security in Lakhs (online)	Cost of Bid Document (Online)	Class of Contractor	Period of Completion	Availability of tender online for bidding From	Availability of tender online for bidding To	Date of opening of technical Bid (Cover- 1)
Chief Construction Engineer A.B Project, Salapada	Construction of Inspection Bungalow (G+1) at Barrage Colony, Salapada under Anandapur Barrage Project in the district of Kendujhar.	ABP-ABD-01/08 of 2026-27	331.00	3.31	10,000/-	'A' Class	12 (Twelve) Calendar month	15.10.26 11.30AM	04.11.26 5.00 PM	05.11.26 11.30 AM

Further details can be seen from the Govt. website **www.tendersorissa.gov.in/www.dowrodisha.gov.in**. Addendum/ corrigendum/ cancellation if any required will be published in Govt. website only.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
Anandapur Barrage Project, Salapada.

OIPR-32001/32180/1/26-27/0009

Government of Uttarakhand, Department of Higher Education
No. :– 439094 / XXIV-C-1/2026-E-42533/01(08)2020 08 October, 2026

NOTICE FOR INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR THE APPOINTMENT OF VICE- CHANCELLOR OF SOBAN SINGH JEENA UNIVERSITY, ALMORA

The Uttarakhand Government has announced the appointment for the post of Vice Chancellor at Soban Singh Jeena University Almora. Under the provisions mentioned in Section 10(1) of the Soban Singh Jeena University Act, 2019 and as per conditions stipulated in UGC Notification dated 18.07.2018; applications are invited for the appointment on the one post of Vice Chancellor with a pay scale of Rs. 2,10,000 and a special allowance of Rs. 11,250.00, with total emoluments of Rs. 2,21,250.00.

2- The Vice Chancellor will be appointed from individuals possessing the highest level of efficiency, integrity, morality, and commitment to the institution. Eligible candidates must have at least 10 years of experience as a professor in a university or 10 years of educational leadership experience in a recognized research or educational administrative organization. The applicant should be a distinguished academician with relevant experience.

3- The age of the person applying for the post of Vice-Chancellor shall not be more than 65 years.

4- "Applicants/post-holders fulfilling the eligibility criteria must submit their applications online on the Samarth Portal URL (https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/) within 15 days from the date of issuance of this advertisement, by 6:00 PM. The application must be filled out completely in the prescribed format, accompanied by the attached declaration form, along with photocopies of all relevant eligibility documents based on the said conditions—including proof of date of birth, appointment order to the post of Professor, date of joining, and certificates related to the pay scale for the post of Professor.

Additionally, one hard copy along with all supporting documents must be sent via Speed Post or Registered Post to the **Office of the Secretary, Department of Higher Education, Government of Uttarakhand, Election Office, 1st Floor, Vishwakarma Bhawan, 04 Subhash Road, Dehradun.**

Prescribed Format

Name & Address	Date of Birth	Age as on date of Publication of advertisement	Education/ Qualification	Position held Presently	Date of Joining on Post of Professor and Equivalent	Teaching/Past Position held (From -To) Experience			Administrative Experience			Awards/ Patents/ Recognition	Publication/ Research Work	Remarks
						Post	Duration From	Duration To	Post	Duration From	Duration To			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15

(Dr. B.V.R.C. Purushottam)
Secretary

आई सी एम आर – राष्ट्रीय स्वास्थ्य अनुसंधान संस्थान,डिब्रूगढ़
स्वास्थ्य अनुसंधान विभाग, स्वास्थ्य और परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार
ICMR- National Institute of Health Research, Dibrugarh
Department of Health Research, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION

Advt. No. E14027/1/2023-24-Estt Date: 30.09.2026

Applications in the prescribed format are invited for the following posts on a **purely contractual basis.**

Sl. No.	Name of the Post	Consolidated Fee/ Remuneration	Total No. of Posts	Age
1.	**SENIOR CONSULTANT** (Scientific - Non Medical)	Between Rs.1,00,000 - Rs.1,50,000	**01**	Age must be between 40 to 70 years
2.	**CONSULTANT** (Finance)	Between Rs.80,000 - Rs.1,20,000	**01**	Age must be between 40 to 60 years
		TOTAL	**02**	

For the detailed advertisement and application form, please visit the official ICMR website at **https://icmr.gov.in** or refer to the following Google Drive link: https:// drive. google.com/file/d/12 DStQ6r0IKkxGz4AlovcMcOdz PirB5 v/view?usp=drive link or scan the below QR code

DIRECTOR

KARNATAKA ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
No. 16 C-1, Millers Tank Bed Area, Vasanthanagara, Bengaluru-560052. Phone: 080-22268677/78/79
Fax: 080-22268667 Email: kerc-ka@nic.in Website: https://kerc.karnataka.gov.in

No: KERC/RPTL/Tr.License/2026-27/2564 Date: 14.10.2026

NOTICE UNDER SUB-SECTION (5)(a) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003

1. An application under Sections 14, 15 and 86(1)(d) of the Electricity Act, 2003, read with Karnataka Electricity Regulatory Commission (Procedure, Terms and Conditions for grant of Transmission License and other related matters in respect of Intra-State Transmission Projects selected through Tariff-Based Competitive Bidding) Regulations, 2026, has been made by **M/s Ryapte Power Transmission Limited,** Plot No.181, Ground Floor, Block-K, Mangolpuri, Delhi-110083, for the grant of Transmission License for development of Intra-State Transmission system i.e., "Evacuation Scheme for 2000 MW Solar Park at Ryapte Village, Tumkur District" on Build-Own-Operate-Transfer (BOOT) basis, consisting of the following elements:

Sl.No.	Scope of Transmission Scheme	Scheduled COD
1.	Establishment of 5x500 MVA, 400/220 kV S/s at Ryapte in Tumkur District along with 2x125 MVAr 400 kV Bus Reactors.	30 months from the effective date
2.	400kV DC line (Quad moose conductor) from Prop. 400/220 kV Ryapte Sub-station to Prop. 400/220 kV Doddathaggalli S/s.	
3.	Establishing 3X500 MVA, 400/220kV GIS sub-station at Doddathaggalli (Near Hosakote) along with 2x125 MVAr, 400 kV Bus Reactors.	
4.	400 kV DC line (Quad moose conductor) from Kolar S/s to prop. 400/220 kV Doddathaggalli Sub-station.	
5.	220kV DC line with Single Zebra and partial 2 runs of 1200 Sq.mm UG cable (based on field conditions) from proposed 400/220 kV Doddathagalli sub-station to 220kV Ekarajapura sub-station with 2 Nos of AIS TB at Ekarajapura S/s with rearrangement/Shifting of existing Bus PT bay.	
6.	220kV DC line with partial AAAC Moose and partial 2 runs of 1200 Sq.mm UG cable (based on field conditions), from proposed 400/220 kV Doddathagalli sub-station to proposed 220kV Hosakote New sub-station.	
7.	220kV DC line with Single Zebra and partial 2 runs of 1200 Sq.mm UG cable (based on field conditions) from proposed 400/220kV Doddathagalli to Sarjapura AIS S/s with 2 Nos of outdoor GIS TB at Sarjapura S/s by extending existing AIS bus bar along with AIS isolator.	

Note: Detailed Transmission Scheme, with the required transmission elements to be implemented, are available in the application which can be accessed at the Commission's website **https://kerc.karnataka.gov.in.**

2. Karnataka Power Transmission Corporation Limited / State Transmission Utility, vide its letter dated 19.09.2026, has recommended for the grant of a transmission licence to the applicant to establish the proposed transmission system.

3. Based on the material available on the record, the Commission vide order dated 13.10.2026 in Misc. Petition No.12/2026, has proposed to issue a transmission licence to the applicant for the establishment of the transmission scheme as noted in para 1 above.

4. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an Intra-State Transmission licence to Ryapte Power Transmission Limited, can be accessed at the Commission's website **https://kerc.karnataka.gov.in.**

5. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of sub-section (5)(a) of Section 15 of the Electricity Act, 2003, the suggestions or objections, if any, to the Commission's proposal to grant a Transmission Licence to the applicant, as aforesaid, be sent to the **Secretary, Karnataka Electricity Regulatory Commission, No.16, C-1, Millers Tank Bed Area, Vasanthanagar, Bengaluru - 560 052, duly supported by an affidavit within FIFTEEN days from the date of this Notification.** The suggestions or objections received after the specified date shall not be considered.

6. The application shall be taken up for hearing by the **Commission at 11.00 AM on 03.11.2026 at Court Hall of the Commission at Bengaluru**. Any person who files suggestions or objections may attend the hearing.

Sd/- Secretary
For Karnataka Electricity Regulatory Commission

DIPR/CP/YC/3125/2026-27

CONTRAPUNTO

The Internet gave us access to everything; but it also gave everything access to us

– JAMES VEITCH

The Right Medicine

To make drugs affordable, price transparency must cover the entire supply chain

Supreme Court, hearing a PIL on the huge gap between what retailers pay for medicines and consumables, and what customers end up paying, wants to know from govt why prices of all medicines, devices, and consumables cannot be capped, given the disparity even for the most basic antibiotic. This comes on the heels of GOI capping the price of certain cancer drugs, a required measure. Additionally, after reports of profiteering by hospitals via exorbitant markups on medicines, Karnataka pricing regulator, this month, directed that hospitals must include both base price (what medicines cost them) and MRP, on all bills for medicines, medical devices and consumables across hospitals. Step back, to recall that in 2018, GOI told Parliament that in a single year, 3.8cr people fell below poverty line due to spending on medicines. And even today, pricing of medicines/devices/consumables is addressed in fits and starts, in a piecemeal manner. The national pricing regulator has capped prices of stents, knee implants, and some essential and cancer drugs. But there hasn't been a whole-of-trade approach.

SC exploring the price capping of all unpatented drugs is timely. As is Karnataka's move. But as industry bodies point out, such measures will have little impact if the price-to-hospital is already artificially inflated. A capping of the mark-up at the point of sale to patients, can hardly fully protect the patient. Hospitals purchase consumables with high MRP and low price-to-distributor. The only way out is to devise an all-India standardised template to track the trade/profit margin from the very beginning of the commercial process, when the drug or device enters the supply chain. Some experts have argued that the first point of sale is where GST is first applied – pharma company to distributor, or for imports, the landing import cost. This is the approach central drug pricing regulator NPPA must take. While Centre has reiterated that enforcement of rates is state responsibility, there are some concerns GOI must address – like medical manufacturers worrying about the skew of a higher GST for inputs, but lower rate for finished products. SC has its finger on the people's pulse. Transparency in the process of costs and trade margins, across the supply chain, can ensure fairness to patients and industry, and help monitor for profiteering, without disrupting supply.

French Fried

Supermarket refrigerator hack in France is a warning for all homes using connected systems. Dumb down

Hundreds of French supermarkets tossed out tonnes of food on Monday, after hackers turned their refrigerators into warmers overnight. They didn't even spare ice cream. How could they! Outrage aside, it was a simple, widespread hack – one of the perils of modern connected life. Around this time last year, PA systems at three Canadian airports and one US airport were hacked, to make pro-Hamas announcements. The Sept 2025 hack of automatic check-in and boarding systems at European airports was more serious. The Aug-Sept 2025 hack of carmaker JLR's systems was catastrophic – production remained suspended at factories in UK, Slovakia, Brazil and India for weeks. In just the last couple of months, we've seen hackers cripple a British gas generator for four days, and now this assault on supermarkets.

Hacks, of course, happen because we live in a connected world. But they're enabled by vulnerabilities in systems. Somewhere amid the thousands or millions of lines of code running equipment, a weakness, a backdoor, exists. Often, it's an oversight. Companies find them and fix them with patches. In the French supermarket hack, the vulnerability reportedly existed on the refrigerators' controllers. They were running outdated firmware, and the patches released by the manufacturer weren't installed. But even the best-maintained system can trip on a "foreign" vulnerability. A staffer wears a knock-off smartwatch to work, connects it to office Wi-Fi, and opens a door for hackers to get in.

We're filling our homes with such trojan horses now – cheap surveillance cameras, smart speakers, photo frames, doorbells, of unknown provenance and with any number of security vulnerabilities. Even reputed firms struggle with security – in 2015, Fiat Chrysler recalled 1.4mn vehicles after security experts showed they could take control of a Jeep Cherokee via its internet-enabled entertainment system. Last month, other experts showed they could hack a BYD Shark 6. And with AI agents, finding vulnerabilities will get easier. What can you do? If you have smart devices, keep them updated. If you don't, think twice before getting them. Supermarkets with thousands of refrigerators need smart controllers – the alternative is more staff – but you can probably manage your fridge efficiently the old analogue way: a to-do list.

I-T's Christmas

Tax man can sometimes be a gift-bearing Santa Claus

Jug Suraiya

For me, Christmas has come early this year. I was visited by an unseasonal, and unlikely, Santa Claus in the guise of the Income Tax department that presented me a gift by refunding part of the TDS, the tax deducted at source from my earnings.

The refund wasn't like winning the lottery, being about equivalent to a weekend in Goa, or the price of a not-too-smart smartphone. But its symbolic value far outweighs its intrinsic worth.

Gift-wrapped in an aura of festive gaiety, the refund morphed the traditional image of the tax man, a dreaded figure like a fiscal Dracula in search of plasma transfusions, into a jovial fellow in a red suit and white whiskers who went Ho, ho, ho! as he distributed largesse to all those who'd been good babalog.

In 1799, Britain became the first to tax incomes as a temporary measure to fund the country's war with Napoleonic France. The impost was made permanent in 1842, and was introduced in India in 1860 to pay for the military expenses incurred after the 1857 uprising.

second*opinion*

Like a guest who comes to dinner and takes up permanent residence, income tax became an immovable fixture of the country's economic landscape, reaching its peak in 1973-74 when govt took away ₹97.75 out of every ₹100 earned above ₹2,00,000 a year, thereby effectively turning all those in this bracket into unofficial govt servants, in that the more they earned, the more they served govt.

When it became apparent that such high rates of taxation were killing the golden goose and replacing it with the illegal ghoos of shady wheeling-dealings, compliance substituted coercion as the favoured approach to revenue generation.

The trick in doing this taxational transformation lay in making people feel good about shelling out money to govt. Like bitter medicine becomes less unpalatable when followed by a sweetener, govt bestows a refund every now and then on lucky taxpayers, making them feel they won the kitty in a kitty party.

Or that Christmas has come early, to a background soundtrack of a jolly Ho, ho, ho!

How To Defend The Rupee

RBI's in action mode shoring up the currency. But not all short-term moves are costless. Best option? Small, unglamorous reforms that can revive dollar inflows

Sugata.Ghosh@timesofindia.com

A central bank striving to prop up currency is like a police force trying to fix the mafiosi. Beyond a point, it's an experiment. No monetary authority can treat a structural malady, just as law enforcers can't cure a social ill. Nonetheless, all the king's men and horses in Mint Street are battling a slippery slope to back the rupee.

Amid foreign investors pulling out from the stock market, creeping inflation, and nasty geopolitical choke points, they are using blunt, unusual weaponry, to pre-empt a drift of the dollar-rupee rate towards the optically damaging number, 100.

In Mumbai's money market, the weekend began with RBI taking aggressive steps to clamp down on dollar demand. This is not just demand from punters betting against the rupee. But even from importers, who book dollars in advance to guard against a falling rupee.

About 48 hours later, these measures were extended to 'offshore' forward dollar purchase deals, cut by banks in GIFT City, which under foreign exchange laws is considered an overseas territory.

This spate of actions had a singular aim: to prune dollar demand and arrest a further slide in the rupee, albeit at a price. All this happened a week after RBI hiked the interest rate – a policy decision that's often linked to supporting currency, besides taming inflation – and six months after a drastic cap on banks' net open position, which captures how much a bank is gambling or is exposed to exchange rate fluctuations.

The last few days' announcements, coming in the early hours of Saturday and late Monday evening – probably, to prevent local traders from quickly taking positions – drove bankers into a huddle. As they tried to figure out how to implement the regulations, which kicked in once the markets opened on Monday. The odd timings, the nature of new rules, and the confusion that followed, betrayed an uncommon sense of urgency. What was the trigger?

New Delhi may well be running out of patience. The huge mobilisation of foreign currency deposits from the diaspora didn't solve the problem. Scrapping tax on profits of foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) from govt bond trades didn't help. So, what now? At some point, New Delhi may have asked for quick results.

However, none of RBI's recent measures are long-term solutions. A regulator, like its peers at different points, can come down heavily on speculators. But, raising the cost of hedging foreign exchange risk for bona fide importers, is a skewed regulation to rein in currency.

Under the new rule, banks must park 20% of the amount – for instance, $2mn, when an importer buys $10mn, which would be delivered later, when it pays an overseas seller. This makes forward covers more expensive. Why? Since funds parked with RBI fetch nothing, banks would recover the cost from corporate clients that import.

RBI can take more steps if rupee continues to play truant. For example, central bank can direct exporters to sell their dollars early

Such measures often lose efficacy as markets have a habit of testing regulators. In 2015, after China tried a similar 20% risk reserve, the fall in yuan wasn't reversed, though it became slower. Even the rupee surge, post RBI's curbs in March 2026, fizzled out in weeks.

Will RBI take more steps if the rupee continues to play truant? Well, there's a lot in a regulator's arsenal – forcing exporters to sell their dollars early, restricting outflows by companies setting up subsidiaries and family offices abroad, and by wealthy Indians buying stocks in Nasdaq, and homes in Dubai. But, such measures could put off not only the business elite, but even foreign investors, who could construe them as regressive capital controls.

A more serious, less discussed issue that's come to the fore is whether India would tread the path, something it has rarely done, of raising interest rates to defend the rupee – in the way emerging economies like Indonesia have.

At a time Indian business houses are making large overseas direct investments, global risk capital is moving into AI ventures, overseas private equity houses and venture capitalists are booking profits to transfer funds, and MNCs like large Korean companies are listing here to take the money out, should India consider giving rate shocks to cushion the rupee?

There's no easy answer here, as hikes in RBI's benchmark rate would immediately push up rates on home, auto, and other consumer loans.

Suddenly, we are confronting some home truths, which the volatile rupee and an active RBI have brought to the fore. Low-hanging fruits are gone. The age-old macro arithmetic of filling the trade deficit with surplus capital inflows is under strain. For long, our balance of payments has been in deficit. And, there are fiscal challenges in slashing capital gains tax on stocks.

Only a long, tortuous road with small, unglamorous reforms that don't make headlines, but require the cooperation of state govts, lies ahead. Perhaps, this is the only road that can lead to 'ease of doing business', a slow revival of foreign direct inflows, and persuading domestic business houses to take long bets on India, rather than shifting capital overseas. It's an arduous path, when Centre-state relations are tense. Yet, it's the only road left. Else, RBI would only tackle the symptoms, not the ailment.

But, for how long?

To Make India's Demography A Dividend...

Govts, industry, educators must deliver ASAP on six changes, from getting more women at work to apprenticeship programmes to bigger incentives for small firms

Paul Alapat

Nations, like individuals, occasionally encounter transformational opportunities that demand decisive action. Demographic dividend – a period when a country's working-age population expands while the *proportion* of young and elderly dependents shrinks to historic lows – is one such. Properly leveraged, it can dramatically boost a nation's economic trajectory, raising productivity, increasing savings and investment capacity, strengthening tax revenues, and easing pension burdens. However, this window opens only rarely in a nation's history, making its utilisation critical.

India's demographic dividend began in 2005, and is projected to last till 2055, with the peak expected around 2036. We're near the midpoint of this favourable period, and roughly a decade remains before the dependency ratio starts climbing again. This raises two urgent questions: does favourable demographics automatically translate into economic gains; if not, is India capitalising on this opportunity?

Not a sufficient condition | A growing working-age population creates only the potential for accelerated growth – it does not guarantee it. In Africa, countries like Nigeria, Chad, Niger, Democratic Republic of Congo, Central African Republic, Mali, and Angola, experienced favourable demographic shifts, but failed to convert them into economic prosperity.

Nigeria is a cautionary tale. While East Asian nations and China successfully harnessed their demographic dividends starting in the 1980s, Nigeria couldn't because 1) its fertility rate declined too slowly, 2) the economy remained overly dependent on oil without diversifying into job-creating sectors, 3) the education system produced graduates lacking employable skills, and 4) governance failures, combined with infra deficits and regional security problems, created additional obstacles.

Closer home, Sri Lanka's demographic advantage peaked around 2010, but benefits were largely negated by civil war, Covid, and the severe economic crisis of 2022.

Where India stands | Among major South Asian economies, both India and Bangladesh currently have expanding working-age populations. However, there's a growing consensus that India has not fully capitalised on this demographic opportunity yet.

GDP growth since 2005 has been robust. Falling dependency ratios account for nearly 20% of per capita GDP growth since the 1980s, and the expanding workforce has supported growth in IT services and manufacturing. But job creation is the core problem.

India needs to generate employment to keep pace with its expanding working-age population (15-64 years). But, in sharp contrast to China and East Asia, where export-oriented manufacturing booms readily absorbed surging worker populations, India's manufacturing sector continues to underperform despite govt incentives and policies.

Image: AI

There are several reasons for this: difficulties in conducting business, inadequate infra (particularly unreliable power supply), and an education system – especially govt schools – that struggles to produce employable graduates. Additionally, India's female labour force participation ranks among the lowest globally, representing a significant underutilised resource. The large informal employment sector further limits productivity and economic value addition.

Things to do | With the demographic window narrowing, India must pursue simultaneous reforms across multiple fronts, treating this as an urgent national priority:

- As India transitions from youth-heavy to working-age-heavy demographics, dramatically **improving education quality** – particularly in govt schools – becomes essential. This must be paired with expanded vocational training and apprenticeship programmes, requiring close collaboration between govt, NGOs, and industry. India should rapidly adopt successful strategies from East Asian economies.
- Complexity of starting and operating businesses in India calls for **business environment reform**. Common complaints centre on excessive approval requirements and sluggish bureaucratic processes, compared with other nations. Multiple regulatory bodies and complicated tax, labour and other laws should be streamlined and aligned with global best practices.
- Labour-intensive **manufacturing**, particularly in the MSME sector, deserves stronger incentives, as do employment-heavy sectors like tourism and other **services**.
- Substantially increasing **women's labour force participation** requires expanded skills training programmes, and improved child support infra. These can enable greater workforce engagement.
- **Addressing infra bottlenecks** is critical, including reliable non-fossil-fuel power supply, adequate water availability, robust transportation networks, and improved access to global supply chains.
- **Regulatory simplification** is equally important. Labour, tax, and regulatory obstacles that currently constrain services sector expansion, must be systematically removed.

The measures needed to capture India's demographic dividend are largely well understood and documented. What remains lacking is genuine urgency – a recognition that transformational opportunities of this magnitude arise infrequently in a nation's history. India owes it to both current citizens and future generations to seize what remains of this window before it closes.

Perhaps, most importantly, policymakers and citizens alike must internalise that a demographic dividend is not an entitlement guaranteed by favourable population statistics alone; it must be actively earned through sustained, coordinated effort across education, business environment, infra, and social policy.

Nigeria and Sri Lanka are sobering reminders that demographic opportunity, without decisive action, simply passes by, leaving behind unrealised potential and a harder path forward once the window shuts.

The writer is an angel investor

Calvin & Hobbes

Sacred*space*

I am afraid that if you don't find peaceful domestic solutions to our inequality and social problems, then it's always tempting to find other people responsible for our problems.

Thomas Piketty

Navratri: Journey From Form To Formless

Anandmurti Gurumaa

The universe, and everything within it, exists in three fundamental states: gross, subtle, and causal. Just as the five elements manifest in these three forms, so does the supreme cosmic energy we revere as Goddess Durga. While some traditions envision the Divine strictly in a masculine form, our profound spiritual heritage has worshipped the supreme as feminine – Bhagavati.

In her causal, cosmic form, she is the golden womb from which the entire universe is born. The very name Durga signifies the one who resides within the fortress of this physical world. Because the human mind cannot easily comprehend this boundless energy, sages gave her a beautiful, visible form so we could connect with her through devotion.

Yet, the divine extends far beyond this physical representation. Consider the mechanism of your own vision: you can look in a mirror and see your physical eyes, which is the gross form. However, you cannot physically capture or see the actual power of sight – the subtle energy that communicates with your brain and allows you to perceive the world. Similarly, while we worship murtis of goddess, the subtle cosmic energy she represents remains invisible, functioning silently and continuously throughout the universe.

Most of us remain focused on the gross, visible form of goddess, approaching her merely out of fear or greed. True devotion is never born from a transactional desire for protection or material gain. The wise seeker does not pray out of fear, but instead seeks the ultimate, causal truth: *Satchidanand*. This divine presence is not a distant deity residing in heavens; she is the life force blooming in leaves, flowing in oceans, and acting as the very power of sight and speech within you. In yogic tradition, she is recognised as dormant kundalini at the base of the Sushumna Nadi, waiting to be awakened through sincere practice. She resides within the fortress of your own body and mind.

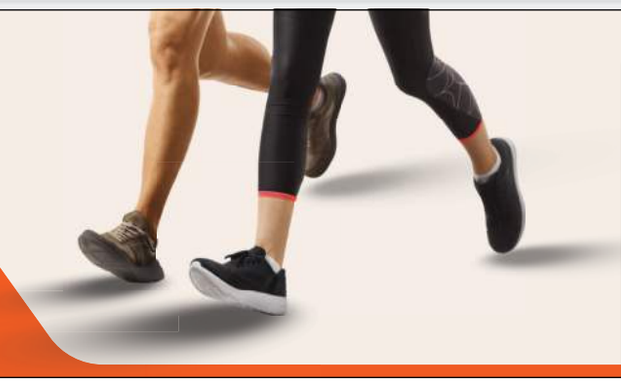
To awaken this inner power, Navratri provides a framework of profound physical and mental discipline. Ancient sages recognised the delicate relationship between human health and nature's rhythms, placing Navratri at junctions of seasonal change when the body's internal fire naturally weakens. This is the time for fasting. Today, fasting has often been distorted into an alternative feast of heavy, substitute grains. A genuine fast is a conscious withdrawal. When the body rests, it triggers autophagy, clearing out dead cells, balancing glucose, and healing from within. We draw inspiration from the Goddess herself, who, in her ultimate state of penance, gave up even leaves to sustain herself, earning the name Aparna.

Alongside purifying the body is anchoring of mind. During these nine days, rituals we perform are deeply symbolic. We do not light a pure ghee lamp merely to illuminate an idol; we light it to perform *tratak* – gazing steadily at the flame to centre our scattered awareness and improve our physical and inner vision.

Ultimately, these nine days are a journey from ordinary human to spiritual aspirant who has mastered the senses and the mind. When the mind is purified and the body is cleansed, you realise that Devi is not outside. The infinite, *Satchidanand*, is within.

10,000 steps. Are they enough?

Step count gets all the attention. But **consistency, intensity and overall movement** matter when it comes to heart health.



Ask Apollo AI
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Know the right step count for you with Ask Apollo

Hooked to magnesium? Here's why most don't need it as a supplement

It's a mineral crucial for bodily functions but self-dosing on supplements can have the opposite effect

Kamini.Mathai@timesofindia.com

As a student, Ryan Fernando had a go-to answer for every question in his clinical biochemistry paper: Magnesium. "It was the rabbit we could pull out of a hat because magnesium is vital to 300 chemical processes in the body, from energy production, muscle and nerve function to blood pressure regulation, heart and bone health. It's the answer to everything," says the nutritionist and founder of Qua Nutrition, Bengaluru.

It still is. Cannot sleep? Magnesium glycinate works like a dream, says an Instagram reel. Sore muscles? Rub on magnesium chloride, says another. Tired? Magnesium malate is the perfect pick-me-up.

In 1926, scientists established magnesium as a vital nutrient for life. A hundred years on, it appears to have grown larger than life. But despite what social media algorithms insist, how many mg of Mg does the human body actually needed as a supplement?

"Zero," says biochemist former professor at Kottayam's Mahatma Gandhi University School of Biosciences Prakash Kumar, who has researched the effects of the element on diets. "Magnesium is an intracellular ion. A deficiency cannot happen in a biological system unless one has certain disorders, diseases or medications that prevent absorption or result in excessive losses. Otherwise, a normal diet is enough. Every food, from legumes and seeds to vegetables, fruit and meat, has magnesium in it."

One argument, though, is that food may not contain as many minerals as it once did. A 2022 study published in the International Journal of Food Sciences and Nutrition — which compared the mineral content of fruits and vegetables available in the UK in 1940, 1991 and 2019 — found magnesium concentrations had declined by 10% over the 80 years.

Chennai-based orthopaedic surgeon Dr Sriram Krishnamoorthy says that does not automatically translate into a prescription for supplements. One must first establish whether there is a deficiency, and a routine blood test does not do that. "Only 1% of the magnesium is found in the blood. Everything else is stored in the body, in bones and soft tissues."

The problem with self-supplementation, says Fernando, is that what works for one person may not work for another. "You go to a party, and every Tom, Dick and Harry who has run a marathon is spouting nutritional advice. And while it's okay as long as they are talking about food, when people start handing out advice on supplements, you're setting yourself up for issues in the long run."

Clinicians look at symptoms before recommending magnesium, he adds. "Cramping muscles, 'I did not get enough sleep', 'my bones ache a little', 'my eye twitches', irritable bowel syndrome (IBS), and diarrhoea. Now, these are statements that make me check for magnesium deficiency."

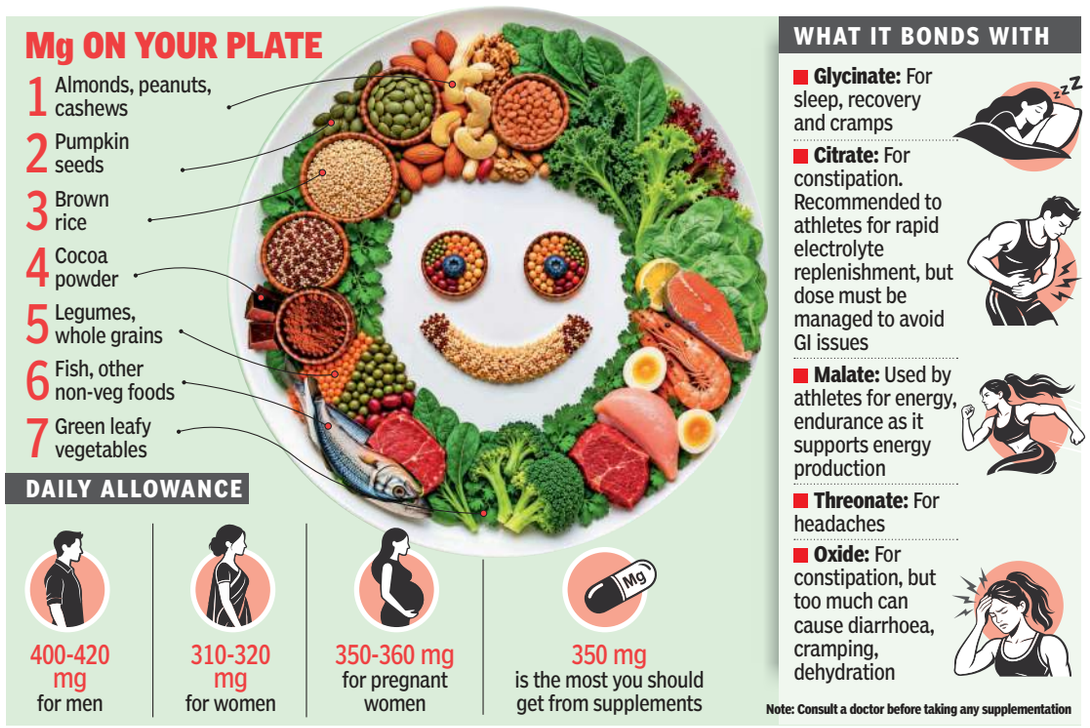
He says a runner came to his clinic with what appeared to be IBS symptoms, underwent a colonoscopy and endoscopy but the results were normal. "Among the products he was taking daily were a protein powder and a magnesium supplement. We stopped both. The gut improved. Then we brought the protein powder back, and he was fine. But the moment we brought back the magnesium supplement, his diarrhoea started. For another client with constipation, the same supplement worked brilliantly, which is why I say magnesium is not a one-size-fits-all."

Kumar says the "chemical combination" is what matters. For example, for improved sleep, magnesium glycinate is recommended. "Magnesium is not doing the magic here, the amino acid glycine is. It lowers body temperature, which is calming. When you take a magnesium glycinate supplement, it gets hydrolysed in the gastrointestinal tract as magnesium and glycine. Kidneys filter out surplus magnesium through urine."

But certain demographics may benefit from supplementation. The elderly may need it, says Dr Krishnamoorthy, as their digestive systems absorb less from food. Athletes too, says Vaibhav Daga, head of sports science and rehabilitation at Mumbai's Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital. "Recreational and professional athletes lose magnesium through sweat and urine. So, while a balanced diet is sufficient for the general population, research shows that 50% of athletes may have a magnesium deficiency." He says it shows up as reduced endurance, muscle soreness or lack of sleep.

Diarrhoea, nausea and abdominal cramping are among the recognised effects of too much supplementation. "Very high doses can have more serious consequences such as low blood pressure, muscle weakness and abnormal heart rhythms. People with impaired renal function must be careful because the kidneys play an important role in getting rid of excess magnesium," says Daga, adding that some medicines, including antibiotics and bisphosphonates used for osteoporosis, can interact negatively with magnesium.

What about the magnesium-based lotions being advertised lately, promising relaxation, better sleep and relief from aching muscles? The relief probably has more to do with the ritual than the lotion, says Kumar. "You're away from blue light, focusing on yourself, giving yourself a foot massage. That's probably why you feel relaxed." Daga also says evidence for absorption through the skin is limited. The bottom line: Do we need magnesium? Absolutely. From a bottle? Not always.



KNOW YOUR VITAL STATS

Quality of sleep depends on room temperature

'Lights out' tells your body it's time to sleep. But cooling down matters too. Your core body temperature falls as bedtime approaches, and an overheated bedroom can disturb your rest. **Here's how**

Temperature and sleep

Too hot? An overheated room can make it harder for the body to lose heat, leading to shorter sleep durations and more awakenings

Fluctuation matters: Evening cooling followed by morning warming could indicate more restful sleep

Keep it cool: A comfortable sleeping environment helps the body shed heat as its core temperature drops, usually reaching its lowest point towards dawn

1°C difference in daytime and nighttime body temperatures

What research says

Nature's cooling cycle: A 2015 US study of South American and African tribes found that sleep occurred during falling nighttime temperatures, and awakening coincided with the daily temperature minimum

Bedroom experiment: A 2007 study compared a constant 27°C room with one that cooled from 27°C to 24°C in the evening and warmed again towards morning. Under changing temperatures, participants showed higher melatonin levels and a greater sense of refreshment on waking

"Temperature is more important than light. Our tendency to live in homes where the temperature remains the same day and night is likely to contribute to the sleep issues people have in the modern world.

Jerome Siegel, NEUROSCIENTIST, CENTER FOR SLEEP RESEARCH, UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, LA

Can temperature reset your body clock?

Temperature cycles can synchronise circadian rhythms in some animals and lab-grown human cells. Whether bedroom temperature changes reset the clocks of people remains uncertain. Better sleep in a cooler room does not, by itself, establish a change in circadian timing

Source: BBC

TOI HealthTech

Could a 'brain-tickling' patch give you a better night's sleep?

Wearable that sends targeted ultrasound waves stimulates REM sleep regions, monitors brain activity

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For a problem as old as sleeplessness, solutions have been surprisingly limited: a sleeping pill, a melatonin tablet, magnesium gummies before bed. But can sleep be improved without popping a pill, just by stimulating the brain? A patch test by researchers from the University of Texas at Austin is trying to do just that.

The soft, wearable patch called NEUSLeeP uses ultrasound waves to target deep brain regions linked to REM (rapid eye movement) sleep. In a study published in Nature Communications, it helped a small cohort of healthy sleepers and those with sleep issues achieve REM sleep around 40 minutes earlier, and averaged a 16-minute longer stay in it. "This is the first time we have been able to do that non-invasively, while simultaneously monitoring brain activity," study lead Kai Wing 'Kevin' Tang said.

The patch opens up new possibilities for understanding sleep and treating sleep disorders at home. The researchers also observed changes in heart-rate variability (HRV) and brain activity linked to emotional processing after stimulation. They have filed a patent and are exploring how the technology can be used beyond the laboratory.

Stress REM-edy?

"REM sleep plays a key role in memory consolidation and emotional coping. If stimulation improves sleep, it could affect these functions," says Dr Biplab Das, director of neurology at Batra Hospital, Delhi. "But it is too early to link it directly to emotions or stress. More extensive, unbiased studies are needed to validate the findings."

Dr Kaustubh Mahajan, head of neuroscience at Mumbai's S L Raheja Hospital, adds that changes in HRV or responses to emotional stimuli should not yet be regarded as proof that the method can treat stress or regulate emotions in a clinical setting.

NEUSLeeP is not the first wearable to track the brain during sleep. ETH Zurich's headband SleepLoop uses auditory brain stimulation (delivering timed sounds aimed at enhancing deep sleep), while MIT Media Lab's Dormio is a glove that tracks signals such as muscle tone and heart rate, with special focus on the transition into dreams. In India, 'temple' patches have also been designed to regulate blood flow to the brain.

But can the technology eventually be tailored to an individual's sleep patterns and brain responses? "Theoretically, yes," says Dr Mahajan. "A neurologist could envision achieving this through a closed-loop device that can allow EEG and sleep data to be regularly updated, along with the device adjusting stimulation parameters and delivering messages based on someone's response."

Safety, cost concerns

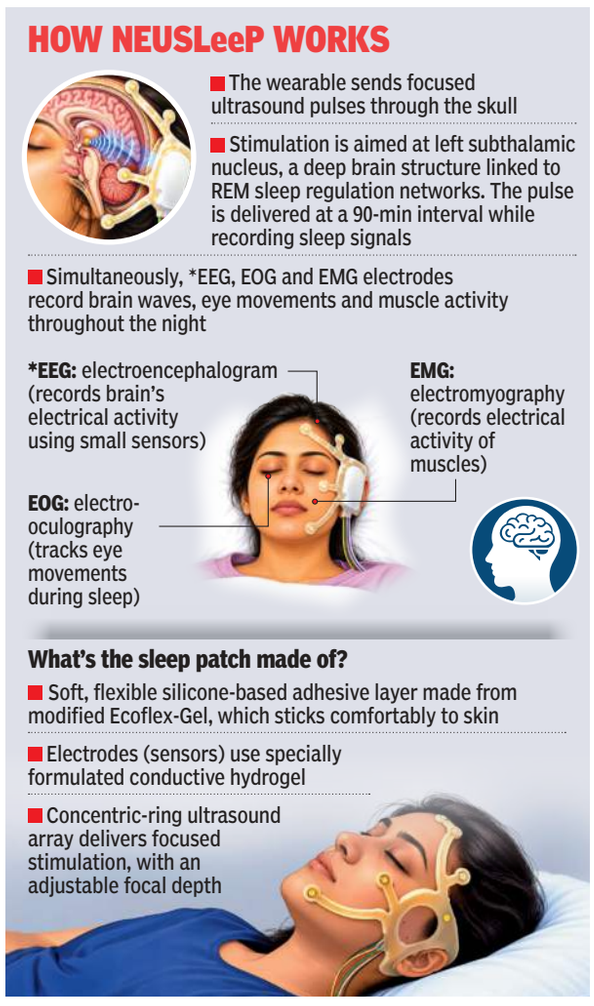
However, Dr Das emphasises that long-term safety will be particularly important because sleep is a complex biological function involving several brain networks. "Scientists have to find out if repeated use of external stimulation can affect memory, thinking, feelings and emotional processing. They will also need to discover if the brain builds a tolerance to stimulation or if it increases the effects over time," he says.

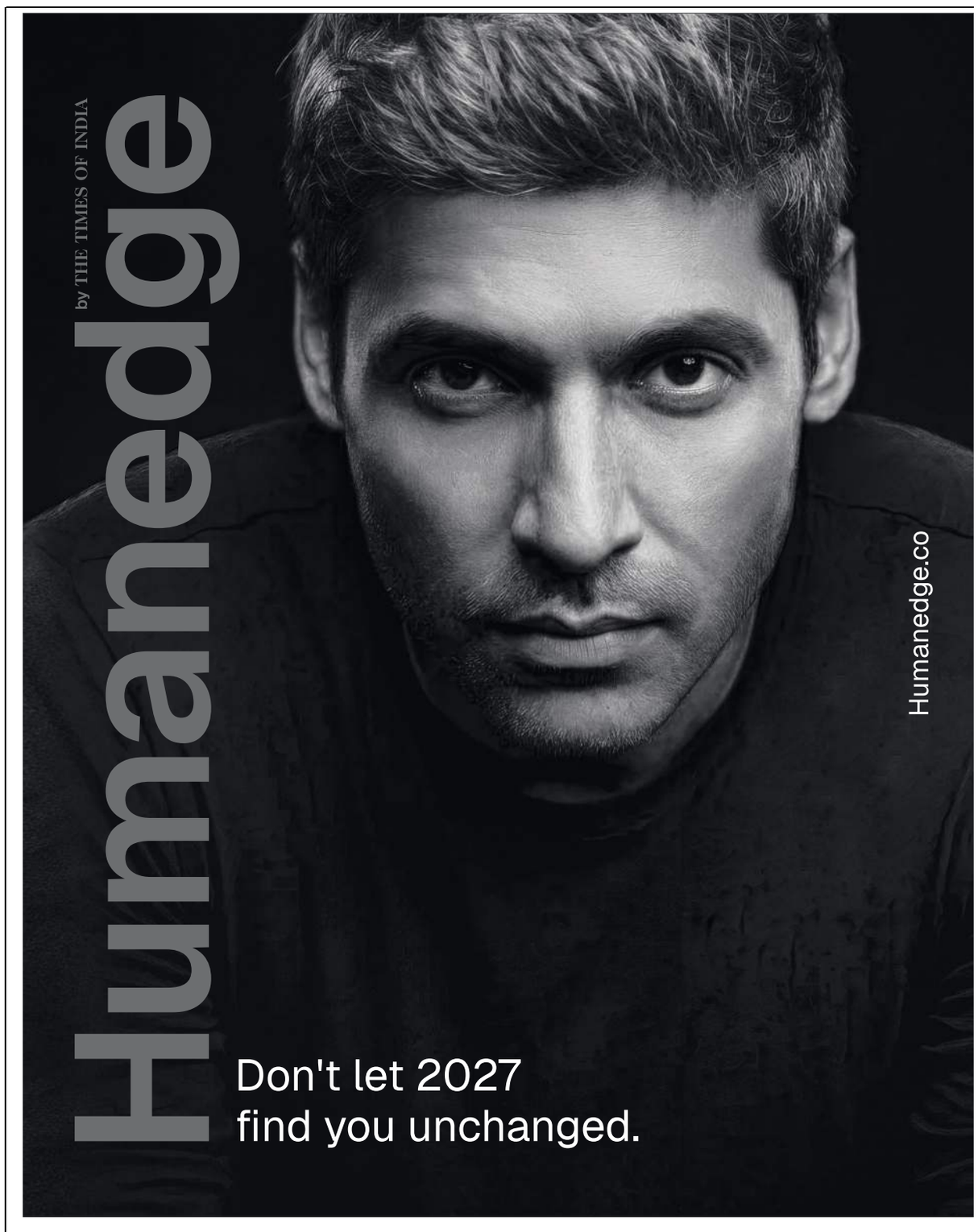
A technology like NEUSLeeP is some way from the market. And even if it does make the transition from laboratory research to clinical use, cost could become a barrier. "Various factors may affect the eventual cost, including different types of sensors used, stimulation technology, software, manufacturing and unit replacement. If these instruments do not get cheaper, accessibility will prove to be an issue for patients in need of treatment," says Dr Das.

Both doctors stress that the real transformation in sleep technology will not come from innovation alone, but from first ensuring safety and economic viability.

"Scientists have to find out if repeated use of external stimulation can affect memory, thinking, feelings and emotional processing. They will also need to discover if the brain builds a tolerance to stimulation or if it increases the effects over time

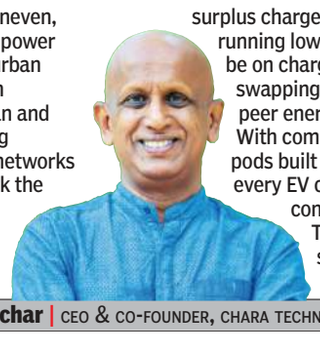
Dr Biplab Das, NEUROLOGIST





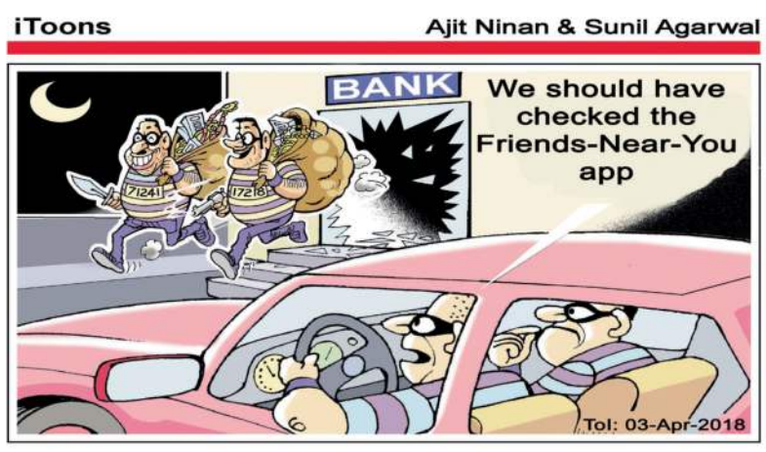
TECH I'D LIKE TO SEE

RETHINKING EV ENERGY NETWORKS FOR INDIA'S NEXT LEAP



India's electric charging ecosystem is still uneven, especially for two and three-wheelers that power most of our last mile connectivity. In dense urban pockets, peak hour demand puts pressure on available charging points, while in semi-urban and rural stretches, access can be limited for long distances. Rather than waiting for charging networks to expand uniformly, it may be time to rethink the role of the vehicle itself. Electric vehicles should not just consume energy, they can also become part of the solution. A delivery vehicle that completes its route with surplus charge could support another that is running low. Globally, the focus continues to be on charging stations and battery swapping. I believe the next step is peer-to-peer energy sharing between vehicles. With compact and secure wireless energy pods built into two and three-wheelers, every EV could function as part of a connected, mobile energy network. That shift would not just strengthen infrastructure, it would redefine it.

Bhaktha Keshavachar | CEO & CO-FOUNDER, CHARA TECHNOLOGIES



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How India talent powers THE OBESITY DRUG RACE

Novo Nordisk's centre has become crucial to R&D and supply chain management

Sujit.John@timesofindia.com

The 4,000-strong Novo Nordisk team in India is involved in R&D, IT, digital, global marketing strategy & execution, new launch strategy, global HR, pharmacoeconomics, finance, pricing, commercial analytics, supply chain management, manufacturing quality audit. John Dawber, MD of Novo Nordisk GBS, is in the centre

It's an epic battle today between Novo Nordisk and Eli Lilly in the high-profile and rapidly growing diabetes and obesity-drug market. Both companies have large global capability centres (GCCs) in India that are becoming increasingly vital in this battle, as competition extends beyond the medicines themselves to how quickly the companies can develop, analyse, launch and supply them.

We recently had an opportunity to talk with John Dawber, MD and VP of Novo Nordisk GBS (Global Business Services), in the company's facility in Bengaluru. Dawber joined Novo in his home country UK in 2008, had a stint at its Denmark headquarters, and then its offices in Japan and Thailand, and has now been leading the Bengaluru GCC for four years, during which he has seen its employee strength rise from 2,200 to almost 4,000. More importantly, as Dawber noted through our entire conversation, the centre has expanded both in the number of functions it handles and in the complexity of the work.

Some of the most crucial work has been in Wegovy, which together with Novo's Ozempic set off the modern-day frenzy around anti-obesity drugs. For Novo's two big US launches this year, the Wegovy pill and the submission for a high-dose Wegovy injectable, Dawber says virtually all the statistical analysis, regulatory writing, submission work, pricing, some marketing strategy and supply-chain planning was done from Bengaluru.

"The brains and the data were here and the work was done here," he says.

> I don't think there's a medicine launch anywhere in the world that doesn't have a thumbprint of Bengaluru on it. It's arguably not possible because of the breadth of work. If something's not got its thumbprint in the R&D space, it's for sure got its thumbprint in supply chain planning.

Big growth in R&D

The biggest growth in employee strength, Dawber says, has been in R&D. About 900 people. And it covers almost the whole value chain. While early drug discovery is still Denmark's forte, India is involved across clinical data management, biostatistics, clinical reporting, regulatory compliance & reporting, global medical affairs (the strategic unit that manages scientific communication, evidence generation, and stakeholder engagement on an international scale), global safety (side effects reporting). "About 80% of global safety is done here. If a patient in the US has a side effect, they go to their doctor, the doctor wants to report it to the company, it ends up here. And then somebody decides, is it drug related or is it not, is it a common side effect, do we need to inform the authorities!" he says.

Novo is increasingly democratising work, looking at where the best capability is available rather than assuming that the headquarters in Denmark must own the work. Some projects are led from the US, some from Denmark and many involve India.

> Our supply chain bosses, whenever they come here, they say, Gosh! The skills in India are a quantum leap above what we see in Europe. Maybe it's not a big surprise given that the pharmacy of the world is India. Compared to other locations around the world, the talent is just immense.

The same model applies to supply chains, an area in which Dawber believes the Bengaluru team has become particularly strong. Novo's factories cannot simply look at their own local demand and decide what to produce. The Bengaluru operation takes demand data from countries around the world, matches it against the regulatory approvals applicable to different markets and then works out which factories should produce which medicines.

It is a complicated global puzzle involving countries, factories, product availability, regulatory permissions and market-specific labelling. Centralising the work makes it easier to coordinate the whole network.

Dawber says Novo's supply chain leaders see the skills in India as way better than that in Europe. That could be partly because the country has long been a major pharmaceutical manufacturing hub for the world.

AI effect

AI is now adding another layer to Novo's transformation. Drug development can still take around a decade from discovery to launch. But individual stages are already becoming much faster.

A striking example is clinical reporting. Once the last patient has completed a clinical trial, enormous amounts of work are required to turn the resulting data into regulatory documents. AI has been introduced into the checking process, cutting the time required to produce a submission-ready document from about 18 months to six or less, Dawber says.

The more interesting application of AI, however, may be what it can discover from information that already exists. Dawber describes a typical large clinical trial with perhaps 10,000 patients and billions of data points. Historically, once a trial was completed, the company would use the data to answer the specific question the trial had been designed to investigate. AI opens the possibility of asking entirely different questions of the same dataset.

> For two of the big US launches this year, the Wegovy pill and the high-dose Wegovy injectable, virtually all the statistical analysis, regulatory writing submission, even the pricing and some of the marketing strategy and for sure the supply chain planning was done out of this Bengaluru office. The brains and the data were here, and the work was done here.

Researchers can push the information through AI systems and search for previously unnoticed patterns in how different groups of patients responded.

The opportunity becomes even larger when data from multiple clinical trials are combined. Dawber points to trials conducted 20 years ago whose information may sit in an old database, others in Excel spreadsheets and still others in PDF files. AI can potentially bring those disparate datasets together and search them collectively for patterns.

"That's the kind of stuff that we'd never have been able to do as humans before," he says. Bengaluru is involved in a lot of the AI work.

And while there's IT and digital talent, the centre bigger talent pools include those who understand medicine, understand how to design and develop clinical trials, statisticians, medical writers, those who can convert clinical data into something that can go into an international journal, those who know how regulatory authorities work and how questions from these authorities need to be answered. The teams include MDs, PhDs, MPharms.

CagriSema is Novo's answer to one of Eli Lilly's latest anti-obesity and diabetes products. It's in the regulatory review stage, not yet launched. It might be orchestrated elsewhere, Dawber says, "but a lot of the brain power, the statistical programmers, statistical analysts, the people that are dealing with the regulatory submissions, clinical trial management, they are all here."

Engineering a cheaper way to play videogames

Akhil.George@timesofindia.com

> Our attempt is to build a gaming device for India and emerging markets. Hardware is not the only thing we need to solve; software is essential too. The goal is to get more devices into more hands, bring more games into the ecosystem and push for regional pricing. Over time, we want our engineering work to help build something different from what we have seen in the West so far.
> **Kaustubh K Jadhav** | COFOUNDER, ARC

On a table in Arc's Bengaluru lab, a gaming device sits attached to cardboard, its electronics exposed. It is an engineering prototype, waiting to be tested before being fitted into a proper case. During a video interview, cofounder Kaustubh K Jadhav lifts it towards the camera. This is device number 007, one of roughly 40 prototypes through which a young team is trying to answer a difficult question: can more Indians afford to play games beyond their smartphones?

The answer, Arc believes, lies as much in software as in the machine itself. Its Rs 33,500 X1 handheld is being built around a relatively affordable, power-efficient processor, with engineers working to make games designed for other computers run on it.

Hardware was not the only thing that needed solving. The software systems were essential too," says Jadhav. "Our attempt was to make a device optimised for the gaming requirements of somebody coming out of India, and primarily emerging markets."

Jadhav's route into gaming hardware came through running and backing gaming businesses. He was previously cofounder and chief operating officer of GameEon Studios, a game development company, and a partner at SyndiCap Venture Partners. He and cofounder Jobin Joseph have spent roughly four years working professionally in gaming, drawing on conversations with PC and handheld gamers to shape Arc's approach.

The price barrier that Arc is trying to abolish is considerable. Sony's PlayStation 5 Digital Edition will set an Indian gamer back Rs 64,990, before the cost of games or a screen. A title such as the upcoming GTA VI costs another Rs 5,999. For a household weighing gaming against other expenses, the machine is only the first bill. A handheld gaming device, like the one Arc is making, can easily cost double what Arc is charging as well.

Architecting from scratch

Arc's engineering effort begins with the processor. The X1 uses Qualcomm's Snapdragon G2 Gen 2, designed for handheld gaming and based on ARM, a family of chip designs also found in smartphones. Many gaming computers use a different architecture, called x86. Architecture is essentially the set of instructions a processor understands.

Jadhav says cost and battery life pushed the team towards ARM. "We could not build an x86 project because of the price, power management and battery life," he says.

But choosing the chip is only the beginning. Games written for a Windows PC cannot simply be dropped onto an Android-based handheld and expected to work. The software and processor speak different languages. Bridging that gap is where much of Arc's effort goes.

The team has built its own operating system, OwlOS, using the Android Open Source Project. Jadhav says it also integrates Proton, software that helps Windows games work on Linux, another operating system. Such a compatibility layer acts like an interpreter. Running PC games on ARM requires handling differences in processor instructions too, making compatibility an engineering task rather than a switch that can simply be turned on.

"The last game we pushed out was GTA V. We were doing a sustained frame rate of around 30 to 35," says Jadhav. Frame rate measures how many images appear each second, influencing how smoothly a game moves.

Red Dead Redemption 2, a demanding game set in the American frontier, is another target. Each additional game title brings work on getting it running, improving performance and checking stability.

"It is not a sprint, it is primarily a marathon," says Jadhav. "We will spend time building something, testing it out, stabilising it."

Behind that effort is a 14-member team, including 11 engineers. Arc's average employee age is 25. Some come from communities that develop open-source software. Others have worked in aerospace engineering, bringing experience in miniaturisation — fitting working systems into confined spaces.

Jadhav says so far the device has passed through eight or nine iterations covering physical design, architecture and software. Around 50 testers have contributed feedback. Changes to major functions or the design trigger another round of testing.

"The complete product design is in-house," he says. Manufacturing draws on suppliers in India, Taiwan and elsewhere in Southeast Asia. "Certain parts can be manufactured in India. Certain parts cannot."

TN team wins Mitsubishi Electric's global competition

L - R: Vijay, Tharana, Seralathan & Tharanika

- The team of **Tharanika K, Seralathan R, Vijay B and Tharana A S** from Sona College of Technology in Salem, Tamil Nadu, won the grand prize at the MECA Global Finals 2026, a factory automation competition organised by Mitsubishi Electric in Tokyo last month. They won against competitors from engineering colleges in South Korea, Japan, Taiwan, Vietnam, Philippines and Thailand.
- Normally, programming a factory machine's controller (PLC) is slow and risky. Engineers write code by hand and can test it once the physical machine exists. This causes delays, needs scarce specialist programmers, and makes mistakes expensive to fix. Tharanika and team built a tool that lets an engineer describe a factory machine's behaviour in plain English, and AI turns that description into working programmable logic controller (PLC) code. AI converts the machine instructions into safety-checked industrial code, and tests it on a digital twin before deployment, enabling quick development, safer validation, fewer programming errors, and reduced time, cost and effort during on-site commissioning.
- Seralathan told us their win could have been because their idea is potentially scalable across all kinds of PLCs – unlike the more narrow use cases of competing teams – and their use of an infrequently used programming language for AI to work on top of.
- The India leg of the competition saw nearly 300 applications from engineering colleges. In this leg, the second and third prize winners were respectively MKSSS' Cummins College of Engineering for Women, Pune, and COEP Technological University, Pune.
- At the global level, the second and third prize winners were from Philippines and Thailand respectively.
- Atsushi Takase, MD of Mitsubishi Electric India, said the idea of the challenge was to empower the next generation of engineers by providing students with access to advanced automation technologies and opportunities to compete and excel on the global stage.

APPLYING AI TO REAL-WORLD PROBLEMS

➤ The team of **Abhiram Ramachandran, Madiha Ahmed and Polisetti Likhit Sai** from IIT Hyderabad won the recently concluded Accenture Innovation Challenge. They developed a gen AI-powered business intelligence solution that analyses business data to identify root causes of declining performance, helping organisations understand what went wrong, and how to address it. They received prizes worth Rs 3 lakh.

➤ The second runner-up was the team of **Tejas Goyal, Prakhar Agarwal and Shiwang Gupta** from IIT Delhi, which developed an AI-powered clinical decision-support system that helps emergency care teams prioritise patients based on the risks of waiting, while ensuring clinical judgment remains with healthcare professionals.

➤ The first runner-up was the team of **Astha Jaiswal, Aayushi Bhardwaj and Siddha Mishra** from IIT Roorkee, which developed an AI-powered manufacturing intelligence platform with a real-time digital twin, using live production data, sensor inputs, computer vision, and digital simulations. Specialist AI agents monitor operations, identify potential issues, and assess repair options, helping manufacturers anticipate defects and take corrective action.

The Accenture competition for STEM students in India is now in its eleventh edition, and drew over 5,000 registrations from 20 IITs and NITs this year.

AI Career Edge PODCAST
When Automotive Engineering Meets AI: The Making of the Future Mobility Engineer
Live on YouTube. Scan the QR or go to the URL to set a reminder
Caleb Munigety | HEAD, ENTERPRISE AI BOSCH INDIA
FRIDAY October 16, 11.30 AM
Event page link: https://bit.ly/AIcareeredge19

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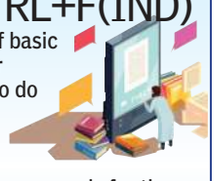


An instruction set is the collection of basic commands a computer's processor understands. These commands tell it to do things such as add numbers, compare values or move data. Think of it as the processor's vocabulary. Software must ultimately be expressed in these commands for the chip to run it. Different processor families, such as ARM and x86, use different instruction sets. That is why a program built for one may need translation or adaptation to run on the other. The instruction set helps determine software compatibility, but speed and energy efficiency also depend on how the processor is designed.

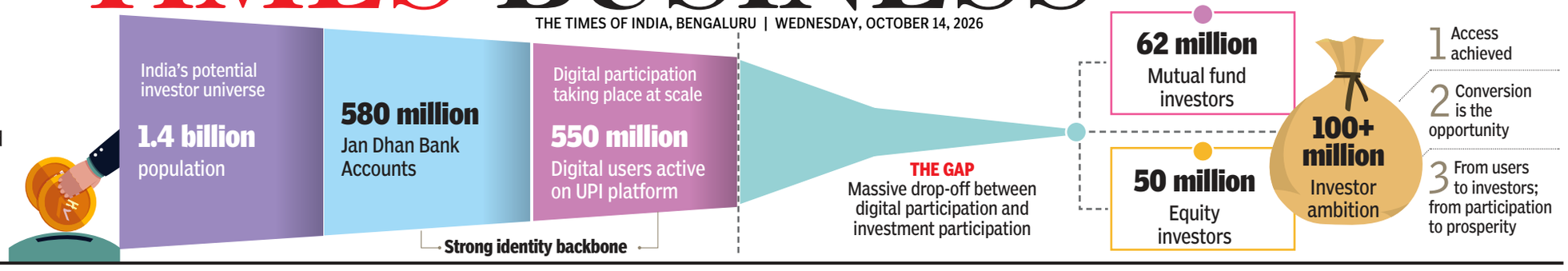
TIMES BUSINESS

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

The Striking Paradox In India's Investment Story

India's financial infrastructure has expanded dramatically, but investor participation remains concentrated within a relatively small segment of the population. The funnel highlights a striking paradox. India has created one of the world's largest digitally connected financial populations, yet only a fraction actively participates in long-term investing

Source: Sebi, NPCI, NSE, AMFI, UIDAI, CBDT, EY analysis



K'taka to drop repeat GST notices in closed cases

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Karnataka's commercial taxes department will take steps to withdraw fresh GST notices issued in cases that have already been audited and closed, if affected businesses bring them to its attention, Vipul Bansal, commissioner of commercial taxes in the Karnataka govt, said on Tuesday.

The assurance followed complaints from industry representatives about repeat proceedings and short deadlines to respond to tax notices during an interaction with senior tax officials. "Wherever such cases are brought to our notice, we will take consequent action of actually dropping those notices," Bansal said, adding that instructions had already been issued to field officers.

Separately, Sanjay Mangal, member (GST) of the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC), said the board was examining whether central GST audits should cover a single financial year or multiple years.

Industry representatives said audits spanning three or four years required extensive documentation, while businesses were given little time to respond. They also raised concerns over the invocation of Section 74 of the CGST Act, which deals with cases involving fraud, wilful misstatement or suppression of facts.

Biz need investments in chips, says Chandra

'Many Decisions Taken By Various Chairmen In The Group Proved Right In Long Term'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

> Sometimes if things go wrong, you course correct. Directionally you design it on the belief it is needed for India, it is needed for mankind, and for enterprises, you will get it right. It doesn't mean that everything will be a smooth ride
>
> Whether we will get it right and meet the numbers in two years or three years, is not the point. The point is chips are fundamentally going to be required... you can't be reckless and say I will put a two nanometre chip, it's just not going to work
>
> —**N CHANDRASEKARAN** | CHAIRMAN, TATA SONS

New Delhi: Tata Sons chairman N Chandrasekaran Tuesday said investments in semiconductors and electronics are important for India, businesses and the future, although they may not generate the numbers in two or three years.

At a time when the salt-to-software conglomerate's investments in some of these businesses have come under scrutiny, Chandra compared the foray into chips and electronics with the group's bet on steel and hydel power in the early 1900s.

"...many decisions have been taken by various chairmen in the group, which have all proved to be right in the long-term. Sometimes if things go wrong, you course correct. Directionally you design it on the belief it is needed for India, it is needed for mankind, and for enterprises, you will get it right. It doesn't mean that everything will be a smooth ride," he said at an event organised by Bloomberg.

He said that everyone recognises that chips are the future and the decisions were financially prudent.

"So, whether we will get it right and meet the numbers in two years or three years, is not the point. The point is chips are fundamentally going to be required... you can't be reckless and say I will put a two nanometre chip, it's just not going to work. So, we also need to see where the demand is... It's not that you are going to have a very clean spreadsheet in this uncertain world, but a lot of things are certain. Direction is certain, the need is certain, the ability to execute is certain and the only thing is how you ramp up, how fast you ramp up..."

The comments come amid an intense boardroom battle, pitting Chandra and other board members against Tata Trusts chief Noel Tata, who had questioned the losses incurred in businesses, such as aviation and semiconductors, sectors where govt attention is also focused.

The Tata Sons boss, who is now in contention for a third term starting Feb, said the group is designed for resilience. "Some resilience has been built into our businesses because it really surprises me how well we have done as a group with so many disruptions that we had. We had an air crash, we had a cyberattack (at JLR), we had supply disruptions. Still as a group, we will deliver double-digit growth and margins are holding up. We are paying more attention. I send the message across the group: We have to think what is resilience for each of our businesses."

At the same time, asked about the big concerns, he said that war was a major worry, while in the short-term technology, if it lands in the hands of bad actors, and the impact on labour restructuring were in focus.

Govt commits ₹7,131cr to 19 fund managers

Supriya.Roy@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: The govt has committed Rs 7,131 crore to the first group of 19 fund managers selected under its Rs 1 lakh crore Research, Development and Innovation (RDI) scheme. The group comprises 14 alternative investment funds and five research organisations that will channel capital to eligible technology companies.

Blume Ventures, Chiratae Ventures, Kalaari Capital, Speciale Invest, YourNest Capital, IvyCap Ventures, Ideaspring Capital and TVS Capital Funds are among the selected managers. The list also includes Sixth Sense Ventures, Celesta India AIF Managers, AdvantEdge Investment Managers, AMA Capital Advisors, Translation Endeavors and Campus.

RDI SCHEME

The five research organisations are AI & Robotics Technology Park (ARTPARK) at IISc Bengaluru; Centre for Cellular and Molecular Platforms (C-CAMP) in Bengaluru; IIT Madras Research Park; Pilani Innovation & Entrepreneurship Development Society at BITS Pilani; and Society for Innovation & Entrepreneurship at IIT Bombay.

The Empowered Group of Secretaries approved the first group at its Oct 8 meeting, according to a govt release dated Oct 12. The selected managers are expected to raise private capital equivalent to the RDI fund's contribution. Individual allocations were not disclosed in the published list.

The fund is managed by an independent business unit within the Anusandhan National Research Foundation, under the Department of Science and Technology. Applications for the first group opened in Jan 2026.

IBM India chief Patel calls for 'digital swaraj'

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Mumbai: IBM India and South Asia managing director Sandip Patel said his call for "digital swaraj" reflects businesses' and govts' growing need to exercise greater control over their data, technology assets and the systems that manage them.

"I have started calling this the era of digital swaraj. In a predominantly digital world and a global digital economy, organisations need a degree of digital sovereignty suited to their level of regulation and the criticality of their operations," Patel told TOI at its flagship event, IBM Think, held in Mumbai on Tuesday.

Companies increasingly want clarity on where their data resides and who controls encryption keys. IBM's Sovereign Core, announced in March, is designed to address these concerns. The software stack can be deployed in a client- or partner-owned data centre, providing cloud-like capabilities while keeping control-plane operations and key management within the customer's jurisdiction.

Built on Sovereign Core, IBM Bharat Core is an AI stack optimised for India, offering reusable Indic AI services, models and connectors across industries. IBM is also developing India-specific tools to accelerate Sovereign Core implementation,

> If the US becomes more restrictive on permanent residency, I think that could be good for India. It gives India an opportunity to strengthen its talent base
>
> **Sandip Patel** | IBM, MD—INDIA & SOUTH ASIA

while its Svaiam reference architecture is designed to help deploy sovereign AI capabilities within govt environments.

IBM is also applying AI internally to improve productivity. Patel said the company initially targeted $2 billion in savings over three years but achieved $4.5 billion in operational savings by the end of last year through automation, simplification, process redesign and AI.

IBM, MeitY Startup Hub to boost deep-tech ventures

IBM and MeitY Startup Hub (MSH), an initiative of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, plan to accelerate India's deep-tech startup ecosystem by providing startups access to IBM's enterprise technologies and innovation platforms to address business use cases.

Nilekani-backed Fundamentum AI fund raises ₹3,000 crore

Supriya.Roy@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Nandan Nilekani-backed Fundamentum's third fund has secured Rs 3,000 crore from investors and raised its fundraising ceiling to Rs 3,500 crore following strong demand, as the venture capital firm prepares to make larger bets on Indian artificial intelligence and deep-tech startups.

The fund, managed by Fundamentum Frontier Advisors (F2A), is led by Fundamentum co-founder **Ashish Kumar**. In an interview with TOI, Kumar said the firm had closed fundraising at Rs 3,000 crore and was negotiating with institutional investors to raise another Rs 500 crore. It expects to complete the final close within the next two months. About 70% of the capital has come from Indian investors, largely family offices, while overseas investors account for the remaining 30%. Nilekani is the fund's anchor investor and mentor.

F2A plans to invest Rs 100-200 crore each in 12-15 companies over the next two to three years. It is already in advanced discussions to close three investments this quarter, with the first announcement expected as early as this month or in Nov. The larger cheque sizes reflect a decision to take bigger stakes in companies rather than a rise in startup valuations, Kumar said. F2A had earlier indicated investments of Rs 50-150 crore. "We will take more of the round," he said, adding that the fund also wants to invest more in subsequent rounds as its portfolio companies grow.

Nifty rebounds 359 pts as mkts regain ground

▶ Continued from page 1

Nifty closed 1.6% or 359 points up at 22,722 points. "Two years ago, we had bought all the asset classes similarly and people thought that I was increasing the tax. I was not increasing the tax, I was bringing all of them at par, so that an investor is not speculating as to which one gives them greater leverage. So, these are the things on which there is a lot of debate. It's healthy to have this debate and I will be keen to hear them," Sitharaman said at a Bloomberg conference, while responding to an observation that investors, especially foreign funds, were keen on removal of capital gains tax and streamlining of taxation before they started investing in India.

Sitharaman acknowledged that investors, both within and outside, were commenting on LTCG and the question of treating all asset classes similarly has been a widely discussed topic. So far this year, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have sold Indian stocks worth a little over Rs 3 lakh crore, NSDL data showed. In 2025, the corresponding figure was a net outflow of nearly Rs 1.7 lakh crore and just Rs 427 crore in 2024. Since Sept 2024, sensex has lost about 13%. At the same event, Sitharaman also noted that rupee has depreciated "significantly" over the past year and a half, and RBI will continue its efforts to prevent excessive volatility.

IMF raises India growth forecast to 7%

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: The International Monetary Fund (IMF) has upgraded India's growth forecast for the current year to 7%, from 6.4%, making it the fastest-growing major economy.

The agency joins others — including the World Bank, ADB, S&P and Moody's — in upgrading its projections after official data estimated first-quarter growth at 7.8%. Most global agencies have forecast 6.9-7% growth in the current fiscal year. IMF's latest World Economic Outlook estimated inflation at 5% this year with per capita output projected to rise 4.7% in 2026 compared with 5.2% last year.

It said that the global economy, projected to grow 3.4% in 2026, has stayed resilient despite multiple shocks in recent years. "India remains among the fastest-growing major economies, with growth in 2026 projected at 7%. This reflects stronger-than-expected momentum, supported by resilient domestic demand and robust services activity," the multilateral agency said.

India along with Germany has seen the highest revision, with Saudi Arabia forecast to contract 3.3% this year, seeing a five-percentage-point cut in the projection.

"India stands out with upward revisions, reflecting sustained momentum and growing evidence of stronger growth potential supported by favorable demographic dynamics, a large and expanding domestic market, and continued structural reforms," IMF said. The report highlighted efforts to diversify trade flows and pointed to India's trade deals with the UK and the European Union that will lower tariffs and reduce barriers to services trade, and "facilitate adjustments to recent trade policy changes". US tariff actions have resulted in a flurry of trade deals across the globe, with India too moving ahead with FTAs that have been on the negotiating table for years.

> **Global economy, projected to grow 3.4% in 2026, has stayed resilient despite multiple shocks in recent years, says IMF**

MDR on UPI to be rolled out after Diwali

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Amid pushback from industry, National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has deferred the rollout of merchant discount rate (MDR) on select UPI transactions until after Diwali.

In a statement on Tuesday, NPCI said that a new date of implementation will be notified separately.

The merchant fee was earlier supposed to come into effect from Oct 15, amid the peak Navratri season when festive sales volumes surge.

Retailers heaved a sigh of relief as the move will spare them the need to reconfigure billing and accounting systems, besides briefing store staff at the point of peak footfalls. "Deferment avoids this and gives the trade time to prepare.....the festive quarter is the single most important trading window for apparel retail. UPI has become the default payment mode at the store counter, and any change in the cost of accepting it directly affects checkout practices, reconciliation and consumer experience," said Santosh Katariya, president, Clothing Manufacturers Association of India (CMAI).

Associations, however, urged govt to revisit the Rs 2,000 threshold given that a large share of apparel retail value (particularly for purchases made during weddings and festive) breaches that mark.

Tier-2 cities lead digital credit adoption: Report

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

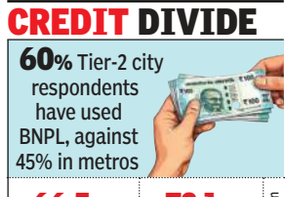
Bengaluru: India's smaller cities are emerging as bigger users of digital credit than metros, even as consumers remain more comfortable using payment apps to make payments than to borrow, a new study has found.

About 60% of respondents in Tier-2 cities have used Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) services, compared with 45% in metros and 52% in Tier-3 cities. Yet, 64% of urban respondents have never formally applied for digital credit through an app, pointing to a gap between the growing use of checkout financing and formal digital borrowing.

The findings are part of the third edition of How Urban India Pays, a study by Pahlé India Foundation in partnership with Amazon Pay. The study surveyed 5,149 consumers across 100 cities and 1,054 merchants across 20 states. Rajiv Kumar, chairman of Pahlé India Foundation, attributed higher adoption in smaller cities to unmet demand for formal credit. Traditional borrowing channels remain harder to access in these markets, particularly for consumers who lack the documentation required by banks, he said.

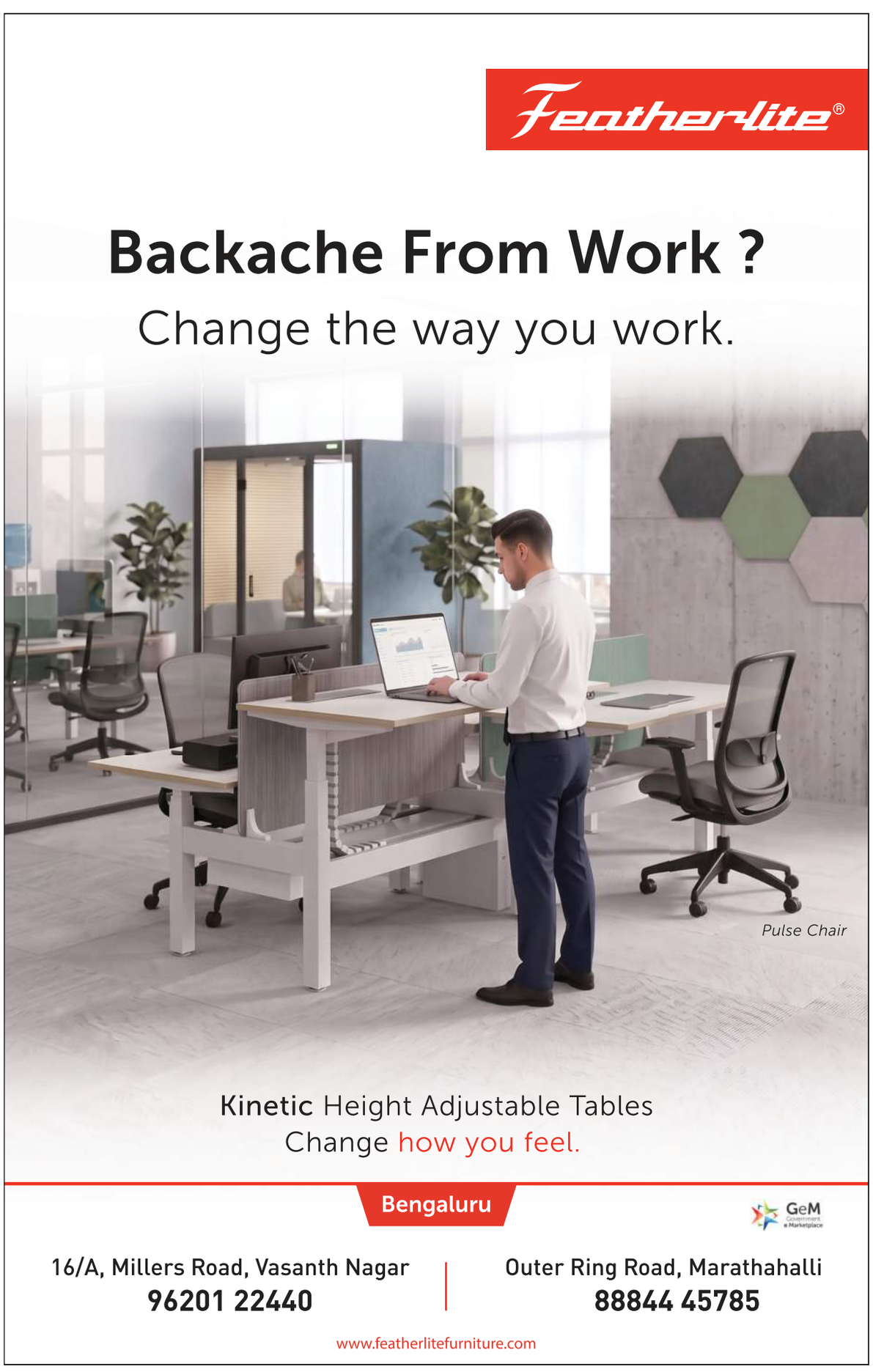
"There is a demand for credit, unfulfilled demand for credit which digital credit is actually filling in," Kumar told TOI. Vikas Bansal, CEO of Amazon Pay India, said rising aspirations among younger consumers were also driving borrowing in smaller cities. Digital platforms, he said, were reaching people who had previously had limited access to credit. Another finding was the higher adoption among salaried women. About 66.5% of salaried women surveyed had used BNPL or EMI products, compared with 59.3% of salaried men. Bansal described this as an encouraging sign of credit reaching segments that have historically been underserved.

CREDIT DIVIDE



The study also challenged the perception that digital borrowing is largely driven by discretionary consumption. Around 27% of respondents said they had used digital credit to purchase work equipment or tools, 24% to start or expand a business or side income, and 22% for education or skilling. However, trust continues to constrain adoption. While awareness of digital credit products averaged 88%, usage averaged just 31% across the five products studied. Consumers rated their payment apps 3.98 out of five for making payments, but only 3.10 for borrowing.

Bansal said the industry needed to simplify lending terms, improve transparency and strengthen consumer protection.



SNAP SHOTS

Sindhu, Sen crash out

PV Sindhu and Lakshya Sen made early exits while Kidambi Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma advanced to the second round of the Denmark Open badminton tournament in Odense. Sindhu lost to lower-ranked Yvonne Li of Germany 21-13, 23-25, 19-21 in her women's singles first-round match. Sen lost to third seed Chou Tien Chen of Chinese Taipei 18-21, 21-13, 15-21.

SL claim consolation win: Kusal Mendis hit a half century and medium pacer Dasun Shanaka grabbed three wickets as Sri Lanka beat Pakistan by eight wickets in the third and final T20I on Tuesday. Skipper Mendis hit a 48-ball 87 as Sri Lanka chased down the 169-run target in 17.1 overs for a consolation win at Pindi Stadium. Pakistan won the series 2-1 with four-wicket and 82-run wins in the first two encounters.
Brief scores: Pakistan: 168/8 in 20 overs (Sahibzada Farhan 76, Arafat Minhas 34; Nuwan Thushara 2-38, Eshan Malinga 2-38) **lost to Sri Lanka: 172/2 in 17.1 overs** (Sineth Jayawardena 38, Kusal Mendis 87n.o, Kamindu Mendis 40n.o).

Rwanda to host F1 in 2030s: Rwanda will host a Formula One race from the early 2030s in a 10-year deal, F1 said in a statement on Tuesday. Formula One has not raced in Africa since the last South African GP was held at Kyalami, north of Johannesburg, in 1993. The track where the Rwandan race will happen is yet to be built.

Barca vs Real legends in Kolkata: Kolkata is set to host an exhibition match between the legends of Spanish football teams Barcelona and Real Madrid on Nov 25, West Bengal sports minister Indranil Khan announced on Tuesday. The match will be held at the Vivekananda Yuva Bharati Krirangan, popularly known as the Salt Lake Stadium.

Coventry crush Newcastle: Coventry earned a slice of Premier League history as they climbed out of the relegation zone with a stylish 4-1 win against Newcastle on Monday. **Results: EPL:** Coventry 4 (Rudoni 6-pen, Cherif 48, Simms 81, Mfuni 86) bt Newcastle 1 (Botman 70).

Gyan does the 'trick: Gyan scored a hat-trick as Team Wildboar claimed a 5-2 win over Kodava Marshals in the DS Murthy Memorial hockey tournament in Bengaluru on Tuesday. **Result:** Wildboar 5 (Gyan 2, 11, 42, Prathik 29, Roy 37) bt Marshals 2 (Swapnil Haldankar 19, Vipul 26). Today's match: New Ashoka HC vs BCYA (3 pm).

Kodagu shock Kickstart: Kodagu FC claimed a 2-1 win over defending champions Kickstart FC in the Karnataka Super Division League football championship in Bengaluru on Tuesday. In another match, MD Arbash scored four goals as BFC cruised to a 9-0 win over Technico FF. **Results:** BFC 9 (Rakshit P Anil 17-pen, MD Arbash 32, 39, 46, 64, Nee Hang Subba 53, 57, Sohum Utreja 62, Meluhha Shreyaas 67-og) bt Technico FF 0; Kodagu 2 (Lalkrawsmawia 2, Muhammed Unais M 90+3) bt Kickstart 1 (John Peter 28-pen); South United 3 (Makakmayum Daniyal 28, 70, Nirupam Gowda H 31) bt Roots 0.

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KARUN LIFTS KARNATAKA

Digs Visitors Out Of Trouble To Keep Draw Hopes Alive Vs Andhra

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Mahesh G

STANDING TALL: Karun Nair scored an unbeaten 81 on Tuesday

Vijayawada: Dropped without explanation from South Zone's Duleep Trophy XI six weeks ago, Karun Nair has answered in the language he has learnt well lately — runs under pressure.

After an unbeaten century in the Dr (Capt) K Thimmappaiah Memorial Tournament recently, the 34-year-old dug Karnataka out of trouble with an unbeaten 81 (130b; 8x4; 2x6) against Andhra in their Ranji Trophy season opener on Tuesday, keeping alive their hopes of salvaging a draw.

With Karnataka trailing by 144 runs on the first innings at the ACA Stadium here, the experienced opening pair of Mayank Agarwal (18) and KL

RANJI TROPHY

Rahul (1) fell cheaply to leave the visitors reeling at 25/2.

Karun, however, held his nerve, counterattacked when the opportunity arose and stitched together a 94-run stand with Manvanth Kumar (44) before combining with R Smaran to steer Karnataka to 176/4 in 60 overs, a lead of 32 runs heading into the final day.

Having conceded the first-innings lead, Karnataka fought to keep the prospect of a point alive.

Earlier, Andhra were bowled out for 418 in 121.5 overs, with spinner Shikhar Shetty claiming a six-wicket haul after a long toil. Resuming at 331/6, Andhra lost centurion Seeram Rahul (119) when he was cramped for room by Ritesh Bhatkal (2/109). The teenage debutant added 11 to his overnight score of 108 before departing. Useful contributions from Venkat Sasikanth (39) and Saurabh Kumar (24) took the hosts past 400.

Facing a deficit of 144, Mayank and Rahul began cautiously, but Andhra's astute field placements left the experienced duo with little room even to rotate the strike.

Left-arm spinner Saurabh (3/41) proved particularly effective, using flight and guile to trouble the openers. He nearly had Rahul in the final over before lunch, but an appeal for a catch behind was turned down. The reprieve did little to help the Karnataka batter, who was trapped in front by Saurabh for a laborious one off 20 deliveries. In his next over, the 33-year-old, who moved to Andhra from Uttar Pradesh last season, trapped Mayank.

KV Aneesh (6) was the next to fall, edging Saurabh to skipper Ricky Bhui at first slip. Promoted to No. 3, Manvanth (44) joined Karun, and the pair set about rebuilding after Manvanth was dropped on seven.

Karun eased the pressure with two sixes off Saurabh and Lalith Mohan in successive overs. As Andhra bowlers began to stray in line and length, the Karnataka duo grew in confidence. Karun remained a picture of composure, bringing up his half-century off 76 deliveries. Their 94-run fourth-wicket stand ended when Manvanth played back to a Lalith delivery and dragged it onto his stumps.

First-innings centurion Smaran then joined Karun, and the pair wore down the attack with sharp running between the wickets. With Karun holding firm and Smaran providing support, Karnataka moved into a position from which they could realistically save the match.

SCOREBOARD

Karnataka (I innings): 274
Andhra (I innings; o/n 331/6): SV Rahul lbw Bhatkal 119, Venkat Sasikanth lbw Shikhar 39, Saurabh Kumar c Shrijith b Shikhar 24, Lalith Mohan (not out) 16, Kavuri Saiteja lbw Shikhar 1. **Extras:** (B-5; LB-5, W-1; NB-4) **15**. **Total:** (all out; 121.5 overs) **418.**
Fall of wickets: 7-364, 8-395, 9-416.
Bowling: Abhilash Shetty 12-0-49-0, Shikhar Shetty 35.5-2-115-6, Madhav Bajaj 33-4-94-2, Manvanth Kumar 4-0-33-0, Ritesh Bhatkal 35-3-109-2, Karun Nair 2-0-8-0.
Karnataka (II innings): Mayank Agarwal lbw Saurabh 18, KL Rahul lbw Saurabh 1, Manvanth Kumar b Lalith 44, KV Aneesh c Bhui b Saurabh 6, Karun Nair (batting) 81, R Smaran (batting) 21. **Extras:** (LB-5) **5**. **Total:** (4 wkts; 60 overs) **176**.
Fall of wickets: 1-18, 2-25, 3-43, 4-137.
Bowling: Kavuri Saiteja 8-1-26-0, Venkat Sasikanth 2-1-4-0, Lalith Mohan 17-1-55-1, Saurabh 18-1-41-3, T Vijay 14-1-43-0, Shaik Rasheed 1-0-2-0.
Other Group 'B' scores: At Secunderabad: Tripura: 134 & 120 all out in 41.2 overs (Paul 25, Sarkar 27; Siraj 2-19, Thyagarajan 6-52) **It to Hyderabad (O/n: 121/4): 294 all out. At New Chandigarh: Assam: 373 all out vs Punjab: 287/5 in 96 overs** (Vihaan 103, Harnoor 54, Salil 25, Emanjot Chahal 28; Purkayastha 2-52).
At Rajkot: Saurashtra: 392 vs Chhattisgarh: 312 all out in 121.5 overs (Mayank 68, Vikalp 46, D Jadeja 25; Unadkat 2-66, Sakariya 2-58, Ankur 2-42, R Jadeja 3-40).

Swansong for four seniors

Manuja.Veerappa@timesofindia.com

For some of India's Olympic medallists, the Asian Champions Trophy could be one last march in national colours. With international hockey returning to Punjab after 17 years, the tournament later this month is set to usher in a change of guard, with at least four senior players facing the exit as India begin rebuilding for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics.

India, who clinched the Asian Games gold in Japan earlier this month to secure their Olympic berth, will continue to be led by Harmanpreet Singh. But the tournament, beginning in Jalandhar on Oct 27 and concluding in Mohali on Nov 5, according to sources will be the final assignment in India

HOCKEY

colours for **Mandeep Singh**, Jarmanpreet Singh, Amit Rohidas and Nilakanta Sharma. All four, who are in their 30s, have been part of India's Olympic bronze medal-winning campaigns over the previous two editions.

The writing has been on the wall for some time, with the team management keen to blood in fresh talent .

Hockey India selection committee chairman RP Singh declined to name the players but confirmed that at least half a dozen could feature in their final matches for India at the ACT.

"It is time to get fresh legs into the team. I cannot comment about the names of the players, but they have been informed about the situation. Having served the country for so long with distinction, we believe they deserve an honourable exit. With Punjab hosting an international tournament after nearly two decades, it is only fitting that some of them sign off on home turf," Singh told TOI.

"With the Olympics less than two years away, it gives the coaching staff enough time to test the talent pool and groom them," he added. Singh also said a team comprising the remaining senior players and fresh faces would tour New Zealand in November, giving chief coach Craig Fulton an opportunity to assess young talent in overseas conditions.

The ACT, where India are the defending champions, will also mark the return of experienced goalkeeper Krishan Pathak, who was left out of the World Cup and Asian Games squads. He replaces HS Mohith. Rajkumar Pal, who sustained an injury during the Asian Games, has been ruled out, while Vivek Sagar Prasad and Sumit have been rested. Amandeep Lakra and Aditya Lalage have been added to the squad. **Squad: Goalkeepers:** Suraj Karkera; Krishan Pathak; **Defenders:** Sanjay, Harmanpreet Singh (c), Amit Rohidas, Jugraj Singh, Jarmanpreet Singh, Amandeep Lakra; **Midfielders:** Rajinder Singh, Aditya Lalage, Nilakanta Sharma, Hardik Singh, Manpreet Singh. **Forwards:** Shilanand Lakra, Abhishek, Sukhjeet Singh, Dilpreet Singh, Mandeep Singh.

East Bengal raise hopes before going down

Nilesh.Bhattacharya@timesofindia.com

Kolkata: For 45 minutes, East Bengal FC were living in a la la land, turning their AFC Champions League Two match against Iraqi powerhouse Al-Shorta here on Tuesday into a classic David-vs-Goliath contest. David Lalhlansanga struck home twice on either side of Ahmed Yahya's goal to help Antonio Lopez Habas' team go into the break with a 2-1 lead.

The scoreline at halftime could have been even more eye-catching for the home team had David not missed at least three more chances to complete his hat-trick. But the visitors from Iraq returned to the field to flip the narrative spectacularly, proving why they are being tipped as one of the pre-tournament favourites as Al-Saedi Hussein made it 2-2 in 51 minutes and Nigerian forward Kingsley Kuku clinched the deal with the match-winner two minutes later for Al-Shorta, who had to play the final quarter of the match with 10 men after Boubacar Moumouni's expulsion following two bookings.

Kuku had another goal disallowed at the death as East Bengal left the field with plenty of 'what-if' moments.

Varun scores double ton

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Vidarbha's Varun Bisht stole the show with a double ton against Karnataka on the second day of the CK Nayudu Trophy match here on Tuesday.

The right-hander hit 209 off 229 balls, comprising 20 fours and nine sixes, as Vidarbha, who started the day on 267/6, were dismissed for 539 in 137.5 overs. Left-arm spinner Hardik Raj was the pick of the bowlers with four scalps for Karnataka. Dhruv Prabhakar and Samit Dravid took two wickets each. The hosts were 92 for no loss at stumps as they trailed by 447 runs. Vijayaraj B (56 batting) Prakhar Chaturvedi (33 batting) were at the crease.

CK NAYUDU TROPHY

Brief scores: Vidarbha: 539 in 147.5 overs (Varun Bisht 209, Gaurav Farde 35, Sanskar Chavate 56, Hardik Raj 4-173, Dhruv Prabhakar 2-36, Samit Dravid 2-63) **vs Karnataka: 92 for no loss in 32 overs** (Vijayaraj B 56 batting, Prakhar Chaturvedi 33 batting).

Shashank stars in Dharwad's victory

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: Shashank Bannatti (5/7 & 3/25) bagged a match haul of eight wickets to help Dharwad Zone claim an innings and 67-run win over Raichur Zone in the KSCA (U-16 boys) inter-zonal tournament here recently.

Brief scores: Raichur: 63 in 29.5 overs (Shivam Katwe 2-26, Samarth Chougule 2-23, Shashank Bannatti 5-7) **& 72 in 24 overs** (Rathod Sairam 32 n.o; Sagar Kamman Alamuru 2-33, Eric Rupreo 2-43, Naksh CM 2-54) **& 82/1 in 14 overs** (Srijesh 33 n.o, Tanshh 44 n.o) **drew with Vice President's XI: 203 in 75 overs** (Anirudh Bangera 33, Viaan Joshi 76, Ashwwath Nagarajan 30; Vidhat S 5-24). **Mysore: 330/7 in 90 overs** (Jayanth Gowda 32, Nikhil Chethan 48, Chirayu I Konnor 62, Preetham HG 38, Bhuvan Gowda C 52 n.o; Ayush YS 3-32) **bt Shivamogga: 60 in 28 overs** (Dharshith RJ 3-11, Rohan Gowda 3-5, Preetham 2-0) **& 107 in 43 overs** (Yuvaraj N 31, Jagan TP 30; Bhuvan 3-8, Bhavish K 4-18, Vivaan DS 2-18). **Mangalore: 92 in 39.4 overs** (Vikram 2-15, Advik Srinivas 5-21, Sai Vignesh Srikanth 2-18) **& 62 in 21.5 overs** (Vikram 3-19, Saurjyesh Das 5-15) **lost to Secretary's XI: 376/9 in 90 overs** (Niranjan Ashok 80, Arnav Manchale 104 (128b, 13 x 4), Srikanth 32, Siddharth HS 44, Vikram 56 n.o; Ayush Kotiyan 3-72, Prathista Nayak 3-67, Avaneesha SN 2-57).
Tumkur: 226 in 63.2 overs (Aayat Khan 55, Shivaraj R 108 (103b, 17x4; 2x6), Mohammed Yaseen 37; Hannan Ahmad 2-60, Aaryan Nagesh 2-37, M Neeraj 3-33) **& 151/3 in 27 overs** (Aayat 65 n.o, Shivaraj 68; Hannan 2-30) **drew with President's XI: 343/8 in 89 overs** (Prabhav Pydah 45, Samarth Suresh 119 (176b, 14 x 4), Ryan Tomar 67; Ashith Girish 2-54, Gagan Y 2-36, Mohammed Zaid 2-63). **Combined City XI: 223 in 80.5 overs** (Saachin Araganji 45, Vedant Shaurya 54; Chiranjith SP 4-48, Akhilesh Pradhan 2-36, Kushal KA 2-32) **& 119/2 in 26.5 overs** (Trishaan Sethi 34, Saachin 49, Aarav Bajaj 36 n.o) **drew with Bangalore: 201 in 66.3 overs** (Niraj V 45, Vastvik Sharma 50, Ruchitaksh Indrekar 30; Vignesh Subhramaniyan 2-22, Aarav Singh 3-18, Aarav Bajaj 3-9).

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
MINOR IRRIGATION & GROUND WATER DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MINOR IRRIGATION & GROUND WATER DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT DIVISION, BELAGAVI.
PH NO.0831-2463850 / FAX NO.0831-2423008

No.EE /MI&GWDDD/BGM/TND/AE/2026-27/1544 Date:13-10-2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (KW-4)

As per KTTP Act-2000 and recent Amendments the Executive Engineer Minor Irrigation & Ground Water Development Department Division Belagavi has invited the Item rate tender through KPPP (https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in). Total 01 No. of Athani Sub Divisions. Estimate Amount Rs.794.00 Lakhs. 1. For KW-4 work: Date of Pre-tender meeting:23-10-2026 at 11.00 AM, 2.Tender Receipt Last Date:28-10-2026 Evening 4.00 PM, 3.Tender Opening Date:29-10-2026 Evening 4.30 PM (if possible), 4. For Tender Details office address: Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation & Ground Water Development Department Division Belagavi & www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in

Sd/-Executive Engineer,
M.I & GWDD Division, Belagavi.

DIPR/BGM/RO-NO-975/KSMCA/2026-27

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, खण्ड प्रथम, सीकर

क्रमांक : 3729 दिनांक: 08-10-2026

संशोधित निविदा सूचना संख्या 14/2026-27 (RO No. 16516)

इस कार्यालय के क्रमांक 3484 दिनांक 23.09.2026 के द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा संख्या 14/2026-27 के क्रम संख्या 1, 7, 8 एवं 9 पर अंकित कार्य को अपरिहार्य कारणों से निम्नानुसार संशोधित किया जाता है:-

विवरण	पूर्व दिनांक	संशोधित दिनांक
निविदा आवेदन / डाउनलोड करने की तारीख	दिनांक 25.09.2026 को प्रात: 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 08.10.2026 को सांय 6.00 बजे तक	दिनांक 25.09.2026 को प्रात: 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 29.10.2026 को सांय 6.00 बजे तक
ऑनलाईन निविदा जमा कराने की तारीख	दिनांक 25.09.2026 को प्रात: 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 08.10.2026 को सांय 6.00 बजे तक	दिनांक 25.09.2026 को प्रात: 9:30 बजे से दिनांक 29.10.2026 को सांय 6.00 बजे तक
निविदा खोलने की तारीख	09.10.2026 को दोपहर 1.00 बजे	30.10.2026 को दोपहर 1.00 बजे

नोट- सवेदक द्वारा धरोहर राशि के रूप में डिमाण्ड ड्राफ्ट/बैंकर चेक/बैंक गारन्टी/ई-बैंक गारन्टी / इन्सूरेन्स श्योरिटी बॉण्ड के माध्यम से जमा करवाता है तो भौतिक रूप से दिनांक 30.10.2026 को दोपहर 12.00 बजे तक जमा करवाना आवश्यक है।

NIB Code : PWD2627A2913
UBN Code : PWD2627WSOB13063, PWD2627WSOB13072, PWD2627WSOB13075 PWD2627WSOB13076

निविदा की अन्य शर्तें यथावत रहेगी।

(अलका सिंह)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. खण्ड प्रथम, सीकर

DIPR/C/17624/2026

KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED TENDER NOTICE
Office of the Chief Engineer(Commercial &Tariff),Vydyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram

Inviting Medium term Power procurement of 500 MW for the period from **01.06.2027 to 31.05.2032 during 18.00 to 24.00 hours (peak hours)** on lumpsum tariff basis, through e-bidding portal (DEEP) only.
DEEP Portal e-Tender No. **KSEBL/Medium/ Lumpsum Tariff/26-27/ET/95** and e-reverse auction No. **KSEBL/Medium/Lumpsum Tariff /26-27/RA/81 Dated 12.10.2026.** Last Date and time of submission of Application and Bid- (Bid Due Date) -**20.01.2027-01.30 pm.**
For more details visit **www.kseb.in**

Ref : PR/MC1/F404/2026

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office : PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001)
Corporate identity Number U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in (Contact Number 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 13/2026 Dated: 08.10.2026

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No. D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three-part bid system for banking of power from interstate utilities/traders, Traders having valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States from **1st November 2026 to 10th October 2027.** For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 08.10.2026 onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C976/26, DPR/Pb.: 1079/12/2026-27/16126

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS:TIRUPATI
TIRUPATI DIST., A.P.
Office of the chief Engineer **TENDER NOTICE**

ADV No.38/D3/CE/TTD/2026-27, NIT No.96 to 98 /SE-I/TTD/ 2026-27 dt:13-10-2026

Name of work:1) Construction of additional floors over existing two hostel blocks with precast concrete technology in SPW College campus at Tirupati **Amount Rs.2739.20 Lakhs, Time for Completion:15 months. (2)** Modification and Improvements of Bhudevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati **Amount Rs.574.96 Lakhs, Time for Completion:12 months, (3)** Modification and Improvements of Sridevi Hostel Block in SPW Degree & PG College at Tirupati Amount Rs.565.89 Lakhs, Time for Completion:12 months

Note: For full details, log on to the Website https:// www.tirumala.org.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026 - PRO SEC (Adv. No. 215). Date - 13.10.2026 **Executive Officer**

Office of the Executive Engineer, PHED, City Dn. I, Udaipur

No. EE/CD1/TA/2026-27/2557-58 Dated 01/10/2026

NOTICE INVITING On line BID (Bid No. 25-28/2026-27)

On line Bid No. 29/**2026-27 (Rs. 150.00 Lacs) & 30/2026-27 (300.00 Lacs)31/2026-27 (300.00 Lacs) in the jurisdiction, of PHED, City Division I, Udaipur** are invited from interested bidders up to 18.00 hours on 22.10.2026. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on portal **www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, and http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, and departmental state web site.
NIB Code: PHE2627A3022
UBN No.: PHE2627WSRC06397, PHE2627WSRC06400, PHE2627WSRC06402

DIPR/C/17544/2026

Executive Engineer, PHED City Dn.I, Udaipur

34001/1002/2627

E-mail. ID-sectcrb_2006@yahoo.co.in
Tel/Fax - 0671-2301751/2302751

Government of Odisha
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER KATAKA (R&B) CIRCLE, KATAKA
('e' - PROCUREMENT NOTICE)
Bid Identification No.CCE.Ctc. (R&B) 12/2026-27.

1. The Chief Construction Engineer, Kataka (R&B) Circle, Kataka on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites on Percentage rate basis bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road and Building works as mentioned below.
2. No. of work : 03 Nos.
3. Nature of work : Building works
4. Class of contractor : **'B', 'A' & Special Class**
5. Tender paper cost : Rs.10000/- (**online**)
6. Available of bid document in the web site. : **From 22.10.2026 to 17.30 Hours of 09.11.2026**
7. Date of opening of bid : **Dt.10.11.2026 at 11.00 Hours.**
8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website **https://tendersodisha.gov.in**. Any addendum / corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said web site

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
Kataka (R&B) Circle

OIPR-34001/34012/1/26-27/0030

25001/1313/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SUNABEDA
e-mail - serwsbd2003@yahoo.com
Letter No. 6161 Date: 12/10/2026

1st Corrigendum

In continuation to this office Bid Identification No. CCERWCSBD-Online-35/2026-27 invited vide this office Notice No.5500, Dtd.21.09.2026, partial modification of NCB has been made as follows:-

Sl. No.	Item	Time schedule as per Original TCN	Time schedule as per Corrigendum Notice
1	Availability of tender online for bidding	Dt.28.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. to Dt.13.06.2026 Up to 5.00 P.M.	Extended from Dt. 28.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. up to 5.00 PM of Dt. 06.11.2026
2	Date & time of seeking tender clarification if any	Dt.12.10.2026 Up to 2.00 P.M.	Dt.05.11.2026 Up to 2.00 P.M.
3	Date & time of opening of tender (Technical Bid)	Dt.14.10.2026 At 11.00 A.M.	Dt.07.11.2026 At 11.00 A.M.
4	Date & time of opening of tender (Price Bid)	will be intimated later on to the successful bidders	will be intimated later on to the successful bidders

All other terms and conditions will remain unaltered.

Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer,
R.W. Circle, Sunabeda

OIPR-25001/25182/1/26-27/0077

11001/369/2627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION
Lokaseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Email ID: hedsec.od@od.gov.in

HE-GCNE-PLAN-0004-2024/ **53950** /H.E., Bhubaneswar, Dated: **07.10.2026**

RFP CANCELLATION NOTICE
Addendum No.II

The notice for invitation of RFP for engagement of STATE PSU/ CENTRAL PSU/ DEPARTMENTAL UNDERTAKING as Project Management Consultant (PMC) for "CONSTRUCTION OF COMPLETE INFRASTRUCTURE FOR 18 NEWLY ESTABLISHED GOVERNMENT COLLEGES, ONE MDC UNDER RUSA, INFRASTRUCTURE FOR B.ED. COLLEGES, HOSTELS FOR 12 EXISTING GOVERNMENT HEIS, 20 HOSTELS FOR AIDED COLLEGES", floated vide this Department RFP No.GCNE:02/2026 Date:21.04.2026 stands cancelled with immediate effect.

Sd/-
Joint Secretary to Government

OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0073

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
HIGHWAYS DEPARTMENT
Thiruvarur (H) Construction and Maintenance Circle

TENDER NOTICE
(Online only)
Tender Notice No. 1 /2026-27 / SDO /Dated:12.10.2026.

For and on behalf of Governor of Tamilnadu **Schedule tender (Two cover system)** will be received by the Superintending Engineer (H) Construction and Maintenance Circle, Thiruvarur **for Sub work of Construction of Railway span (1No) and adjacent Highway spans (5Nos) in Lieu Of LC.No.1 in Thanjavur arm in the Main work of Construction of Road Over Bridge in lieu of LC No. 20 at km 52/4 of Nagai-Gudalore - Mysore road in between railway km 30/000-100 at Needamangalam yard in Needamangalam railway station of Thanjavur - Nagore-Karaikal section and LC No. 1 at km.53/2 of Nagai- Gudalore - Mysore road (NH 67) in between railway km 1/000-100 at Needamangalam-Mannargudi section under CRIF /2022-23 Scheme** in respect of **Thiruvarur** (H) Construction and Maintenance Division upto **11.00 hours** on **24.11.2026** through online only.

Details of work, approximate value of work, EMD, availability of tender documents and all other details are available from **22.10.2026 onwards in the Government website https://tntenders.gov.in.** If any changes / Corrections etc in the tender, it will be published on the above website only.

DIPR/3104/TENDER/2026

Superintending Engineer (H), C&M, Circle, Thiruvarur

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH

E-Auction of 39 Booths under New Over Bridge, Sector 17, Chandigarh

Municipal Corporation, Chandigarh is going to hold E-auction on Monthly Rent Basis in respects of 39 Booths under New Over Bridge, Sector- 17, Chandigarh.

Schedule for e-auction

Auction Publish Date	Document Submission / Payment Date		Document / Payment Approval Date		Bid Start Date	
Start	Start	End	Start	End	Start	End
14.10.26	15.10.26	21.10.26	22.10.26	26.10.26	27.10.26	27.10.26
9.00 AM	10.00 AM	5.00 PM	9.00 AM	7.00 PM	9.00 AM	3.00 PM

Detail of Booths

Sr. No.	Booth Number	Area of Booth / Shop (in Sq.yd.)	Monthly Rent
1.	1, 8, 9, 16, 21, 28, 29 & 36	14.650	Rs. 26,150/-
2.	2, 4 to 7, 10 to 15, 22 to 27 and 30 to 35	9.000	Rs. 16,065/-
3.	37	17.420	Rs. 31,095/-
4.	18 to 20 and 38 to 40	10.700	Rs. 19,100/-

The detailed terms & conditions of e-auction including eligibility and earnest money deposit (EMD) can be downloaded from the website http://eauction.gov.in/ 2026_CH_ 201

Helpline : 0172-5021521

Commissioner
Municipal Corporation, Chandigarh

TIMES SPORT

THE TIMES OF INDIA, BENGALURU | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

NIKO KOVAC EXTENDS CONTRACT AS BORUSSIA DORTMUND COACH TO 2029

IGA SWIATEK AIMING TO END YEAR ON A POSITIVE NOTE AS WTA FINALS SPOT HANGS IN BALANCE

ON CARDS: MORE RUNS ON THE BOARD

FACE-OFF

IND vs WI

TV TIME: 7 PM

STAR SPORTS

JIOHOTSTAR

HEAD TO HEAD

IND	WI
22	11

LAST FIVE MATCHES

IND	W	L	W	W	W
WI	L	W	L	W	L

VENUE: HYDERABAD

WEATHER 30°C

ODDS

IND	WI
2/10	3/1

195.95

Abhishek Sharma's strike rate while scoring 2036 runs in 64 innings is the highest among the batters with 1000 runs or more in T20Is.

15 Catches taken by WI Shimron Hetmyer in 23 innings is a record by any fielder vs India in T20Is.

—**Stats:** Rajesh Kumar

India Look To Clinch T20I Series With More Damage Up Front In Powerplay

Shiva.Gundra@timesofindia.com

Hyderabad: High-scoring games have been the norm in the white-ball series between India and West Indies and Wednesday should be no different when the two batting-heavy teams clash in the fourth T20 International at the Rajiv Gandhi International stadium.

With India 2-1 up in the five-match series, the hosts will look to seal the series. India began with a comfortable win, chasing down 172 inside 15 overs, powered by captain Shreyas Iyer's maiden T20I century. But the hosts were stunned in the second match despite posting 249, as Shai Hope's unbeaten century helped West Indies draw level in a record chase. India regained the lead by winning in the third game.

India's formidable top order, featuring Abhishek Sharma, Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan, will once again be vital to their fortunes. Abhishek's explosive starts and Kishan's consistency have given India the momentum. Both will be on familiar territory, as they play for Sunrisers Hyderabad in IPL. In fact, it was the strong start that gave India a winning score in the last two games.

Samson will be under pressure to deliver consistently with youngster Vaibhav Sooryavanshi breathing down his neck. After scores of 11, 82 and 3, Samson needs another big score. The middle order, with the likes of Iyer, Tilak Varma and Nitish Kumar Reddy, has plenty of firepower.

India's bowling unit will need to find ways to contain the visitors' power-hitters. Mayank Yadav has impressed with both pace and control, while Naman Dhir has proved to be a good option. Arshdeep Singh's wickets in the previous match and Axar Patel's presence add depth to the attack. Prince Yadav, who replaced Kuldeep Yadav in the previous game, will be keen to make an impact and strengthen his case.

West Indies will look to their power-packed batting line-up to keep the series alive. Hope, with 159 runs, has been a key contributor, along with Sherfane Rutherford (172 runs), who is striking the ball brilliantly. Shimron Hetmyer, Rovman Powell, Romario Shepherd, Kamil Pooran and Sprinter give the visitors plenty of firepower down the order.

In a game dominated by batters, Roston Chase stood tall with his off-spin. He consistently troubled the big-hitting Indian batters throughout the series.

Indian vice-captain and local boy Tilak said that they were wary of West Indies' big hitters. "West Indies batters are very dangerous. If you think you can win the match by taking three or four wickets, that is not possible. They are so strong after playing so much franchise cricket, they are relentless. So, you need to take all the wickets or keep them silent," said Tilak.

Tilak, who had a lot of success at the top of the order, revealed that he is happy to contribute wherever the team requires. "I am happy to do the role I am given, whether it is going from ball one at the death or the rebuilding act. My goal is to perform for the team's victory," he revealed.

Meanwhile, West Indies coach Darren Sammy thinks that restricting India in powerplay is crucial. "The difference that prevented us from going 2-1 up was the powerplay. Even though we bowled them out, they got a total that could be defended," said Sammy.

AFP

IN FOCUS: Sanju Samson will be under pressure to deliver consistently as Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is breathing down his neck

3 India have won all three T20Is played at Rajiv Gandhi International Stadium, Uppal — by 6 wkts vs WI on Dec 6, 2019; by 6 wkts vs Aus on Sept 25, 2022 and by 133 runs vs B'desh on Dec 12, 2024.

Touch-and-go for Rana and Krishna for NZ tour

ODI, Test Teams Delayed As CoE Sets 3-Week Timeline For Prasidh; Harshit's Test On Oct 25

Arani.Basu@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: The selection committee is likely to leave it as late as possible before naming the ODI and Test teams for the upcoming tour of New Zealand as they wait on the fitness status of Prasidh Krishna, Harshit Rana and Rishabh Pant.

TOI understands that Krishna has been given a three-week timeline when he reported to the Centre of Excellence (CoE) after he walked out of the second ODI against West Indies in Guwahati on Sept 30.

PRASIDH KRISHNA

Seam-bowling allrounder Rana, who has been at the CoE since July, is expected to undergo a return-to-play match simulation on June 25 before the ODI and Test squads are expected to fly out on Oct 28 with the ODI series scheduled to start on Nov 4.

BCCI, on Monday, announced that Pant will not be available for the first two India 'A' four-day matches starting on Oct 24 due to a side strain he picked up in the Irani Cup match.

It is learnt that the CoE has adopted a cautious approach in clearing players after rehab. Sources told **TOI** that the Indian team management had pulled out Krishna after bowling five overs in Guwahati as a precautionary measure after he complained of some discomfort in his left hamstring.

"With both Pant and Krishna, the injuries don't look severe at the outset. But the CoE doesn't want to take any chances. That's why both of them were given three-week timelines when they reported to CoE," a BCCI source told TOI. "The selectors and team management are keen to have Rana in both formats, and he is seen as a perfect fit as the seam-bowling allrounder batting at No. 8," the source added.

Krishna is seen as a primary member of the pace-bowling attack in both Tests and ODIs while Pant will form the batting mainstay during the two-Test series starting on Nov 19. Pant had asked for game time with the India 'A' team to find rhythm before the Tests. The Test team is expected to play a warm-up match before the first Test after the third India 'A' four-day match finishes on Nov 10.

Bhuvi training at CoE

It has also emerged that Bhuvneshwar Kumar, who has been picked for the T20Is after four years, is undergoing training at the CoE. Over the last three years, the 36-year-old had designed his calendar to prepare for the IPL.

He has only been playing T20s in domestic cricket. The camp at CoE is intended to get back in shape for the rigours international cricket.

YUVRAJ APPOINTED CAPITALS ASSISTANT-CUM-BATTING COACH

New Delhi: Former World Cup-winning all-rounder Yuvraj Singh was on Tuesday appointed assistant and batting coach of Delhi Capitals ahead of the 2027 IPL season.

The announcement comes a week after DC unveiled Sourav Ganguly as their head coach. A veteran of 304 ODIs, 40 Tests and 58 T20Is, Yuvraj will take up his first coaching assignment in the cash-rich league. "I am excited to begin a new chapter in my life with the DC. I have an old association with the franchise and know the owners well, which makes this a special opportunity for me," he said in a statement.

YUVRAJ SINGH

The appointment marks Yuvraj's reunion with the Delhi franchise. In 2015, the franchise, then known as Delhi Daredevils, secured his services for Rs 16 crore, making him the most expensive player in IPL history at the time. PTI

BETHELL RETURNS AS ENG NAME WHITE-BALL SQUADS FOR OZ SERIES

London: England on Tuesday named their squads for Nov's white-ball tour of Australia, with all-rounder Jacob Bethell returning from a knee injury as they step up preparations for next year's ODI World Cup.

ODI SQUAD: Harry Brook (captain), Jofra Archer, Gus Atkinson, Sonny Baker, Tom Banton, Jacob Bethell, Jordan Cox, Henry Crocombe, Sam Curran, Liam Dawson, Ben Duckett, Will Jacks, Jamie Overton, Adil Rashid, Joe Root, Josh Tongue.

T20 SQUAD: Harry Brook (captain), Tom Banton, Jacob Bethell, James Coles, Jordan Cox, Henry Crocombe, Sam Curran, Liam Dawson, Aneurin Donald, Eddie Jack, Will Jacks, Jamie Overton, Adil Rashid, Thomas Rew, Phil Salt, Luke Wood. AGENCIES

Hazlewood heroics give Australia big win

Pacer Records Personal Best In 214-Run Victory

Durban: Australia paceman Josh Hazlewood bowled his side to a 214-run victory on the last day of the first Test at Kingsmead on Tuesday with South Africa's resistance ending before tea as the home side were dismissed for 206.

Hazlewood took 6-49 as Australia bagged the six wickets they needed on the last day to go 1-0 up in the three-match series. He struck twice in one over with the new ball after already having taken two wickets on Monday and then breaking through South Africa's stoic early fightback on Tuesday.

The 35-year-old Hazlewood also removed the last batsman to ensure the victory in the first clash between the teams since South Africa upset Australia in last year's World Test Championship final at Lord's in London.

South Africa held out for the first 110 minutes of Tuesday's play before a legside delivery from Hazlewood was edged by Wiaan Mulder and snagged by a diving catch from wicketkeeper Alex Carey.

Mulder and Aiden Markram resumed at 102-4 overnight and the pair extended the fifth-wicket partnership to a patient 69 runs off 205 balls before Hazlewood's breakthrough with Mulder making 29.

Part-time spinner Matt Renshaw, who was the man of the match for Australia with the bat, then took a second Test wicket when Kyle Verreynne quickly followed Mulder back to the change room with a reckless shot that saw him caught at slip by Steve Smith without scoring.

South Africa were 166-6 at lunch and added 25 runs before the new ball was taken but crumbled quickly thereafter.

Jansen was bowled by Hazlewood for 35 and three balls later Simon Harmer followed as he brushed the ball through to Carey with his glove.

Markram then fell after a patient 75 off 237 balls, edging Mitch Starc's delivery off his pads to be caught behind but was only given out after a television review. Hazlewood then completed the win as tailender Anrich Nortje popped up the ball to short midwicket for Nathan Lyon to catch.

"Josh is known for being consistent but that undersells him as he can reverse the ball, get the pace up, bowl anywhere; he's a captain's dream," said Australia skipper Pat Cummins.

Brief scores: Australia 390 and 314/6 dec beat **South Africa 284 and 206** (Markram 75, Bedingham 46; Hazlewood 6-49, Renshaw 2-30) by 214 runs. REUTERS

AFP

HOW'S THE JOSH! Hazlewood (2nd from right) celebrates after dismissing Wiaan Mulder

1 Temba Bavuma's first Test loss after winning 11 Tests. His results summary as captain reads — 13 Tests, 11 wins, 1 defeat and 1 draw.

11 Renshaw is the first Australian and the eleventh in Test annals to manage 250+ runs and take two wickets in the same Test.

6-49 Hazlewood has produced a career-best bowling performance in Tests, bettering the 6/67 vs India in Bengaluru in March 2017. His match figures of 8 for 103 (2-54 + 6-49) are his best in a Test vs SA.

Afghanistan's thrilling fightback saves Test

Abu Dhani: Sediqullah Atal's marathon century and some inspired lower-order resistance inspired Afghanistan to a dramatic draw in the one-off Test against Bangladesh on Tuesday.

Opener Atal, playing only his third Test, batted for eight-and-a-half hours for his 332-ball 111 before No. 9 Qais Ahmad hit an unbeaten 49 in Abu Dhabi.

Having started the final day on 132-3, Afghanistan survived to finish on 346-8, from a total of 142 overs, after being set a 479-run target to win.

When Atal fell to a close-in catch off left-arm spinner Taijul Islam soon after tea with the score at 281-7, Bangladesh were in sight of victory.

But Qais and fellow tailender Yamin Ahmadzai (19 off 85 balls) batted for 110 deliveries in a valiant 45-run stand for the eighth wicket to resist Bangladesh's spinners.

Even when Ahmadzai fell to Mehidy Hasan Miraz, Bangladesh had five overs to enforce a win but Qais and number 10 Zia-ur-Rehman hung on, although not without drama.

Brief scores: Bangladesh 346 and 372/7 drew with **Afghanistan 240 and 346/8** (Atal 111, Rahmat 51, Qais 49*; Ebadot 3-50). AGENCIES

346-8 Afghanistan have recorded their highest fourth innings total in a Test, bettering the 149/3 vs Ireland in Dehradun in Mar 2019.

1 Litton Das is the first wicketkeeper in Test cricket to post a hundred and a fifty apart from effecting nine dismissals in the same Test match.

Mourinho returns to Rome with Real drama

Rome: Jose Mourinho left Roma 2 ½ years ago huffing and puffing over the referees after failing to qualify the club for the Champions League during his turbulent but also successful stay in the Italian capital. Now he's back to lead Real Madrid into the Stadio Olimpico on Wednesday for Roma's first Champions League home game in over seven years.

CHAMPIONS LEAGUE

Mourinho's mood will get a lift in Rome, where he remains a beloved figure after leading Roma to successive European finals — a Conference League title in 2022 and a Europa League final the following season. Or maybe his current state will bring back memories of more clashes with the officiating crews.

Underfire Man City face PSG at home

Manchester City will be back in European action on Wednesday when they are at home to holders Paris Saint-Germain. Both clubs are bankrolled by wealthy owners from the Gulf, with City backed by the ruling family of Abu Dhabi while PSG are financed by the Qatari state. "I really feel like I speak for the whole group, we trust the club," insisted Ruben Dias, despite City being found guilty of 34 charges of failing to cooperate with the league's investigation. PSG are bidding for a third straight Champions League title, having come from two goals down to beat City 4-2 in stunning fashion during the 2024/25 edition.

"The message for tomorrow night is quite easy, in terms of winning the perfect game because they (PSG) are the best team in Europe in this moment," said City manager Enzo Maresca. "They won the last two Champions Leagues so that shows how good they are, so we need the perfect game but at the same time doing our best, I think we can beat them and be happy at the end," he added.

Today's matches: Feyenoord vs Como (10.15 pm) LASK vs Liverpool (10.15 pm) Aston Villa vs Fenerbahçe, Real Betis vs Porto, Roma vs Real Madrid, Manchester City vs Paris Saint-Germain, Shakhtar Donetsk vs AEK Athens, Bodo/Glimt vs Borussia Dortmund, Slovan Bratislava vs Stuttgart (all matches at 12.30 am, Thursday). AGENCIES

AFP

Top running coach Yunus Khan banned

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Bengaluru: The Indian athletics fraternity, mostly in denial mode despite the rising number of doping cases, received a major shock when the National Anti-Doping Agency acted on "credible evidence" and imposed a provisional ban on top distance running coach Mohd Yunus Khan, currently the chief coach at the Army Sports Institute (ASI) in Pune.

NADA sources told **TOI** that although there had been complaints against Khan, who serves as a Subedar Major, from various quarters in the past, he was spared due to a lack of sufficient proof. "This time action was taken because we had clinching evidence about his role," they said. Refusing to divulge the details, sources said the ASI has been informed of the sanction, which prevents Khan from working as a coach. According to the NADA website, last updated on Oct 12, Khan has been booked under Article 2.9 of the NADA rules which governs complicity. It covers deliberate actions or involvement in a doping violation committed by someone else.

Harmanjot Singh, who won the 5000m gold at the World Athletics Silver Level Continental Tour in Bhubaneswar on Aug 22, was the latest of Khan's trainees to fail the dope test. Harmanjot, who was awarded $1600 for the victory, was flagged after his sample collected from the training camp in Ooty on Aug 12 tested positive for an anabolic steroid.

Meanwhile, for experts tracking the progress of Khan's athletes, the NADA ban was no surprise, given the rising number of positive cases from his stable. "One of his trainees, who was caught in the net three years ago, had submitted an official complaint against him to the authorities. But the complaint was brushed under the carpet and no action was taken," they said.

Besides Harmanjot, the other Army athletes who trained under Khan and were provisionally suspended include Ajay Kumar (2023, National Games, Goa), Harjodhvir Singh (2023, National Games, Goa), Mohan Saini (Oct 2023) and Kartik Kumar (out-of-competition tests in USA, 2025).

Ban threat on para shooters for challenging PCI in court

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New Delhi: With India's Asian Para Games preparations already marred by selection disputes and court battles, the Paralympic Committee of India (PCI) has landed in another controversy over a para shooting policy that threatens athletes with lengthy bans for challenging its decisions in court.

A clause in the PCI governing body-approved 2026-27 national selection policy for para shooting prescribes a three-year ban if a shooter or their parents initiate legal action against the association and the case is dismissed. A repeat offence could invite a lifetime ban, according to the 16-page policy, a copy of which is with **TOI**.

TOI EXCLUSIVE

"Any para shooters/coaches/parents going to the courts or taking any legal action against the association and further if the case is dismissed by the court, the para shooter would be banned for at least three years and in case of repeated offence, ban could go for lifetime as well," the clause states.

The provision raises questions about athletes' right to seek judicial redress in selection disputes, potentially exposing para shooters to severe sporting sanctions for challenging the PCI's decisions. A senior PCI official told **TOI** that the clause was damaging and should never have been included. The official said directions had been issued to amend the policy and that a corrigendum would be uploaded. However, since the policy was approved by the governing body, a formal amendment may be necessary. It is learnt that some shooters unhappy with their exclusion from the Asian Para Games squad refrained from approaching the courts for fear of being banned.

Boccia dropped, contingent shrinks to 10 sports

The controversy comes amid further reductions in India's contingent for the Games. After para fencing, boccia has become the latest discipline to be dropped, with the sports ministry withholding clearance for the two-member team of Sachin Chamaria and Anjali Devi. India, initially scheduled to compete in 12 sports, will now participate in 10. The ministry cleared 166 athletes late Monday evening, taking the delegation's strength to 275, including 94 team officials and support staff and 15 contingent staff. The Games begin in Nagoya on Oct 18.

Cyclists' hopes end with DRM

The final Delegation Registration Meeting (DRM) in Nagoya on Monday has effectively closed the door on additional entries. Para cyclists awaiting court relief against their exclusion will miss the Games even if they secure a favourable order later. Only Arshad Shaik will compete as the sole entry.

Baretha flags Suhas' inclusion

Para badminton player Chirag Baretha has questioned the last-minute inclusion of LY Suhas, citing his absence from national and international competition since the Paris Paralympics in 2024. Baretha was excluded after the ministry ruled that he did not meet the selection criteria.

"How a player can be qualified and sanctioned in the events at the Asian Para Games, he has never played a single game in the events he is qualified. Arbitration in sports can be visibly seen with the sanction issued," Baretha wrote on X.

Shubhankar, Anirban looking to excel

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New Delhi: Shubhankar Sharma arrives at the DP World Tour India Championship with a win behind him at the recently concluded Kapil Dev Invitational, and a renewed sense of belief. Anirban Lahiri, on the other hand,

GOLF

is hoping that time away from the game will help him return to his best.

As the tournament begins at the Delhi Golf Club on Thursday, the two Indians will be looking to make the most of an important week on home soil. The championship has attracted a strong international field giving the Indian players an opportunity to test themselves against some of the best in the sport. For Shubhankar, the timing of his victory could prove significant. The two-time Tour winner has endured a frustrating couple of seasons, with the effort he has put not always translating into results. Meanwhile, Anirban's preparations have been built around a different priority: taking a step back before returning to the demands of professional golf.

Shubhankar (left) and Anirban

The 39-year-old spent nearly seven weeks away from competition after a demanding stretch on the circuit. For the first three-and-a-half weeks, he barely touched his clubs, choosing instead to concentrate on his fitness. The decision followed an assessment with Dr Greg Rose at the Titleist Performance Institute, which helped shape his approach to getting his body back into better condition.

Shubhankar, meanwhile, wanted to get back into a competitive routine and work out what needed to change in his game. The victory came as an unexpected bonus, but perhaps its biggest value was the confidence it restored. "My main goal of playing last week was to gain some momentum coming into this week. I wasn't thinking about winning," he said.

Shubhankar has also been making changes to his equipment. After trying different clubs and finding it difficult to maintain consistency in varying conditions on the DP World Tour, he decided to return to equipment he knew well. He has since made a few adjustments and worked on correcting habits that had begun to affect his performances. "The biggest victory was to see that the work that I'm putting in is now showing some result," he said.

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Pic: Karthikeyan Sairam; Fashion Designer: Jayanthi Ballal, Mysuru; Stylist: Aishwarya Sai K; Location: V V Puram, Bengaluru

ADITHI SAGAR FINDS HER OWN KIND OF FREEDOM IN ROYAL BLUE

The old world charm of early mornings in South Bengaluru, with its vintage architecture, steaming-hot idlis and dosas, and the aroma of filter coffee, sets the scene for *Bangalore Times*' Navaratri shoot with actress and singer Adithi Sagar in the colour of the day — royal blue. She reflects on childhood memories of Navaratri, the confidence to embrace her individuality and the freedom to explore her creative passions

P2

'Garba has turned into a big celebration without borders'

Shanvi Srivastava gears up to add her own sparkle to Garba beats as she joins Bangalore Times Garba Nite on October 18 - Day 2 of the two-day extravaganza

V Nichita

For Shanvi Srivastava, the magic of Garba began with a move to Mumbai: the hunt for the perfect festive outfit and the joy of stepping into the city's much-loved celebrations. Recalling her childhood in Uttar Pradesh, she says that Navaratri meant nine days of prayers, *aarti* and dressing up in a different colour each day. Her earliest glimpses of Garba came through Bollywood films, but today she loves how the dance form has travelled beyond Gujarat, bringing people together through music, movement and celebration. The actor is set to join *Bangalore Times* Garba Nite this weekend at Bhartiya Mall of Bengaluru, as the city prepares to dance the night away.

CONTINUED ON 3

> Bengaluru embodies the spirit of togetherness, as every small and big celebration is grand here. I am looking forward to join everyone at the Bangalore Times Garba Nite this weekend

@shanvisri

SHANVI SRIVASTAVA

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Time: 6pm to 10pm
Live: Mystic Pop Girls Band

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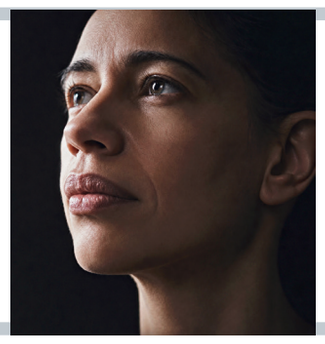
Buzzstop

KALKI KOECHLIN'S SCI-FI DRAMA SET FOR WORLD PREMIERE AT SEATTLE FESTIVAL



Kalki Koechlin's sci-fi drama *Ruhani and Dolma* will premiere at the Tasveer Film Festival in Seattle. Directed by Chandni Varma, the 30-minute film follows a celebrated quantum physicist who gives up her work on the multiverse theory to become a Buddhist nun, continuing her search for parallel universes through Buddhism. Koechlin stars alongside Namit Das and Zachary Coffin. The film is part of the Tasveer Film Festival and Market, which showcases South Asian cinema and stories. PTI

Pics: Sridhar VG

Raghu Dixit brings folk-rock magic to Mysuru Dasara

Raghu Dixit; (above) seen performing at the festival

Against the magnificent backdrop of the illuminated Mysuru Palace, renowned singer and composer Raghu Dixit enthralled thousands of music lovers with an electrifying performance during the Dasara celebrations. Expressing his joy at the event, Raghu said it was a privilege to perform in his hometown.

Known for his distinctive blend of folk and rock, he played a lot of his popular numbers, including *Ninna Poojege Bande Mahadeshwara, Hey Bhagwan, Munjaane Manjalli and Kodagana Koli Nungitha*, that also had the crowd singing along.

The concert brought together music, cultural heritage and festive spirit, creating a memorable evening for the thousands gathered at the palace.

It is not the mountain we conquer but ourselves - Edmund Hillary

ADITHI SAGAR

Pic: Karthikeyan Sairam; Fashion Designer: Jayanthi Ballal, Mysuru; Stylist: Aishwarya Sai K; Shoot Coordination: V Nichita; Location: V V Puram, Bengaluru

Royal blue means freedom & confidence to me: Adithi Sagar

Dressed in royal blue for this *Bangalore Times'* Navaratri shoot, Adithi brings together the nostalgia of old Bengaluru and the festive spirit of the season

Adithi enjoys her morning coffee with some early risers in the city

Scan the QR code to watch the BTS video of **Adithi Sagar's** Dasara shoot

Mehwash Hussain

Bengaluru's early mornings have a charm of their own, states actress and singer Adithi Sagar. While Navaratri is traditionally associated with devotion and the worship of the Goddess, her connection to the festival is rooted as much in childhood memories, family and food as it is in the idea of feminine strength.

"I love the festive spirit of Navaratri and how it brings people together. Getting to spend time with my family, enjoying traditional treats like *kosambri, sundal* and *rasam* with ghee, makes the occasion feel warm and special," she says. Among her fondest Navaratri memories is *Gombe Habba*, the traditional doll display that is an integral part of the festival in Karnataka. As a child, she loved watching her mother arrange intricate clay figurines depicting artisans and their everyday occupations.

'CONFIDENCE HELPS ME BE MYSELF'

"Blue, to me, represents freedom — the vastness of the sky and the waters, and how tiny we are as beings," reflects Adithi. Confidence, however, has a more personal significance. It comes from understanding and accepting oneself, she believes. "Having a life of one's own, shaped by individual interests, passions and ambitions, is an important part of building that confidence. It need not involve grand gestures; sometimes, it simply means taking the first step towards something unfamiliar," she explains.

Celebrating Navaratri

'I WANT TO CREATE MORE'

Beyond the festivities, Adithi is keen to explore the many creative pursuits that excite her. Painting, dancing, singing and acting are all part of her world, and she hopes to give herself more room to experiment, particularly through independent projects. For the coming year, she plans to, "Follow the idea, trust what my mind is trying to create and bring my thoughts into form. I want to explore different things without putting them into categories. I just want to go all in and all out."

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

1	9				4			7
					7			2
		5	9			4		
4	7			6		8		
			7		2			
		2		4			5	9
		8			6	9		
6			1					
2			4				1	8

HOW TO PLAY

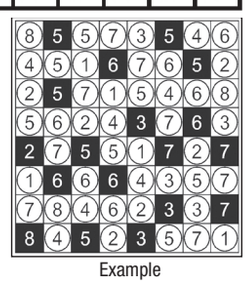
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY

1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 [4] 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. **6 6 6**)

1	1	5	6	4	4	8	2
1	7	5	3	4	2	8	6
1	2	2	4	1	3	2	5
3	8	4	5	3	9	2	1
2	2	3	2	5	2	9	2
4	4	1	9	8	5	3	7
4	5	5	1	4	6	8	9
1	9	7	2	6	1	4	3

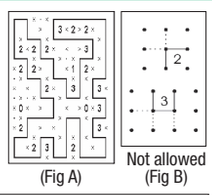


Example

LOOP THE LOOP

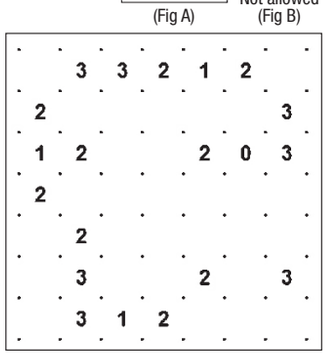
RULES

- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)

Not allowed (Fig B)

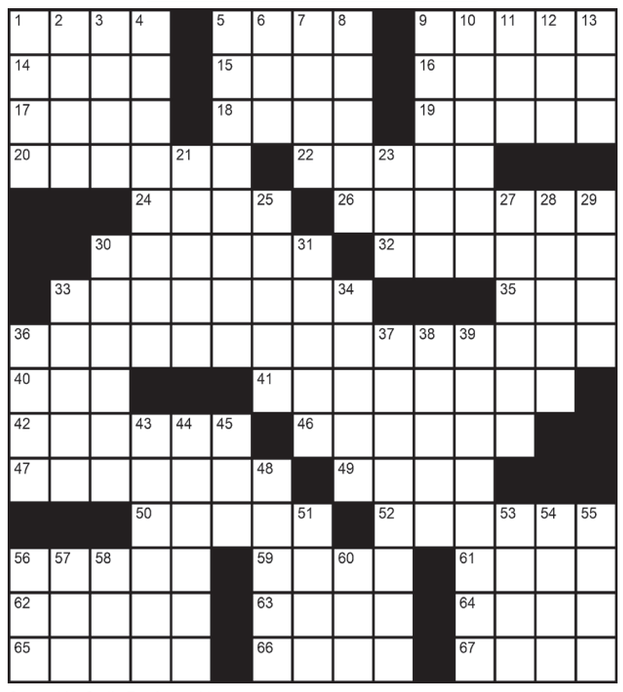


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



Created by Stella Zawistowski — 14/10/2026

ACROSS

1 Smeary image
5 Act courageously
9 Postponement
14 In the __ of duty
15 Tappable image
16 Banishment
17 Black-hearted
18 Stool or bench
19 Childbirth pro
20 Can't stand
22 Formally contradict
24 __ the Impaler
26 Dance troupe's performance
30 Leads to
32 Render a judgment
33 Invariable
35 Martini ingredient
36 Exasperated cry: 5 wds.
40 Have the title to
41 Walks all over
42 Compass pointer
46 Newspaper worker
47 Towed vehicle
49 Narrow opening
50 Large book
52 Frozen spike
56 __ greens
59 Actor LaBeouf
61 Mortgage, e.g.
62 Felt sore
63 Pottery oven
64 Return to earth
65 Male pigs
66 Alone
67 Bitter beers

DOWN

1 Ran in the wash
2 "As I __ and breathe!"
3 Curriculum part
4 Applicable
5 Feeling of aversion
6 Star pitcher
7 Lion's sound
8 Go inside
9 Reason out
10 Strikingly unusual
11 Skater Alysa
12 "I'm __ ears!"
13 Positive vote
21 Watery snow
23 Place to sleep
25 Handed out cards
27 Friend of Pooh
28 Spanish "goodbye"
29 Allow to borrow
30 Part of the eye
31 Sleeper's noise
33 Cringe in fear
34 Aired spots: 2 wds.
36 Typography choice
37 Revolutionary Zapata
38 Vision-related
39 Fleet of boats
43 "I beg to __!"
44 Famed London insurer
45 Snakelike fish
48 Puts at stake
51 Canton's state
53 Solid fossil fuel
54 Narrow road
55 Finishes up
56 "Chocolate" dog, for short
57 "Green" prefix
58 "Now I understand!"
60 Under the weather

Tuesday's Puzzle Solved

A	G	E	S		D	U	K	A	S		C	A	R	E
H	I	N	T		E	N	N	U	I		O	R	A	L
A	N	T	E		S	T	O	R	M		D	I	V	E
B	A	R	A	C	K	O	B	A	M	A		S	E	C
		E	M	S				S	E	R	P	E	N	T
C	H	A	R	I	S	M	A		R	I	O			
A	U	T	O		P	I	T	Y		A	L	D	E	R
P	E	E	L		A	L	T	E	R		L	A	V	A
O	D	D	L	Y		L	I	L	Y		I	T	E	M
			E	O	N		C	L	E	A	N	E	R	S
M	I	S	R	U	L	E				M	A	N		
I	N	N		R	E	S	P	I	R	A	T	I	O	N
G	N	A	T		A	S	I	D	E		O	G	R	E
H	E	R	O		S	I	M	O	N		R	H	E	A
T	R	E	E		T	E	A	S	E		S	T	O	P

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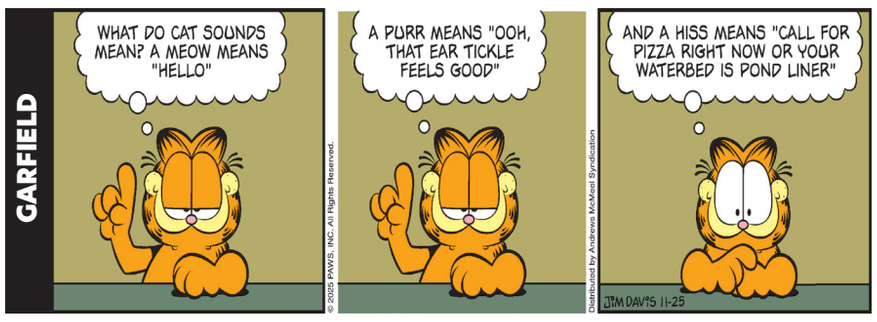

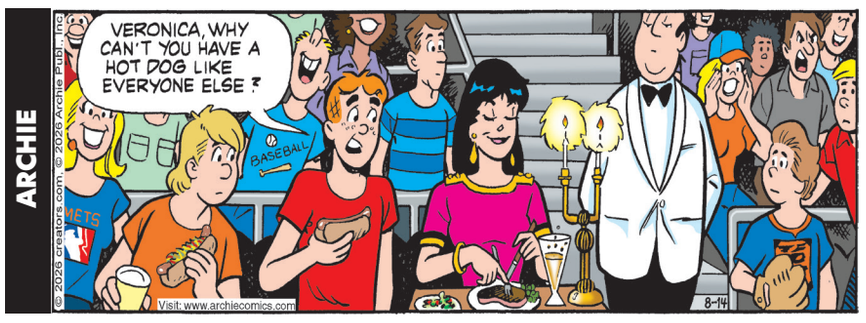

ARIES: You may see the change that comes with a new opportunity. Try to put your worries aside and enjoy your day, as the financial troubles are probably not as big as you imagined. Use this day to soothe, heal, and repair.
TAURUS: You may need to take a conservative approach to planned new expensive purchases. It is a good time to fall back on the golden rule, because you are doing a lot better than most of the people you run across in your daily life. Real estate interests are sparked.
GEMINI: Today is the perfect moment to reevaluate money matters. It may be a good time to consider new investments. Your intuitive nature saves the day. Capture moments of simple perfection.
CANCER: You can consider a career change. You may be worrying about some financial difficulties. Your mind returns to financial issues today. Enter into new social circles, go out and enjoy some parties.
LEO: All choices may be giving you a fresh mental outlook on your future. You may get an unexpected windfall, or a little extra money.

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VIRGO: You come from a moment of opportunity in choosing to leave myself unprotected or exposed. The key here is to be flexible with an infinite amount of possibilities.
LIBRA: A sluggish financial involvement that you've been nursing is finally likely to take a positive turn. Matters that were looking like liabilities will start to yield profits.
SCORPIO: A friend or colleague suggests a scheme that seems not worth to consider. Everything happens for a reason. Keep energies flowing and always remember to place a mirror directly in front of you.
SAGITTARIUS: Today is a chance to fix, stir, or dip. The positive aspect is that you will be leaving behind disagreeable issues for a calmer, more peaceful atmosphere. Today is a good time to express your feelings with conviction, knowing that there will be a response in kind.
CAPRICORN: You will win over people with your charm, but others will be hard to read. Open your mind and have faith in the future.
AQUARIUS: You may take on obligations that take hard work or cause hardship. You will have to watch your temper with someone moody or difficult. Take it easy; don't make solid plans. Utilize your skills to the fullest.
PISCES: A sense of testing the limits can result in a frustrating and stressful day. Extra distractions will make it difficult to accomplish things. Use your leadership skills to inspire rather than get your way at all costs. Responsibilities will force you to focus and be serious.

DENNIS THE MENACE

SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

NYAER
CORKY
KOOUCC
DIRAMS

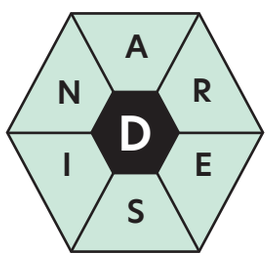
HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

So, two cheers for ___: one because it admits variety and two because it permits criticism. - E. M. Forster (9)

SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
23-average | 27-good | 32-outstanding



How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

EVENTS

WORKSHOPS

Paint and Play Dandiya: Colour your own dandiya then enjoy a session of dance and music to play with your creation at SMOOR Lounge in Indiranagar on October 14 from 3 pm onwards.

Navaratri Dream Catcher: Craft your own Navaratri themed dreamcatcher at Brik Oven in Bellandur on October 14 from 5.29 pm onwards.

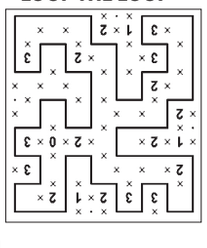
Email us at bangalore.times@timesofindia.com

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

2	3	7	4	9	5	6	1	8
6	4	9	1	8	2	7	5	3
5	1	8	7	2	6	9	4	3
8	6	2	3	4	1	7	5	9
9	5	1	7	8	2	3	6	4
4	7	3	5	6	9	8	2	1
7	2	5	9	1	3	4	8	6
3	8	4	6	5	7	1	9	2
1	9	6	8	2	4	5	3	7

LOOP THE LOOP



TIMES HITORI

9	7	2	6	1	4	3	
4	5		1		6		9
3		9		2		8	1
	2		5		3		7
1	8	4	5	9	2	6	3
	1	7	3	4		2	
2		6		4		1	5
6	4	5	2	8	1	7	
	3	1	4		5	9	2

SPELLATHON

Words: Yearn, rocky, cuckoo, disarm
Answer: So, two cheers for Democracy: one because it admits variety and two because it permits criticism. - E. M. Forster
aide, arfed, and, aside, dare, darn, dean, dear, dine, diner, dire, drain, idea, rail, rained, raised, read, rend, ride, rind, rinsed, said, sand, sander, SANDIER, SARDINE, sedan, send, side, sired, snared, snide

SCRAMBLE

Answer: So, two cheers for Democracy: one because it admits variety and two because it permits criticism. - E. M. Forster

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Garba brings the world together, one dance at a time, says Shanvi

CONTINUED FROM 1

'WE WOULD START PREPARING FOR GARBA A MONTH IN ADVANCE IN MUMBAI'

"Growing up in Uttar Pradesh, Garba was not such a big thing for us. Navaratri was about nine days of *puja*, *aarti* and wearing the colours," she says. Talking about how she was introduced to Garba nights after she moved to Mumbai, she adds, "It was in Mumbai that I discovered the excitement surrounding the festivities. We used to find out which ground the celebrations were happening at, dress up for Garba and look for the right kind of outfits. We would start preparing a month in advance."

'Indians are everywhere and our celebrations are spreading like wildfire across the world'

For Shanvi, one of the most beautiful things about Garba today is how it has travelled beyond its roots in Gujarat to become a global celebration. From community gatherings in the US to people dressing up and celebrating at workplaces and airports, the dance form has found enthusiastic audiences far beyond India. "Celebration is a dopamine hit, according to me. We all love enjoying, coming together and celebrating. We need more such reasons to be happy," she says.

She finds the growing global embrace of Indian festivals exciting. "Indian traditions and cultures have always been colourful and attractive. Now, Indians are everywhere, so it's spreading like wildfire, and it's beautiful. I like how the world is welcoming it," she explains.

'Bollywood movies were my first window into Garba'

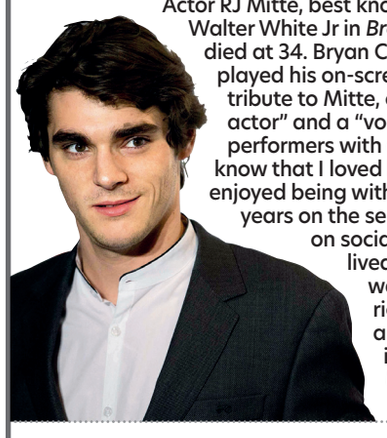
Before social media made festive fashion and dance trends accessible at the click of a button, Bollywood films offered a glimpse into traditions from different parts of the country.

"Since I studied in UP, there was no direct connection with Gujarat. Back then, we didn't have social media to get all this information. Movies were the only thing," Shanvi says. She remembers the colourful attires, family bonds and festive atmosphere depicted in films featuring Gujarati families. "We learnt from films how to dress like them and how to move like them while doing Garba," she adds.

UP TO DATE

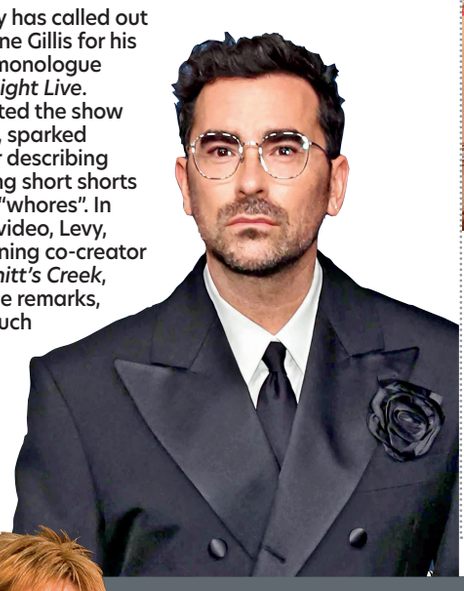
WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY

RJ Mitte, actor best known for Breaking Bad, dies aged 34



Actor RJ Mitte, best known for playing Walter White Jr in *Breaking Bad*, has died at 34. Bryan Cranston, who played his on-screen father, paid tribute to Mitte, calling him a "fine actor" and a "vocal advocate for performers with disabilities". "I do know that I loved him, and thoroughly enjoyed being with him throughout the years on the series," Bryan wrote on social media. Mitte, who lived with cerebral palsy, was also a disability rights advocate and appeared in films including *Standing Up for Sunny* and *Triumph*.

Dan Levy slams Shane Gillis over jokes about women



Actor Dan Levy has called out comedian Shane Gillis for his controversial monologue on *Saturday Night Live*. Gillis, who hosted the show on October 10, sparked backlash after describing women wearing short shorts to the gym as "whores". In an Instagram video, Levy, the Emmy-winning co-creator and star of *Schitt's Creek*, condemned the remarks, arguing that such clothing does not make women derogatory labels but exposes the misogyny of those judging them.

Akriti Agarwal and Prithvi Shaw patch-up after broken engagement

Actor and influencer Akriti Agarwal has confirmed that she and cricketer Prithvi Shaw have reconciled weeks after calling off their engagement in September. In an Instagram statement titled "A personal clarification", Akriti said opinions from people close to her had influenced her decision, adding, "I feel I was misguided." Taking responsibility for the split, she said, "We have since spoken openly, understood each other and chosen to be together again." She added, "This time, I want our future to be guided by our own understanding, trust and love," and urged people to respect their decision as they begin again.

Harry Potter books to get two new additions

Good news for Harry Potter fans! It has been confirmed that two new books will be published adding to the *Pocket Potters* collection in February 2027. Aimed at younger readers and collectors, the books will explore characters from the Wizarding World, including Hogwarts professor Minerva McGonagall and the mischievous Weasley twins, Fred and George. *Pocket Potters: Fred and George*, illustrated by Helen Brady, will trace the twins' school pranks, magical inventions and journey to establishing their Diagon Alley joke shop, Weasleys' Wizard Wheezes. Meanwhile, *Pocket Potters: McGonagall*, illustrated by Natalie Smillie, will explore the Hogwarts professor's life, from her Transfiguration classes and ability to transform into a tabby cat to her bond with Harry, loyalty to the castle and dry wit.

Parandis, mirror, gajra: Navratri hair goes glam

Yashaswi Kochar

Nine nights of Navratri call for nine stunning looks, and the right hairstyle can take your festive ensemble up a notch. Noopur Chokshi, hair & makeup artist, says, "This year, I'm seeing a shift away from very stiff, heavily sprayed hairstyles. People want their hair to look dressed up, but they still want it to feel like them. Textured braids, sleek low buns, sleek ponytails and half-up hairstyles are going to be big this Navratri."

Accessories are the easiest way to make a simple hairstyle feel instantly festive. Be it flowers, shells, *latkans*, or matching braids, there are plenty of ways to let your hair stand out

'Don't try to fight the frizz'

If you don't have time to wash your hair before garba, dry shampoo is a practical option. Go for a sleek ponytail or bun and add something festive like a *maang tikka* or *gajra*. Arsheen suggests, "Start with dry hair and use a lightweight anti-frizz or styling product before you begin." Noopur adds, "Keep a few U-pins and an anti-frizz product in your bag for emergencies."

You can use small oxidised accessories as part of your hairstyle

"A colourful *parandi* woven into a braid, or even a few statement clips can completely change the look," says hairstylist Aatmi Shah

Pics: @snehalmishraa

'Parandis, mirror stickers & colourful threads are stealing the spotlight'

People are opting for hairstyles that are relatively clean. The overall vibe is polished but still fun and dance-friendly, shares hairstylist Aatmi Shah. You can also add threads, small *ghungroos* or any small elements from your outfit. Noopur says, "This year, accessories will play a much bigger role. A simple braid with a beautiful *paranda* or a bun with a fresh *gajra* can make more of a statement than a very complicated hairstyle."

Arsheen Mansuri, a celebrity hair and make-up artist, says, "If the outfit is heavy, keep the hair sleek and simple. With a simpler outfit, you can go a little bolder with a statement *maang tikka* or jewellery."

Delicate hair chains, *maang tikka*-inspired jewellery and boho *parandis* are trending

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